



Communicating Our Legacies — Vital in a Changing World

The 64th Annual Meeting of
The General Service Conference
of Alcoholics Anonymous

The Sixty-Fourth Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

*Communicating Our Legacies —
Vital in a Changing World*

2014
Final Report

Hilton Westchester, Rye Brook, NY - April 27-May 3, 2014

Copyright © 2014 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive, New York, NY 10115

www.aa.org

Contents

The General Service Conference

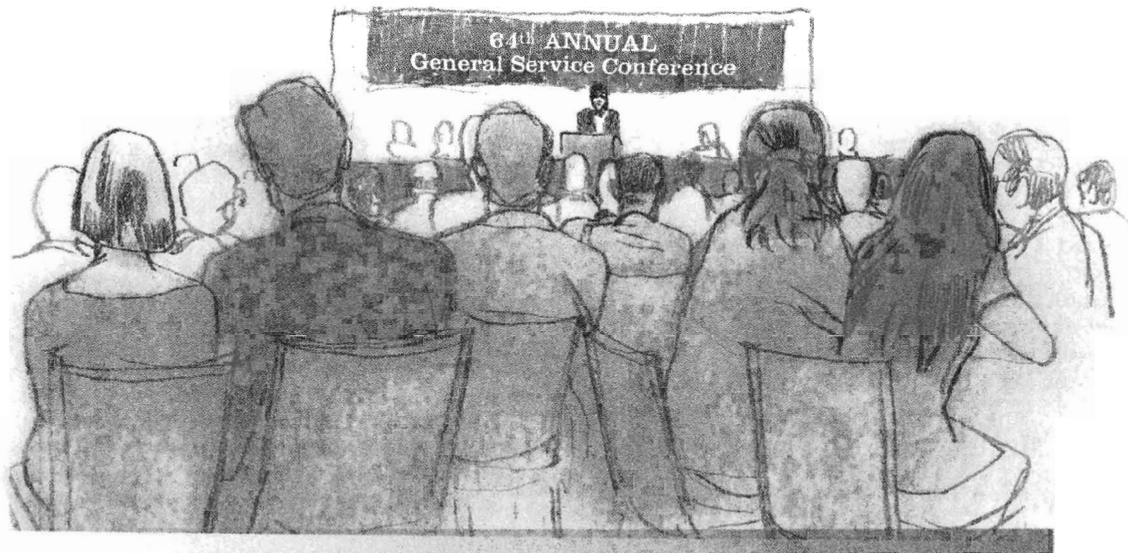
Communicating Our Legacies —	
Vital in a Changing World	3
Greetings	4
Keynote	4
Conference Advisory Actions	6
Agenda	6
Archives	6
Cooperation With the Professional Community	6
Corrections	7
Finance	7
Grapevine	7
International Conventions/Regional Forums	7
Literature	7
Policy/Admissions	8
Public Information	8
Report and Charter	9
Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities	9
Trustees	9
Presentations and Reports	10
Living in the Heart of A.A.	10
Recovery, Unity and Service — Our Responsibility	10
Passing It On Through Sponsorship	11
Finance Report	12
La Vigne	16
Living in the Heart of A.A.	17
Participating in Our Common	
Welfare Through Contributions	17
Inventory — A Guiding Tool to Our Future	17
The A.A. Grapevine — 70 Years	18
General Service Office Archives	19
2015 International Convention	21
Report of the 2014 General Service	
Conference Inventory	23
Reports from the General Service Board	
and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards	30
General Service Board	30
A.A. World Services, Inc.	31
Literature Distribution	34
A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	37
Grapevine Literature Distribution and Circulation and	
Geographical Breakdown	39
Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O. and Grapevine Reports	
Archives	40
Audit Committee	41
Compensation Committee	41
Conference	42
Cooperation With the Professional Community/	
Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities	43

Corrections	44
Finance and Budgetary	45
General Sharing Session	48
A.A. Grapevine	48
Group Services	49
International	49
Estimates of Groups & Members	49
International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums	50
Literature	52
Nominating	53
Public Information	54
Staff Coordinator	55
Area Service Highlights	56
Additional Committee Considerations	64
Recommendations Not Resulting in Advisory Actions	66
Floor Actions Not Resulting in Advisory Actions	67
Financial	68
Consolidated Statement of Financial Position	68
Consolidated Statement of Activity	69
Consolidated Statement of Functional Expenses	70
Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows	71
Report of the Independent Auditor	72
2014 G.S.O. Budget	76
2014 Grapevine Budget	77
2014 Contributions from Groups—by Delegate Area	78
2014 Budget Highlights: G.S.O.,	
Grapevine and La Viña	80
2014 Conference Committees	81
2015 Chairpersons and alternates	81
2014 Trustees' Committees	82
2014 Conference Members	83
Trustees (General Service Board)	83
A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors	85
G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs	85
Area delegates	85

Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



Monday afternoon, when members of A.A.'s 64th General Service Conference approached the stairs leading to the ballroom of Hilton Westchester they were greeted by five 6' tall panels depicting the history of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, A.A.'s basic text. Beginning with the germ of an idea in 1937, when cofounders Bill and Dr. Bob realized that "they needed a book," the panels highlighted the various stages of the writing, rewriting, printing and finally the birth of the Big Book, just 75 years ago.

On the right side of the hallway were four more panels showing the four editions of *Alcoholics Anonymous* — 1939, 1955, 1976, 2001.

As they approached the doors to the ballroom each Conference member was handed a facsimile edition of the 1939 Big Book, with the heavy paper, colorful red and yellow "circus" bookjacket, and red binding.

Another A.A. milestone celebration was the 70th Anniversary of the Grapevine, the International Journal of Alcoholics Anonymous. Tuesday afternoon Ami Brophy, Grapevine's executive editor/publisher gave a PowerPoint presentation on the Grapevine's history. Then there was, of course, the celebratory cake. Later in the week Donald Cusson, Eastern Canada regional trustee, gave a PowerPoint presentation on *La Vigne*, the French-language magazine.

This year the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous in the United States and Canada was held in Rye Brook, New York, at the Hilton Westchester, April 27 – May 3. The 133 Conference members consist of delegates from the 93 Conference areas in the U.S. and Canada; trustees of the General Service Board; A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Board directors; and General Service Office and Grapevine staff members.

The Conference was officially opened Sunday with the roll call by Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O. general manager, followed by greetings from the delegate chair, Linda McGhee, Southeast New York. The Keynote Address was given by Roberta Lindeman, general service trustee.

This year's Conference was chaired by chairman of the General Service Board Terry Bedient; Phyllis Halliday; and Linda McGhee. G.S.O. staff member Mary Cummings was Conference coordinator.

Sunday evening the Opening Dinner was followed by an open A.A. meeting, chaired by Padee McCrery, California Northern Coastal, chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee; the

leader was Sharon Stevenson, Montana. Speakers were: Juan Montiel, Southern California; Linda Kornacki-Kuhns, Northern New Jersey; Clayton Vandivort, Southwest regional trustee; Lynda Bergeron, Grapevine director; and Clay Rittenhouse, G.S.O. staff.

Conference week is long, often arduous, but ultimately rewarding—filled with board and committee reports, presentations and discussions, area service highlights, sharing sessions and, most of all, committee meetings.

The main focus of the Conference though, is on the deliberations of each of the twelve Conference committees, and it is during the committee meetings that the major work of the Conference is done. After a joint meeting with each corresponding standing trustees' committee, the Conference committees review material and background information, weigh and discuss various issues and come up with recommendations which may result in Conference Advisory Actions.

One highlight of this year's Conference was a PowerPoint presentation by G.S.O.'s archivist Michelle Mirza (nonalcoholic), which included audio recordings of cofounder Bill Wilson giving a history of events leading up to the publication of the Big Book.

Another highlight was a presentation by staff member Eva Sanchez, International Convention coordinator, on the upcoming celebration of A.A.'s 80th Anniversary in Atlanta, Georgia, July 2–5, 2015. Following the presentation the 457 Riverside Drive Players (actually G.S.O. and GV staff members) put on an informative and humorous skit covering possible happenings at the Convention.

The 2014 Conference was the second year of a planned three-year Conference Inventory. Wednesday morning Conference members split into 15 groups to address the 2014 Inventory questions and report backs were read to the entire Conference Friday afternoon.

Wednesday afternoon Richard Boisvert, of Terrebonne, Quebec, was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee; and Joel Castellaw, of San Diego will become the new Pacific regional trustee. Joe Downey, from Kingston, Ontario, will serve as the new general service trustee. At the Delegates Only meeting Tuesday night Jake Jacobson, Northern Minnesota, was selected delegate chair for the 65th Conference; Jen Noonan, New Mexico, will be alternate chair.

Friday afternoon rotating Panel 63 delegates each gave a two-minute farewell. Then the 64th General Service Conference was officially closed with the Serenity Prayer, led by Becky Burden

(English), Roger Bedard (French), Juan Montiel (Spanish), and Rod Betonney (Navajo).

At the closing brunch on Saturday morning rotating trustees gave their farewell talks: Rod Betonney, Pacific regional trustee; Donald Cusson, Eastern Canada regional trustee; and Roberta Lindeman, general service trustee. The program was chaired by Terry Bedient (nonalcoholic), chairman of the General Service Board.

While the General Service Conference operates all year, the annual meeting held every spring is the culmination of the year's activities, the time when the collective conscience of A.A. in the U.S./Canada emerges to take actions that will guide the groups in the years to come. In this way, the Conference is a window to the future of the Fellowship.

Each Conference has its own flavor, and one A.A. was heard to observe, "A.A. love and respect were the hallmarks of debate and sharing at the 64th General Service Conference. The spirit of A.A. Traditions was observed, thus creating a unifying commitment to Alcoholics Anonymous."

Greetings

My name is Linda McGhee, delegate, Panel 63, Area 49, Southeast New York. Now that we have all answered the roll call, we are now voting members of the 64th General Service Conference. It certainly is an honor and a privilege to stand as Conference Delegate Chair and welcome all of you. This is a moment in time that each of us will remember as long as we live. Welcome back Panel 63 delegates and welcome Panel 64 delegates to your first Conference. A special welcome to the 20 trustees of the General Service Board and directors and staff members of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine, as well as the many support staff who assist us throughout the week. On behalf of the Fellowship, I would like you to know that we appreciate all that you do for Alcoholics Anonymous. I hope all of you will enjoy your week here at the Hilton Westchester, Rye Brook, New York. Please take advantage of your breaks and enjoy the serene surroundings outside the building, but do hurry back.

Our theme this year is "Communicating Our Legacies—Vital in a Changing World." Recovery, Unity and Service—these are our Three Legacies which are vital to A.A.'s growth. You will see the Third Legacy Procedures in action as we strive to find solutions to matters concerning our Fellowship, for both today and tomorrow. We will look for solutions to matters that could affect our future in this ever-changing world. You have been selected, because of your dedication to service, to represent your areas and their interests as well as to do the work of A.A. as a whole. So don't be afraid to stand for what you believe is good and right for the Fellowship. This is your destiny this week. If you make any errors, our chairperson will lovingly get you back on track. You will be amazed by the Conference chairpersons, trustees, the Conference coordinator and the staff members who work so hard for us throughout the week to make sure we have everything we need in record-breaking time. They are indeed amazing.

Your experience here is invaluable to the new G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, all trusted servants within the groups, districts, and in your areas, as well as the new members coming through the doors of A.A. for the first time. Passing the A.A. message on is the key to our Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service.

This day is beyond my wildest dreams. Twenty-three years ago I couldn't have dreamed I would be standing before the opening of the 64th General Service Conference giving a welcome address; yet, here I am, doing God's will, not mine.

Again, welcome to all of you.

Linda McGhee, Southeast New York

Keynote Address

Thank you, Mary, and to those involved in planning this Conference, for the loving invitation, and thank all of you for your dedicated service to this Fellowship that saved our lives. I am honored to be here and to serve with you. We are all so very privileged to be a part of this Conference week. With happy and grateful hearts we demonstrate our gratitude by the focused attention we give agenda items and our thoughtful voting on the issues before us. The love and respect that we will show each other in the next few days are a testament to the effectiveness of our program and the value we place on its principles.

The General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous is the guardian of world services and of A.A.'s Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions. The Conference is a service body only; it is never a government. This is clearly stated in the Current Conference Charter, which succinctly describes the purpose of the General Service Conference, and that purpose is service. In his enthusiasm for preserving and nurturing the Fellowship, Bill Wilson envisioned a plan whereby delegates from the U.S. and Canada would meet each year and would ultimately take the place of him and Dr. Bob by assuming responsibility for conducting A.A.'s most vital affairs. The Conference would serve the trustees in the way that Bill and Dr. Bob had, by providing the link to alcoholics in the Fellowship. Concept II indicates that the Conference should be "the actual voice and the effective conscience for our whole Society."

The first Conference, April 19–22, 1951, was composed of a panel of 37 delegates and the second Conference in 1952, another four-day meeting in New York, had a panel of 38 delegates, making a total of 75 delegates representing the U.S. and Canada. Today we have 93 delegates carrying the group conscience of their respective areas to this meeting where the business of A.A. will be thoughtfully conducted.

It is most exciting to be at the 64th General Service Conference and to focus on "Communicating Our Legacies – Vital in a Changing World." This theme is no surprise as better communication is usually the motive for everything we do. Each of you in this room is well aware of our Three Legacies: Recovery, Unity and Service, and we know how essential these three are to the survival and effectiveness of Alcoholics Anonymous. Each of us has been entrusted with the group conscience of those we represent; what an awesome responsibility. This is my tenth General Service Conference and I feel the same enthusiasm and dedication that I felt at my first Conference. One Conference I recall went until the wee hours of the morning on Saturday, and I don't remember anyone leaving or being bored or eager to leave, just a determination to finish what we had come to do. This kind of effort gives new meaning to the idea of trusted servant.

Consider the challenges of carrying our message to the alcoholic who still suffers in a world where communication is clogged and complicated by television, the Internet, cell phones, tablets, and laptops, along with the enhancements of Facebook, Twitter and the like. All are examples of dramatic changes that have occurred in the last two decades. This cacophony of sound, visual and graphic images, as well as constant connection with nearly the entire world, can create distractions that hamper and distort the transmission of our message. The home group where members are connected to their cell phones during the meeting and sometimes use them during the meeting; Internet options regarding A.A., many of which are quite inaccurate; and other media that also convey inaccurate information about Alcoholics Anonymous are ongoing challenges to our communication. These are just a few examples of the changes we have experienced since Bill dreamed of the Conference and developed the means of carrying

the message by employing the Twelve Steps. However, the primary focus of our work remains one alcoholic talking to another, regardless of these changes, with the Conference, the home group, the district and the area always supporting that mission.

When I began this incredible journey nearly thirty years ago, the Legacy of Recovery was the primary influence in my life as my sponsor and I focused on the Steps. This relationship was my initial experience with our Legacy of Recovery. As I became immersed in the Twelve Steps, I couldn't look up anything about A.A. on the Internet because there was no Internet. The resources I had were my sponsor, my home group, and the A.A. Conference-approved literature. Today there are a myriad of ways that a suffering alcoholic can connect to help and recovery through the use of a computer, smart phone, or tablet, and we must assure that the message received is clear and authentic. This is one aspect that is vital in our changing world.

In my early years in A.A., the Legacy of Unity was modeled and applied in my home group by our adherence to the Twelve Traditions. The group conscience, self-support through our own contributions, singleness of purpose, and acceptance of all who showed up at our door are a few of the Traditions I immediately saw in action. Recently a man just out of prison attended my current home group and shared a story of desperation. He didn't feel he fit in anywhere in the mainstream society, he couldn't find a job and had no emotional support. After the meeting, I noticed that four or five men from the home group were gathered around him, offering phone numbers and help, clearly demonstrating Traditions Three and Five—"The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking" and "Each group has but one primary purpose—to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." My observation was that the communication in this instance was the basic principle of Alcoholics Anonymous, one drunk talking to another in just the same way Bill and Bob founded our program almost 80 years ago. This face-to-face interaction becomes even more vital in a changing world where most people spend considerable time communicating through their electronic devices.

A new vista opened when my sponsor told me that we should begin participating in general service, and we began to attend district meetings; we even went to an area assembly. I had no idea that anything of that magnitude existed. This Third Legacy of Service has provided experiences beyond my wildest dreams as I became a G.S.R., D.C.M., area officer and finally delegate. Upon completion of four years of service on the A.A.W.S. Board as a nontrustee director and, finally in the last four years, as general service trustee, I can reflect on many years of serving Alcoholics Anonymous and recognize the growth that service has provided me. I humbly hope that my service to Alcoholics Anonymous has been helpful. One real eye-opener was the recognition of the breadth and scope of A.A. service in the U.S. and Canada, as well as around the world. The communication regarding the importance of the service structure for the preservation of our Fellowship is vital in a changing world. There are alcoholics who are completely unaware of our service structure and the role it plays in preserving our Three Legacies, and there are A.A. groups that are not listed with the General Service Office or do not have a G.S.R. and, therefore, have no voice in a Fellowship-wide discussion.

Our agenda for this particular Conference includes many important items that will impact the Fellowship today and in the future. Some items will stimulate animated and maybe even slightly heated discussion, or a motion, a vote, a minority opinion, or even a change of outcome with the final vote. As alcoholics we relish the opportunity to discuss any A.A.-related service matter, sometimes ad infinitum, and that is part of what makes the Conference interesting. This attention to detail and the multiple opinions assures

that we reach the very best group conscience, guided by our Higher Power. As we consider the election of trustees, the approval of slates for boards, the approval of new literature and the revision of old literature, review our audiovisual collection and contemplate new productions, and continue with our Conference Inventory, there will be many opportunities for loving discussion. Concept VI specifies that "...our General Service Conference has the principal responsibility for the maintenance of our world services, and it traditionally has the final decision respecting large matters of general policy and finance." Always we will be guided by the loving presence of our Higher Power and by the group conscience.

As we continue our Conference Inventory and work on agenda items in this 64th General Service Conference, we must look for ways to better carry the message in a world where the barrage of media and the Internet can be utilized to reach the still-suffering alcoholics. Along with this consideration, we must continue to retain the proven Twelfth Step face-to-face interaction of one alcoholic talking with another. The issues we deal with here have not really changed. What is different now is the explosion of technology that adds a new dimension when communicating our Legacies.

In the eight years of service on the A.A.W.S. Board, I have been privileged to learn many lessons. Some of the major concepts from these lessons were: communication is our primary focus; love and tolerance is our code; respect for the group conscience; love and respect for each other; transparency where appropriate; confidentiality where appropriate; and always the Three Legacies, as outlined in the Steps, Traditions and Concepts, provide the pathway to Recovery, Unity and Service at every level.

I will share a personal service story that illustrates how we continue to build on what was started by others. As area secretary several years back, I was privileged to start our area newsletter. This was in the very early days of computers. Another woman in the area volunteered to word process the publication. Two days before the deadline for mailing the newsletter, she called me from her home and said she was having computer problems that prevented her from completing the newsletter. She lived in remote Nevada, about one hour and forty-five minutes from where I lived. So on a Sunday afternoon I got in my car, drove to her home, picked up the material and drove back to my home, a nearly four-hour trip. Fortunately, my daughter, who is also a member of this Fellowship, was living at home at the time, and she was much more computer literate than me. We took turns at the keyboard, finished the project, and mailed it by the deadline! I still have a copy of the initial document and love to compare its crude form to today's professional publication. Three women put together that first newsletter, and subsequent A.A.s in the area have enhanced its format and enriched its contents so that it clearly carries the message from our delegate and this Conference to the members of A.A. in the area. The fatigue and frustration I felt through that whole process were overridden by the joy of being a tiny part of something that benefitted Alcoholics Anonymous!

Most likely we will begin something here that could be the start of something bigger, that might be enhanced and enriched by those who come after us. It is our responsibility to make sure that whatever that is, we are "Communicating Our Legacies" in a complete and accurate manner.

In closing, I thank Alcoholics Anonymous for our sobriety, thank you all for your presence here today, for your love of Alcoholics Anonymous, and for your service. Keep in mind the alcoholic who may be in this very hotel who might benefit directly from our work this week! Always imagine what effect the outcome of our deliberations will have on her or him. Have a great and productive Conference!

Roberta S. Lindeman, general service trustee

■ Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2014 Conference.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 1 The theme for the 2015 General Service Conference be: "Celebrating 80 Years of Recovery, Unity and Service – The Foundation for Our Future."
- 2 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2015 General Service Conference:

"Our Common Welfare Through Gratitude in Action"
 - a. Diversity in A.A. — Our Heritage of Inclusion
 - b. Safety and Respect — Practicing the Principles Begins in our Home Group
 - c. Safeguarding our Traditions through the Evolution of Technology
 - d. Inventory — Looking Back to Move Ahead
- 3 The Conference Evaluation Form be available in English, French and Spanish beginning in 2015.
- 4 The description of the Conference Agenda Committee in Chapter 8, "Conference Committees," in the 2013-2014 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*, which currently reads:

AGENDA (*trustees' committee: General Service Conference*): Reviews and approves the overall format and content of the agenda for the annual Conference meeting; Considers proposed Conference themes and presentation/discussion topics.

Be revised to read:

AGENDA (*trustees' committee: General Service Conference*): Reviews and approves the overall format and content of the agenda for the annual Conference meeting; Considers proposed Conference themes, presentation/discussion topics and **Conference Evaluation Questionnaire**.

ARCHIVES¹

It was recommended that:

- 5 The video *Markings on the Journey* be approved.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 6 The statement in the section *Referrals From Court and Treatment Facilities to A.A.* on page 4 in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional..." which currently reads:

Referrals From Court and Treatment Facilities

Today numerous A.A. members come to us from court programs and treatment facilities. Some arrive voluntarily, others do not.

A.A. does not discriminate against any prospective member. Who made the referral to A.A. is not what interests us — it is the problem drinker who elicits our concern.

Proof of attendance at meetings. Sometimes a court asks for proof of attendance at A.A. meetings.

- Some groups, with the consent of the prospective member, have the A.A. group secretary sign or initial a slip that has been furnished by the court together with a self-addressed court envelope. The referred person supplies identification and mails the slip back to the court as proof of attendance.
- Other groups cooperate in different ways. There is no set procedure. The nature and extent of any group's involvement in this process is entirely up to the individual group.

Be revised to read:

Referrals From Judicial, Health Care, or Other Professionals

Today numerous A.A. members come to us from **judicial, health care, or other professionals**. Some arrive voluntarily, others do not.

A.A. does not discriminate against any prospective member. Who made the referral to A.A. is not what interests us — it is the problem drinker who elicits our concern.

Proof of attendance at meetings. Sometimes a **referral source** asks for proof of attendance at A.A. meetings.

- **Groups** cooperate in different ways. There is no set procedure. The nature and extent of any group's involvement in this process is entirely up to the individual group.
 - Some groups, with the consent of the prospective member, have **an A.A. member acknowledge attendance on a slip that has been furnished by the referral source. The referred person is responsible for returning the proof of attendance.**
- 7 The statement in the section *How to Make Referrals to A.A.* on page 5 in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional..." which currently reads:

Alcoholics Anonymous is listed in most telephone directories. (Some professionals call A.A. while the person is in the office, thus giving the individual an immediate opportunity to reach out for help.)

Or, you can contact the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous for help and information. Write:

P.O. Box 459
Grand Central Station
New York, NY 10163
(212) 870-3400
www.aa.org

Be revised to read:

Alcoholics Anonymous **can be found on the Internet at www.aa.org and** in most telephone directories by looking for 'Alcoholics Anonymous' or 'A.A.' **(Some professionals ask the person they are referring to call the local A.A. number while still in the office, thus offering an immediate opportunity to reach out for help.)**

Or you can contact the General Service Office (G.S.O.) of Alcoholics Anonymous for help and information. G.S.O.'s A.A. website www.aa.org can aid in finding local resources.

P.O. Box 459
Grand Central Station
New York, NY 10163
(212) 870-3400
www.aa.org

- 8 On page 6 in the pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional" the following text be deleted:

"I can't stand the smoking."

There are nonsmoking meetings available. Check the local meeting book for them or contact the local A.A. central office which is listed in your telephone directory.

CORRECTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 9 The section "What A.A. does NOT do" in the pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals," which currently reads:

What A.A. does NOT do

A.A. does not: Furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover; solicit members; engage in or sponsor research; keep attendance records or case histories; join "councils" of social agencies; follow up or try to control its members; make medical or psychological diagnoses or prognoses; provide drying-out or nursing services, hospitalization, drugs, or any medical or psychiatric treatment; offer religious services; engage in education about alcohol; provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money or any other welfare or social services; provide domestic or vocational counseling; accept any money for its services or any contributions from non-A.A. sources; provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials, social agencies, employers, etc.

Be revised to read (additional text in **bold**):

What A.A. does NOT do

A.A. does not: Furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover; solicit members; engage in or sponsor research; keep attendance records or case histories; join "councils" of social agencies (**although A.A. members, groups and service offices frequently cooperate with them**); follow up or try to control its members; make medical or psychological diagnoses or prognoses; provide **detox, rehabilitation** or nursing services, hospitalization, drugs, or any medical or psychiatric treatment; offer religious services or **host/sponsor retreats**; engage in education about alcohol; provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money or any other welfare or social services; provide domestic or vocational counseling; accept any money for its services or any contributions from non-A.A. sources; provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials, social agencies, employers, etc.

- 10 A new video be developed to replace "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" at a cost not to exceed \$70,000.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 11 Because all Conference members are considered equal, all members should have equal access to Conference material and that a plan be created by the General Service Office to translate Conference material (background material, Conference Manual, etc.) into French and Spanish for use during the Conference, with a report being presented to the 2015 General Service Conference. This plan may include coordinating the use of the volunteer network throughout the Fellowship, hiring professional translators or any other facilities that the office deems necessary. The report should include costs and any other considerations deemed necessary to allow timely translations to occur.

GRAPEVINE

No recommendations.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

It was recommended that:

- 12 An anonymity-protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 2015 International Convention.
- 13 An encrypted, anonymity-protected Internet broadcast of the 2015 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony be approved.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 14 The revised pamphlet "Circles of Love and Service" be approved.
- 15 The pamphlet on spirituality with the title "Many Paths to Spirituality" be approved.
- 16 A correction to inaccurate text related to the addition of appendices on page xi in the Preface of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, which currently reads:

"The second edition added the appendices, the Twelve Traditions, and the directions for getting in touch with A.A."

Be replaced with:

"The second printing of the first edition added the appendix 'Spiritual Experience'; in the second edition, the appendices on A.A. Tradition, the 'medical view' and 'religious view' of A.A., the Lasker Award and information on how to contact A.A. were added, and the appendix on the Alcoholic Foundation was discontinued."

- 17 The Conference recommended that the following recommendation be returned to the A.A.W.S. Board for review and brought back to the 2015 Conference Committee on Literature with full background:

The committee recommended that "The A.A.W.S., Inc. Policy on Publication of Literature" be further clarified regarding "...needed editorial changes" as noted below by asterisk and bolded text:

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.



"Unless otherwise specified in the Advisory Action of the Conference approving a new or amended piece of literature, A.A. World Services, Inc. will have the ~~full~~ authority, without need of further Conference action to (a) select the format or formats in which the approved literature will be produced, (b) make, from time to time, needed editorial changes*; provided, however, that no editorial change will be made to the Big Book's Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' the first 164 pages (Chapters 1-11), 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' or the Appendices without prior Conference approval of such change, and (c) translate the approved literature into any language, and in connection therewith to modify or replace illustrations, photos, and other visual art in a manner reasonably designed to conform them to the culture of the expected readership."

Editorial changes to be limited to factual, statistical, capitalization, punctuation and spelling; that any other changes made to the substance of the Conference-approved literature shall be through the Conference process."

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 18 Jennie Herd, alternate delegate, Area 85, Northwest Ontario, be seated as a Conference member at the 64th General Service Conference because Ken Baker, Panel 63 delegate for Area 85 is unable to attend.
- 19 Jim Stone, delegate, Area 1, Alabama/Northwest Florida, be seated as a Conference member at the 64th General Service Conference because Craig Miller, Panel 63 delegate for Area 1 is unable to attend.

- 20 Joyce Saunders, alternate delegate, Area 83, Eastern Ontario, be seated as a Conference member at the 64th General Service Conference because Mel Catherine, Panel 63 delegate for Area 83 is unable to attend.
- 21 The 67th General Service Conference be held April 23-29, 2017, since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays or hotel availability.
- 22 During a two-year trial period the General Service Conference include one day of electronic voting on all nonelection votes, on the Thursday of the 2015 General Service Conference and on the Friday of the 2016 General Service Conference, and that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference provide a report from data gathered from the 2015 and 2016 General Service Conferences, evaluating electronic voting to the 2017 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for consideration.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 23 The 2014 A.A. Survey Questionnaire be changed as follows:
 - Item 3a be changed from "Married" to "Married or Life partner."
 - Item 11e be changed from "Counseling agency" to "Counselor or mental health professional."
 - Item 11f be changed from "Court order" to "Judicial system."
 - Item 11g be changed from "Health professional" to "Medical professional."
 - Item 13a be changed to "Before coming to A.A., did you receive any treatment or counseling (such as medical, psy-

chological or spiritual, etc.) **related to your drinking?** (If yes, answer question 13b.)”

Item 14a be changed to “After coming to A.A., did you receive any treatment or counseling (such as medical, psychological or spiritual, etc.) **related to your drinking?** (If yes, answer question 14b.)”

Item 15 be changed from “Did a health professional ever refer you to A.A.?” to “Did a counselor, medical or mental health professional ever refer you to A.A.?”

- 24 The 2014 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 2011 A.A. Membership Survey.
- 25 The video public service announcements “Living in Chaos” and “We Know What It’s Like” be discontinued.
- 26 A new public service announcement be produced in 2014 at a cost not to exceed \$30,000.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

- 27 The following text be added to the Glossary of General Service Terms that begins on page S19 of *The A.A. Service Manual*:

“Advisory Action — Represents the informed group conscience of the Fellowship, as the result of a recommendation made by a Conference committee or a floor action, which has been approved by the Conference body as a whole.”

- 28 The following text be added to the Glossary of General Service Terms that begins on page S19 of *The A.A. Service Manual*:

“Additional Committee Consideration — An item that was discussed by a Conference committee, but with no action taken or made by the Conference as a whole.”

- 29 The section called “Secretary and Registrar” on page S45 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be split into two separate sections called “Secretary” (existing duties and qualifications to remain the same) and “Registrar” to include the following text (additions in **bold**):

Registrar

DUTIES: In **many** areas, *registrars* now develop and maintain records of all groups in the area, including group name, meeting location, time, and G.S.R. or group contact. Registrars may also be responsible for names, addresses, **e-mail addresses** and phone numbers of the G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, district and area officers and area committee members. They may provide mailing labels for area publications such as a monthly newsletter or a mailing of minutes. **Area registrars also assist the G.S.O. Records Department to keep their records up-to-date.**

QUALIFICATIONS: Registrars should be familiar with the **area and district structure**. For this job, an organized approach is important as there are many details that need to be recorded. Ideally, it would be very helpful if the area registrar possessed some practical, working computer knowledge, and were comfortable relaying information via email to G.S.O. and within the local area.”

TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

No recommendations.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 30 The following slate of trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May 2014:

Class A

Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE	Michele Grinberg, J.D.
Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D.	The Honorable
Corliss Burke, B.Ed	Ivan L.R. Lemelle
John Fromson, M.D.	David M. Morris, C.P.A.

Class B

Richard Boisvert	William Noonan
Joel Castellaw	Chet Parker
Joe Downey	Clayton Vandivort
William Farnsworth	Andrew Ware
Nancy Haynes	Robert Wilcox
Barbara Kelly	Albin Zezula
J. Gary Lutz	

NOTE: The General Service Board will operate short one Class B regional trustee.

- 31 The appointment of the following officers be approved at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May 2014:

Officers of the General Service Board

<i>Chairperson</i>	Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	The Honorable
	Ivan L.R. Lamelle
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Nancy Haynes
<i>Treasurer</i>	David M. Morris, C.P.A.
<i>Secretary</i>	Albin Zezula

- 32 The February 2014 appointment of the following officers by the chair of the General Service Board be approved at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May 2014:

<i>Assistant treasurer</i>	Donald W. Meurer
<i>Assistant secretary</i>	Julio Espailat

This appointment process is in accordance with the 2007 General Service Board Bylaws.

- 33 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in May 2014:

Carole Boerner	J. Gary Lutz
Beau Bush	David Noll
Joe Downey	William Noonan
Julio Espailat	Chet Parker
Phyllis Halliday	

- 34 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board in May 2014:

Lynda Bergeron	Ed Martin
Ami Brophy	Paz Preciado
William Farnsworth	Andrew Ware
Nancy Haynes	Albin Zezula

■ Presentations and Reports

LIVING IN THE HEART OF A.A.

The Sunday afternoon Presentation/Discussion session was moderated by Astri Torjussen, Western Washington.

Recovery, Unity and Service — Our Responsibility

The theme of this year's Conference is "Communicating Our Legacies—Vital in a Changing World." As all of us know, our Three Legacies are Recovery, Unity and Service. Recovery is our Twelve Steps, the thing that makes us whole so we can live useful and productive lives. Unity is our Twelve Traditions, which bind our Fellowship together in love and service. Our Third Legacy, Service, provides us with the structure to implement our primary goal: to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. The Three Legacies were handed to the whole Fellowship of A.A. by our cofounders and the oldtimers in A.A. When this was announced at the St. Louis Convention in 1955, when A.A. was celebrating 20 years, Dr. Bob was gone, so Bill spoke for him and all alcoholics about how turning over the Third Legacy to us was vital to the continuation and growth of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Prior to 1951, Headquarters in New York, as it was called in those days, had already been involved with the distribution of literature and public relations, encouraging good publicity and discouraging the bad, providing accurate information about A.A., maintaining necessary and delicate relationships with medicine and religion, answering letters, and directing travelers to groups in other places outside of New York. They produced the World Directory, provided courage, strength and hope to meetings developing outside of North America, provided services to our Lone members in combat, hospitals, asylums, and jails, and were involved in publishing the Grapevine. Headquarters was operated by a group of trustees who were conducting all of these activities.

But it was time to turn it all over to the Fellowship. Members, however, were quite happy to let the small group of trustees handle our affairs. They even were willing to pay a fee to let that happen. They didn't want to be bothered with business and wanted to keep it simple. However, our cofounders and the oldtimers knew we had to take care of our own Fellowship. Bill and Bob knew they were going to die someday. The trustees were unknown to most members and needed the guidance of the Fellowship, so something or someone had to take Bill and Bob's place. A.A. was out of its infancy and the cofounders said it was time to act like an adult and take direct responsibility. They knew that when the oldtimers started to pass on, Headquarters could not continue and might not be revived. At that point, A.A. had never faced a grave crisis, but they knew that someday we would. Without direct support and no reliable cross section of A.A. opinion, how would the trustees handle a crisis? As far as the cofounders and the oldtimers were concerned, this left a gap in the set-up of

our Fellowship. A.A. members would surely ask things like: by whose authority do the trustees speak for us? How do they know they are right? The question then arose, with our lifelines severed and tangled what would happen to the millions who don't know? Alcoholics would suffer and die because we forgot the virtue of prudence. And that is why the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous became the agency to make all services happen and close off that gap.

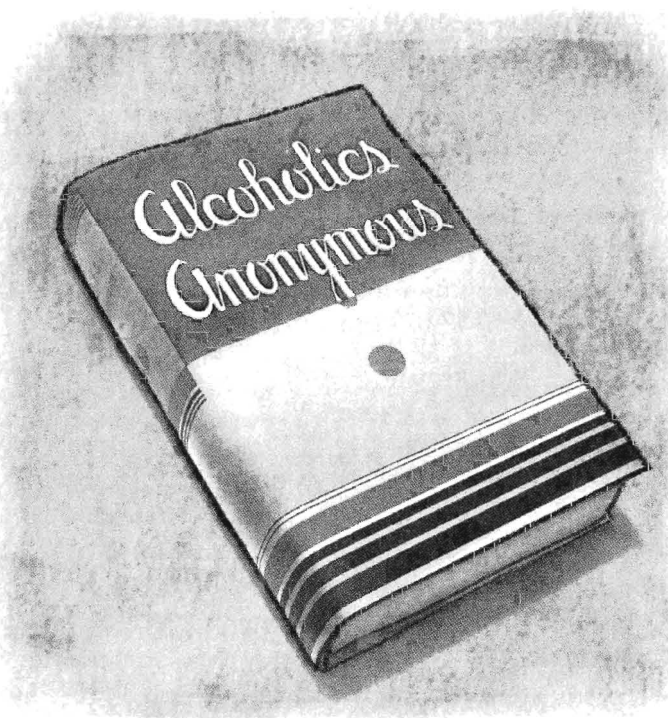
Members of the first Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous gathered at New York City in April 1951. It was composed of 37 U.S. and Canadian delegates, plus A.A. General Service Headquarters staff and trustees. The single purpose of that Conference was to serve A.A. throughout the world. Sitting here in this room today, we have the results of those early days of growth, based on some pretty spectacular insight from our cofounders. But what we also have is one of the most misunderstood pieces of our Third Legacy. So how do we carry the Third Legacy to other members of A.A.?

General service has been called the glue that holds A.A. together. Bill W. wrote, "The most vital, yet least understood, group of service that A.A. has are those that enable us to function as a whole.... Our worldwide unity and much of our growth since early times are directly traceable to this cluster of life-giving activities." Authority and responsibility for A.A. as a whole is exercised directly by the groups through

their G.S.R. The general service representative is the vital communication link between the individual groups and the General Service Structure. If a group does not have an active G.S.R., it is effectively giving up its right to participate in the determination of the policies and future direction of the A.A. Fellowship. Since 1955, when the groups delegated to the General Service Conference complete authority for the active daily maintenance of our World Services, it has grown to fill needs beyond the reach of individuals, groups, intergroups and local committees. The term "General Service" is applied to all kinds of activities within the Conference structure, carried on by districts, areas, delegates, trustees and the New York General Service Office staff. The G.S.R. attends the district meeting, the D.C.M. comes to the area committee meeting and the delegate takes the voice of all

G.S.R.s in Area 91 back to the Conference. The delegates realized back in 1951 that way beyond the individual A.A. member and the individual groups there existed our Fellowship as a whole. They realized it had to function as a whole or we would not have the Fellowship we have come to cherish today.

Getting back to the topic of carrying the message of the Third Legacy in our ever-changing world, the same principles exist in my mind. I've been here and been involved in some form of service for 26 years now, from making coffee in my home group to serving intergroup to being involved in general service. The same principles apply today that applied back in 1951, back in 1955, 26 years ago, and today, in our world of "I want it yesterday."



Those principles are, in my mind, two-way communication between the delegate, the D.C.M.s and the G.S.R.s. As in personal recovery, it involves taking inventory, being a service sponsor, and carrying the message. It's about being a guardian of the Traditions and taking personal responsibility when I see the Twelve Traditions being stomped on, whether it is out of ignorance or out of an "I don't care" attitude. "I don't care about things like a group conscience and the Traditions and our structure," is just an A.A. member's ego running amuck. Just like in personal recovery when I Twelve Step another alcoholic, I stay sober even if they do not. During times when it seems like an exercise in futility, it is still my responsibility to go out and do what is required of me as an individual A.A. member, who is one little piece of a large whole. I think this is the reason this Fellowship has survived. We have not blurred the principles that make it work effectively no matter what is going on in the world outside.

Kim Carswell, Saskatchewan

Passing It On Through Sponsorship

I am Scott Gilkerson, alcoholic, and I have the privilege and honor of serving Area 71, Virginia, as its Panel 63 delegate. It is also a pleasure to present a few thoughts and words on the topic of "Passing It On Through Sponsorship," something that was especially poignant in my early sobriety and laid the foundation for my service journey up to this point. I don't know how the topics are selected for those of us providing presentations, but I thank our Conference coordinator, Mary, and the God of my understanding for this one.

When I received Mary's loving invitation and read the topic, I was taken back to 19 years ago, right about this time of year. A time when our Steps were something you shared about taking but certainly not applicable to me; when our Traditions were foreign and boring to talk about; and when our Concepts only received passing reference from those involved in A.A. politics. In other words, a time when I thought my troubles were unique, when I questioned whether you were telling the truth by saying you had not had a drink in a whole year, and, of course, when I was still trying to get sober on my own terms and not having any success.

Then I met this magical man. A man that asked me how I was feeling after an especially brutal weekend and I was honest with him, saying I felt like—well, you can probably guess the words I used. He then offered to be my sponsor by telling me I should feel the way I did, but that I didn't have to if I was willing to accept some spiritual help. Thus began our journey together.

Sometime shortly after that he asked me to show him my most recent sobriety chip. He pointed out three words on that chip—Recovery, Unity and Service—and said that as we continued on this path we would be involved in all three aspects. More important than his words were his actions. He showed me how taking the Steps gave him a new freedom and a new happiness; he accepted and implemented the group's conscience when that differed from his own opinion; and he served the group in whatever capacity it needed, even when that interfered with his personal ambitions. He even saw that general service might be a wrench that fit this nut and encouraged me to get involved, and then he eventually suggested I ask another man to be my sponsor.

The man that became my second sponsor was involved in general service and his example demonstrated the value of giving something back to A.A. as a whole: the program and Fellowship that saves our lives and gives us lives worth living. He also reintroduced me to the first part of the First Step of Service—Get in the Car—and gave me the decoder ring that put meaning behind our long abbreviation list and service phrases—G.S.R., D.C.M.,

P.I./C.P.C., Minority Opinion, Right of Decision, etc. I traveled with that man for many years, to many assemblies and planning meetings, by just getting in the car and then watching our service processes unfold, learning that expressing our collective conscience isn't politics at all.

The time then came where a service sponsor was required. She had a deeper grasp of our Concepts and their practical relevance to our business processes, a fuller understanding of how our World Service entities related to each other, and displayed the trusted servant qualities that I wanted and needed in order to continue serving Alcoholics Anonymous. She showed me the difference between a statesman and a politico, the importance of prudence, and that compromise is often not such a bad idea. She is the one who provided the example and mentorship necessary to become one of the very few fortunate souls who has the honor to serve as a delegate to the General Service Conference.

I've only addressed my personal exposure and experiences with "Passing It On Through Sponsorship" thus far. I did so because experience is our best teacher, bringing deep meaning and eventual relevance to the words contained in our literature or spoken by those who came before us. Without those experiences, the words are largely theoretical. Our experiences make those words tangible.

Our "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" pamphlet is probably our definitive word on this topic. In it, on pages 14-15, is the section titled "What does a sponsor do?" and begins with this: "A sponsor does everything possible, within the limits of personal experience and knowledge, to help the newcomer get and stay sober through the A.A. program." While that quote seems to concentrate on our First Legacy, Recovery, the follow-on bullet points suggest that even in the beginning of a newcomer's journey we, as sponsors, have an obligation and responsibility to plant the seeds for our other two Legacies, Unity and Service.

One point suggests that we urge the newcomer to join in group activities as soon as possible. For me that meant becoming the group's coffee maker. (Actually, I did that for what seemed like a very long period before getting sober, but that is a story in itself.) Another aspect to the point of joining in on group activities was my first sponsor recommending that I pick a home group and then attend that group's business/group conscience meeting. Since I was making coffee anyway, you can tell how much thought and effort went into selecting a home group.

Another point suggests we impress upon the newcomer the importance of all our Traditions. Early on, I was unable to see how our Traditions played any part in getting or staying sober. Today, I can confidently state if our Third Tradition said "The only requirement for membership is sobriety" that I not only would not have been making coffee at my home group, it might have been a much longer period of time before I got sober. I don't know if there was a group conscience on my continuing to make coffee even though I was still drinking, but I do know my sponsor just kept telling me to "Keep Coming Back," which I did until I had an honest desire to stop drinking.

One last point from this pamphlet, we are advised as sponsors to "...give the newcomer some scope of A.A. beyond the group, and directs attention to A.A. literature about the history of the Fellowship, the Three Legacies, the service structure, and the worldwide availability of A.A.—wherever the newcomer may go." At different junctures, the three sponsors I mentioned provided exposure to all three legacies and the many facets of our wonderful program. The vast majority of what I was told and shown by them has held true throughout the years. I can only hope that I can strive to be as good a steward of A.A. for those that I sponsor as those that sponsored, and continue to sponsor, me. The closing of our essay on the Ninth Concept, (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 40)

states: "Every sponsor is necessarily a leader. The stakes are about as big as they could be. A human life and usually the happiness of a whole family hang in the balance." I offer that as sponsors, whether recovery or service, after our newcomers begin to overcome the fatality of destructive drinking and start their sobriety journey, the lifeblood of A.A. then hangs in the balance. We owe it to our sponsees and to the society of Alcoholics Anonymous to sponsor them into all Three Legacies—Recovery, Unity and Service—through our Steps, Traditions and Concepts, so that what we have been given freely by our sponsors is passed along to those that we sponsor.

I consider myself very fortunate to have sponsors who, in their own way, communicated our legacies through their examples to me. I am blessed to have that experience, and I hope the God of your understanding continues to bless and keep you.

Scott Gilkerson, Virginia

FINANCE REPORT

Monday afternoon, the Finance report, followed by questions and sharing, was given by David Morris, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. Slides referenced in this report are not included in this publication, but are available upon request. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.

Good afternoon. My name is David Morris and I am a Class A trustee and treasurer of the General Service Board. It is my privilege to deliver the treasurer's report to the 64th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous or, as it is more commonly referred to, "Finance Around the Picnic Table," the phrase coined at the 59th Conference.

That phrase means that much of the finance discussion during Conference is "preaching to the choir." But what we really need is better communications about finance when members talk around the euphemistic picnic table before and after meetings. Communication is the key. And although our finances have grown more complex, remember that Corporate Poverty is more a state of mind than the size of our bank account. "Too much — and we argue over perilous wealth and lose sight of our primary purpose of carrying the message. Too little — and we risk losing the ability to carry the message at all."

As this agenda indicates, we will review the Fellowships' self-support efforts; the service activities of the General Service Office; the publishing activities of A.A. World Services, A.A. Grapevine and La Viña; the Pension Plan Obligation; and the Reserve Fund. During the next few minutes, we will discuss 2013 actual results compared to 2012 actual results, 2013 actual results compared to 2013 budget, take a look at the 2014 budgets, and discuss thoughts for 2015 and beyond.

As I complete my first year of being your treasurer, I can very truthfully say that A.A.'s financial summary of operations are indeed much more complex and interrelated than I would have ever imagined when I became a trustee last July. During my steep learning curve, I had to break down all of A.A.'s operations into small manageable pieces to understand them and that is the approach I have taken in this revamped finance presentation. Because of this, a number of 2012 and 2011 amounts have been restated or revised to ensure com-

parability with 2013. Hopefully, this will simplify and take some of the mystery and complexity out of it, thus making it easier for you to convey the key concepts to the Fellowship.

We will focus on thirteen key numbers in 2013 shown on this slide:

Self-support contributions — \$6,906,371
G.S.O. general fund total expenses — \$9,507,582
G.S.O. general fund loss — \$2,601,097
AAWS net sales — \$12,604,719
AAWS net income — \$2,632,651
Grapevine net sales — \$3,019,339
Grapevine net income — \$315,205
La Viña net sales — \$127,270
La Viña net shortfall — \$142,544
Reserve Fund — \$15,301,653
Coverage ratio — 10.9 months
Net income from operations — \$204,215 and \$293,629

While on this slide, if we combine the G.S.O. General Fund Loss of \$2,601,097 with the A.A.W.S. publishing profit of \$2,632,651, we get \$31,554. This is net profit Gary Lutz disclosed in his A.A.W.S. report.

However, if I fail in my mission, then Don Meurer, chief financial officer of the General Service Office, Eugene O'Brien, Grapevine controller, and I will be available throughout the week for you to ask any questions. Our goal is to help you become familiar with our financial position so that you can communicate clearly to your areas. Enhancing your understanding of our finances is one sure way to improve the service structure. Your areas will be listening carefully to what you report after the Conference, so let us know what we can do to enhance that.

Slide 3 shows that the actual combined financial results were a profit of \$204,215 in 2013 compared to the 2013 budgeted loss of \$726,340. This marked improvement of \$930,555 is due to increased self-support and improved publishing results in both A.A.W.S. and Grapevine, when compared to budget. Let's now delve into the details.

Slide 4 — Many of our conversations this week will emphasize the importance of the Seventh Tradition and self-support.

Slide 5 shows that the General Service Board received contributions of \$6,906,371 in 2013, an increase of approximately \$348,763, or 5.3 % greater than 2012. The 2013 actual contributions received were \$209,371, or 3.1 % above 2013 budget. In fact, December contributions of \$850,000 were the best month in the history of A.A. The \$6,906,371 is one of the key numbers that I highlighted on Slide 2.

Slide 6 shows the 30-year history of the dollar contributions, the blue bars on the slide, and the percentage of groups that contribute to G.S.O., the line with square boxes running across the slide with the percentages on the right side. For 2013, the per-



centage is 42.5%. The good news on this slide is that it does show that the actual dollar contributions continue their upward growth. However, the bad news is that the proportion of contributing groups continues to be at the all-time low of about 42.5%.

Slide 7 is a bar chart of only the percentage of groups contributing to G.S.O., with the 42.5% for 2013.

Slide 8 — As you are aware, first the trustees' Finance Subcommittee on Self-Support, and then A.A.W.S. Finance Subcommittee on Self-Support, have worked diligently during the past several years towards a goal of ensuring sustainable self-support initiatives. With the possibility that our print media sales might decline in the future, it is vital that our Fellowship embrace the Seventh Tradition. Delegates, other trusted servants and G.S.O. staff have offered many creative and practical ways to communicate the message of self-support, and we are grateful for everyone's participation. One of the most popular has been the restoration of our November Gratitude Month and focus on the use of our Birthday Envelopes. Additional work is being done by A.A.W.S. on the Green Card. The answer to self-support may very well be in sustained communication — and it is here where we continue to need your suggestions.

We are grateful for every member who contributes to his or her local group as a portion of those monies do work their way to G.S.O., helping ensure that G.S.O. has the necessary resources to continue providing the services that our members and groups, as well as translations and assistance to countries around the globe, seek and need. A special word of thanks to all the delegates, D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s who have worked to help make this strong result possible. I hope information from this Conference will help to assist in your communication about self-support around the picnic table.

Slides 9 & 10 illustrate how the value of the dollar has changed from the early days of A.A. up to modern times. If someone supported A.A.'s services with a dollar in 1945, they would now need to contribute \$13.00 today.

Think about this—what does it cost today to support those same services from an earlier time? Another way to think about this: what was the price of a drink when you stopped drinking and what is it today? So remember, "A dollar ain't what it used to be."

Slide 12 summarizes the direct cost of each of the major service functions performed at the General Service Office. We are all familiar with the functions listed, from Public Information, Corrections, Archives, to name just a few, with the possible exception of the last caption entitled Supporting Services. This includes the

administrative, accounting, human resources, information technology, rent, and other indirect overhead costs. It would not be possible for the major service functions listed to operate without this support structure. The total cost of all G.S.O. service functions in 2013 was \$9,507,582, which was \$253,451, or 2.7% more than in 2012. Most of the functional cost centers are essentially even or flat from 2013 to 2012, but I will highlight a few differences. In 2013, the General Service Conference was held in midtown New York City compared to at Rye Brook, New York in 2012. In 2012, we had the World Service Meeting (also at Rye Brook, New York), and the net cost, which falls to G.S.O., was \$212,502. There is no comparative cost in 2013.

Slide 13 is a bar graph of selected major service functions and their 2013 costs for those of you who like pictures over numbers.

Slide 14 is similar to the prior direct cost slide, except that the costs of Supporting Services, for example, \$3,113,470 in 2013, have been allocated back across the service functions to determine the fully absorbed cost of each activity. The 2013 direct costs of Group Service were \$2,454,030, but were increased to \$3,648,966, when they were allocated an additional \$1,194,936, equaling 38.4% of their share of Supporting Services. By the way, the \$9,507,582 in 2013 is one of the key numbers that I highlighted on Slide 2.

Slide 15 breaks down the first line on the preceding slide entitled Group Service (fully allocated) into its component services. This slide provides a broader understanding of the extraordinary range of services performed by your G.S.O. on behalf of all of the groups across the U.S. and Canada. A complete list of activities is available on the AA.org website.

Slide 16 displays key member statistics. How do we arrive at these numbers? They are simple calculations from the amounts shown on our financial statements on Slide 2 divided by the number of members or groups shown on the Contribution statistical report. And remember, those numbers are only as good as the data we can capture in an Anonymous Fellowship.

Specifically, using the 2013 cost of services provided of \$9,507,582 from an earlier slide, we can calculate cost of services provided is \$6.84 per member or \$146.96 per group. Also, from an earlier slide, we saw that 2013 contributions were \$6,906,371. Again, we can calculate self-support per member of \$4.97 or per group of \$106.75. As can be seen, the costs of services provided are NOT fully covered through self-support. There is a shortfall of \$2,601,097, or \$1.87 per member. This difference of \$6.84 per member less \$4.97 per member is \$1.87 per member. Thus, the shortfall of \$1.87 per member is made up or covered through the use of the \$2,632,651 of literature profits. Another way of thinking about it is that only 72.7% of the cost of services is covered from self-support.

Slide 17 shows the percentage of services supported through contributions in a graphic format, including the 72.7% for 2013.

In concluding on these sections about self-support and the costs of services provided, there are a few things to consider when communicating with the Fellowship. Focus on the spiritual value of contributing with examples of how the contributions get used. Humanize the numbers. If \$9.5 million of G.S.O. services provided seems too large and intimidating, then talk in terms of these costs being \$6.84 per member or \$146.96 per group. Yes, we are fac-



ing some financial challenges, but our service structure is designed to foster responsibility and stability. Members can be confident that its trusted servants are accountable, based on the checks and balances that have been built into the financial structure of staff, accountants, officers, and independent auditors.

Slide 19 Now let us turn to A.A.W.S. publishing activities and its literature profits. This slide summarizes the financial performance of publishing in 2013 compared to 2012. Net sales of literature were \$12,605,109 in 2013, compared to \$12,365,150 for 2012, an increase of \$239,959, or 1.9% more. After deducting the cost of literature sold; costs of shipping and warehousing; program expenses; and supporting expenses, A.A.W.S. publishing had an Excess of Revenue Over Expenses of \$2,632,651, compared to \$2,848,895 for 2012, a decrease of \$216,244, or 7.6% less. This decrease is the combination of an increase in publishing revenue of \$231,416, offset by larger cost of services provided of \$447,660.

Remember, this excess of literature profits is what is used to offset the cost of G.S.O. services provided not covered through self-support or the \$2,601,097 in 2013 shown on Slide 2. Also, the \$12,604,719 and the \$2,632,651 are two of the key numbers that I highlighted on Slide 2.

Slide 20 summarizes the financial performance of publishing in 2013 compared to 2013 budget. Net sales of literature were \$12,605,109 in 2013, compared to \$12,540,400 in the 2013 budget, an increase of \$64,709, or 0.5% more. After deducting the cost of literature sold; costs of shipping and warehousing; program expenses; and supporting expenses, A.A.W.S. publishing had an Excess of Revenue Over Expenses of \$2,632,651, compared to \$2,394,678 in the 2013 budget, an increase of \$237,973, or 9.9% more. This is due primarily to savings in the cost of producing the literature sold; shipping and warehouse savings; and operating expenses, when compared to budget. Again, the \$12,604,719 and \$2,632,651 are two of the key numbers that I highlighted on Slide 2.

Slide 21 provides the principle literature titles sold both in units and dollars in 2013 and 2012. The two fascinating points of this slide: first, besides the sheer number of Big Books and the other titles listed that continue to be sold each year, is the information included in the footnotes, 68 translations of the Big Book with 17 pending, along with publications in 93 languages. Second, the size of the contribution of Big Book sales to total publishing revenue, 47% from a single source.

Slide 22 shows the Big Book sales during the last two decades.

Slide 23 is the self-support and literature policy formally adopted by the General Service Board at its February 3, 2014 meeting.

Slide 24 summarizes the 2014 budget of A.A.W.S. publishing activities compared to 2013 actual results. Net sales of literature in 2014 are projected to increase by \$2,101,281 due to the publication of the 75th Commemorative Anniversary edition of the Big Book and an October 1, 2014 literature price increase. After deducting out the usual costs, this translates into an increase in Excess of Revenue Over Expenses of \$769,228 to \$3,401,879 in 2014, compared to 2013 actual results.

Slide 25 — Let's move to A.A. Grapevine.

Slide 26 — Grapevine reported total magazine income of \$2,242,363 in 2013, compared to \$2,342,910 in 2012, a decrease of \$100,547, or 4.3% less. The decline in magazine income mirrors the continued decline in both print and online subscriptions, which is shown at the top of the slide. On the positive side, other publishing income was \$776,976 in 2013, an increase of \$71,666, or 10.1%, compared to \$705,310 in 2012.

When we subtract the cost of goods sold and delivery costs, along with the three operating expenses listed, this results in

\$315,205 of Excess of Revenue Over Expenses in 2013. This compares to \$257,003 for 2012, an increase of \$58,202, or 22.6% more. This increase is due to the very positive results achieved in other publishing activities and cost savings generated in general and administrative expenses.

While on the subject of costs, GV has streamlined its operations and has reduced all costs and expenses by over \$500,000 since 2010. An excellent result to help offset the decline in magazine subscriptions.

Finally, if you add magazine income of \$2,242,363 and the other publishing income of \$776,976, these two numbers equal \$3,019,339, which is one of the key numbers that I highlighted on Slide 2. The other Grapevine number on this slide and Slide 2 is the Excess of Revenue Over Expenses of \$315,205.

Slide 27 summarizes the financial performance of publishing in 2013 compared to the 2013 budget. Total gross profit in 2013 was \$1,993,516, up \$173,657 from a budgeted amount of \$1,819,859, or 9.5% more. After deducting costs and expenses, Grapevine had an excess of revenue over expenses of \$315,205, compared to \$11,954 in the 2013 budget, an increase of \$303,251. This is due primarily to previously mentioned \$173,657 of additional revenue and \$135,394 of savings in operating expenses, when compared to budget.

Slide 28 displays the 40-year trend of subscriptions showing the continuous long-term downward trend since 1989.

Slide 29 provides the principle titles of Grapevine's other publishing income and illustrates how publishing of *The Language of the Heart* and other titles has contributed significantly to Grapevine's continued viability by offsetting the continuing decline in magazines subscriptions.

Slide 30 sets forth the 2014 budget compared to 2013 actual results. It continues to show a nearly 5% decline in the basic GV subscriptions, which is offset by continued strong other publishing income. Net magazine revenues are down by \$95,571. When this decline in revenue is combined with increased operating costs, it results in GV's net Excess of Revenue Over Expenses of \$315,205 in 2013 declining to \$94,232 in the 2014 budget, a decrease of \$220,973.

Slide 31 shows the financial results of our Spanish-language magazine La Viña. While there have been and continue to be many discussions and subcommittees over how best to convey the La Viña results to the Fellowship, this slide shows the results consistent with prior years. A new subcommittee of the trustees' Finance Committee has been established by me, with trustee Clayton Vandivort from the Southwest region as the chair, to examine this reporting issue. Even before these efforts are completed, I have decided to revise the way La Viña's results are reported. Instead of being called a "net loss," it will now be called "shortfall between revenue and expense."

Gross profit from the sale of magazines and related items was \$63,534, a decrease of \$1,931 from 2012. After deducting the costs and expenses of \$206,078, the result was a net shortfall between revenue and expenses of \$142,544. This compares to similar shortfalls of \$115,820 in 2012 and \$69,723 in 2011. On the positive side, the upward movement in subscriptions to 10,145 in 2013 continued. Nevertheless, in 2014, a net shortfall of \$141,575 has been budgeted. Remember that La Viña's net shortfall is paid from the General Fund, which houses all contributions received from the Fellowship. This \$141,000 equates to 10 cents per member.

Slide 32 shows the subscription history of the La Viña since 1997.

Slide 33 shows the annual shortfall between revenue and expenses again from 1995 to now that have either been funded from the Reserve Fund during the first five years or since then

from the General Fund. The total of such losses is nearly \$1.7 million. To our Spanish-speaking members, please support this very valuable tool.

Slide 34 — As you are aware, the Moving Ahead for Progress in the 21st Century Act and admonitions of our Independent Auditors have brought to the forefront of our recent finance discussions the continuing need to focus on our long-term obligations for post-employment commitments to current employees and retirees, for both pension and postretirement medical benefits. Our benefit plans should be periodically reviewed, but remember that as long as G.S.O. remains in business, pension benefits, which have already accrued cannot be changed.

This slide shows the long-term liabilities or obligations, assets in trust fund these liabilities and net unfunded status of our pension and retiree medical plans. The net exposure decreased from \$14.3 million at December 31, 2012 to \$6.6 million at December 31, 2013, with the majority of the improvement being in the pension plan. This improvement that occurred in 2013 was the result of the interest rate used to discount the pension plan obligations or liabilities increasing from 3.88% at December 31, 2012 to 4.76% at December 31, 2013. In addition, the positive upward trend of the stock markets translated into pension plan assets growing \$3.6 million, or 18%, in 2013 beyond contributions made by A.A.

By way of background, A.A. established in 1965 a Defined Benefit Pension Program for its employees. Last year we reported that a subcommittee of the General Service Board was formed in late 2011. Their objective was to coordinate the review and selection of pension plan options for transitioning from a Defined Benefit Plan to a Defined Contribution Plan for new A.A.W.S. and G.V. employees. This has been accomplished with a new Defined Contribution Plan established January 1, 2013 for new employees hired subsequent to January 1, 2013. Over the very long-term, this change will have the effect of capping the pension plan obligations and over time reducing the ongoing cost. These obligations are funded out of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine current operations and now account for about 12% of the G.S.O. operating expense budget.

Slide 35 outlines some of the various rules and regulations that A.A.'s pension plans are subject to and that have to be considered annually.

Slide 36 provides details of the size and complexion of the defined benefit plan showing the number of employees and retirees covered, along with the related costs and benefits payable.

Slide 37 is solely for the true accountants and actuaries in the audience. First, it shows the magnitude of the amounts involved and, second, it reconciles the "ins and outs" of the pension plan obligations or liabilities at the top of the slide and the pension plan assets at the bottom of the slide to what was previously shown three slides earlier. Its true purpose is to illustrate the extreme volatility of numbers that goes into determining the annual pension expense. Primarily due to the increase in the discount rate from 3.88% to 4.76% during 2013, actuarial gains were \$3,054,213, resulting in a significant reduction in the projected benefit obligations or liabilities. In addition, the positive upward movement of the stock market in 2013 resulted in an annual investment gain of \$3,564,880, or 18% growth. The combination of these two items resulted in the reduction in the unfunded status from \$10,368,723 in 2012 to \$3,568,738 in 2013.

Nevertheless, despite this improvement, based on the information on this slide and the previous ones showing our annual benefit payment obligations, and after considerable analysis by both A.A.W.S. Finance and trustees' Finance, and discussions with our advisors, the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Commit-

tee recommended to the General Services Board that \$1,500,000 be transferred from the Reserve Fund to the Pension Plan Asset Fund to further address the long-term exposure cited by our Independent Auditors. The added benefit of this transfer is that the annual cash funding expense required under the various U.S. Pension regulations can be reduced from a \$2,100,000 expense in 2013 to a \$1,500,000 expense in 2014 and going forward all other things being constant. This savings has been reflected in the 2014 budgets that have been on the various slides previously presented to you today.

Slide 38 shows Reserve Fund.

Slide 39 shows the relationship between the Fellowship, G.S.O. and the Reserve Fund. To pay its bills and fund obligations, the General Service Office has only two sources of money: contributions and literature sales. At the end of each year, any cash more than necessary to pay bills on time is transferred to the Reserve Fund. Historically, G.S.O. has relied on literature sales to help balance the budget.

Slide 40 shows the relationship between the Fellowship, Grapevine and the Reserve Fund. To pay its bills and fund obligations, Grapevine has only two sources of money: subscriptions and literature sales. At the end of each year, any cash more than is necessary to pay bills on time is transferred to the Reserve Fund. As a matter of fact, early in 2014, Grapevine transferred \$260,000 from its operating accounts to the Reserve Fund, based on the positive results for 2013 of \$315,205 and a 2014 budget of \$94,232. The last time that Grapevine had such positive operating results and was in a position to make a transfer was in 2006. This 2014 transfer does help to partially offset the \$588,000 transferred from the Reserve Fund to Grapevine in 2010.

Slide 41 summarizes the investment guidelines of the Reserve Fund and shows the balance and annual interest earned. These guidelines severely limit the types of eligible investments, resulting in a rate of return for both 2013 and 2012 that was less than 1.0%.

Slide 42 covers the General Service Board Reserve Fund. The Reserve Fund ended 2013 with a balance of \$15,301,653, equal to approximately 10.9 months of operating expenses of \$16,879,552. You may recall a Conference Advisory Action that the Reserve Fund not exceed 12 months of operating expenses.

Given the effect of the transfer out of \$1,500,000 to the Pension Plan and the inflow of the Grapevine's contribution of \$260,000, the adjusted Reserve Fund balance would be \$14,061,653, which translates into a reserve coverage ratio of 10.0 months. The 2014 budget projects the ratio will be 9.4 months at December 31, 2014.

Finally, our Independent Auditors have affirmed that the Reserve Fund is in fact adequate for the short-term obligations for which it was intended, and is now also adequate with respect to our long-term obligations.

Slide 43 provides a number of actions that have been taken over the last decade to maintain the Reserve Fund within an acceptable range between 9 and 12 months. Big Book prices were reduced \$1 with publication of the 4th Edition, then restored in 2004; selected book prices and handling charges were raised in 2005; both A.A.W.S. and Grapevine implemented price increases in 2009 and 2014 will have the Pension Plan transfer and the literature price increases commencing in October 2014.

Slide 44 is a summary of some of the key assumptions included in how the 2014 budget numbers included in all of the previous slides were arrived at.

Slide 45 provides information on the 2015 International Convention in Atlanta, with comparisons to the prior three. The General Service Board approved both the overall budget and per person registration fees at its February 3, 2014 meeting.

Slide 46 repeats the 2013 results and includes the combined 2014 budgets, which projects a combined 2014 profit of \$248,101. This amount is composed of A.A.W.S. budgeted profit of \$295,444, Grapevine budgeted profit of \$94,232, and La Vigne budgeted shortfall of \$141,575.

In conclusion, both the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee and your General Service Board continues to monitor financial budgets, estimates and projections, always with an eye towards fiscal prudence. 2014 and future years will undoubtedly be marked with some uncertainty and perhaps some surprises due to the continuing volatile economic times. However, based on the actions both taken and proposed, the operating organizations, Reserve Fund and the outlook remains positive.

Slide 47 — I am pleased to acknowledge the extraordinary talent and dedication that I am privileged to observe as treasurer. Thank you to members of all the finance committees of the operating organization who sort through enormous details throughout the year. Thank you to Phyllis Halliday and Ami Brophy for competently overseeing our operating corporations. And a very special thank you to Don Meurer and Eugene O'Brien, our talented and dedicated finance managers. Likewise, a special thanks to our Independent Auditors, who do an extraordinary job, always exhibiting professionalism and independence. The information included in my slides will be contained in the complete report of our Independent Auditors that will be included in the Final Conference Report.

And remember, Finance has no importance in and of itself. Finance is simply a way to help carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.

David Morris, Treasurer, General Service Board

LA VIGNE

Monday evening's Presentation on La Vigne, A.A.'s French-language magazine, was accompanied by a PowerPoint presentation.

My name is Donald and I am an alcoholic, I also have the privilege of serving as the Eastern Canada regional trustee. Being a trustee on the General Service Board, I have also been serving as director on the La Vigne Board for the last four years, as did the Eastern Canada regional trustees before me.

La Vigne is a bimonthly French magazine, a printed meeting made by A.A. members for A.A. members. In 1965 La Vigne A.A. produced its first issue, with a sharing by Bill W. on the Twelve Steps, and an article by Dave B., the founder of A.A. in Quebec, on Fear Control.

Here is the letter from Bill W., published in the first issue:

Dear Friends:

With this, please have my deepest gratitude for all of the magnificent progress that has been made among you in years past, you who are the well-loved French-speaking A.A.s of our Fellowship.

In particular, I specially wish to congratulate you upon the beginning of publication of a digest of the A.A. Grapevine in the French language. Not only is the Grapevine a world forum for A.A., it is also a sort of magic carpet on which the reader can travel to distant places and so communicate with new friends and fresh ideas in every quarter of the globe.

Then, too, I know that each new issue will be for you a labor of love, from which your entire membership will harvest a host of blessings.

Most affectionately yours, Bill

La Vigne will be celebrating 50 years in 2015. Its primary purpose is to allow A.A. members to share their experience in recovery. Hence, the major part of the magazine is made up of recovery stories. Its production, distribution and administration lies entirely with A.A. groups from Quebec's four areas. We have subscribers from Europe, Africa, Asia, USA and, of course, other Canadian provinces.

The Board of Trustees of La Vigne is composed of nine directors, consisting of the four delegates of Quebec, the Eastern Canada regional trustee, the secretary, the chief editor, the treasurer, and the shipping manager. The chairman is always a delegate elected every year. There are four La Vigne Area representatives (RLVR) that participate in the discussions. The administrative assistant and the alternate delegates may attend the meeting as observers.

A bit of history: In 1959, a member asked if we could have a French version of the Grapevine. 1962: The first prototype is brought to the Conference and presented to Bill W. who said: "You should go ahead with this project." 1965: Volume 1, No.1, April-May, is published. 2,000 copies were printed. 1974: A committee responsible for the magazine is formed. 1985: The International Convention is held in Montreal. A.A. celebrates its 50th anniversary, and La Vigne, its 20th. A special 192-page edition is printed and 6,000 copies are sold. 2005: A 400-page edition is published to celebrate La Vigne's 40th anniversary. It includes articles from each and every issue ever published. More than 12,000 copies are sold.

La Vigne: Is it really A.A.? Our magazine is not "Conference-approved." However, all the work, production and distribution, as well as all the contents, are made by or come from A.A. members.

Furthermore, Les Éditions de La Vigne's charter specifies that: Les Éditions de La Vigne is responsible for producing, publishing and distributing, by sale or otherwise, the magazine La Vigne A.A. to actual or potential members of Alcoholics Anonymous of French expression. To attain goals, les Éditions de La Vigne constitutes a Board of Administrators whose main responsibility is to see that the principles, Concepts and Traditions of the A.A. Fellowship are followed within the corporation of les Éditions de La Vigne A.A.

In 2011, the Conference expressed its appreciation and gratitude and the following Floor Action recommended that: "The 61st General Service Conference express its appreciation and gratitude for the French-language magazine 'La Vigne,' and the value it has for French-speaking members of Alcoholics Anonymous and the respect 'La Vigne' has shown for the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous."

La Vigne is an up-to-date magazine, which maintains a dynamic website. Read it on your computer, tablet or your cellular phone. It is always contemporary. Yesterday's stories may be as helpful as today's stories. For those on the move or stalled in traffic, there is the audio format. Subscription rates upon request.

Made by volunteer A.A. members from stories submitted by A.A. members, La Vigne is an ideal Twelfth Step tool.

Donald Cusson, Eastern Canada regional trustee

NOTE: Following Donald's informative presentation on La Vigne, Terry Bedient asked Conference members to inform French-speaking members within their areas, districts and groups about La Vigne. Conference members stood in recognition of La Vigne as the French A.A. magazine of our Conference structure and that it might serve French-speaking A.A. members in the U.S. and Canada.

LIVING IN THE HEART OF A.A.

Tuesday afternoon's Presentation/Discussion session was moderated by Marilyn Rodgers, Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador.

Participating in Our Common Welfare Through Contributions

Hi, my name is Sheryl and I am an alcoholic. In March 1996, I was court-ordered into Alcoholics Anonymous; God was doing for me what I could not do for myself. My first three years of A.A., I took from A.A. like only a newcomer or untreated alcoholic could. I remember thinking, "I need to get my life together. I need to get a job, a house, my son back, a car. I need to get my life in order." I started to get some of those things back and I got a little money in my pocket, but I was not willing to share my money or give back to anyone, especially A.A.

I had an impeccable tan, my nails done every two weeks, and nice suits to wear to work. I looked really good on the outside. To the untrained eye, it almost looked like I had been cured of alcoholism. I had the Steps and the Traditions memorized. I was really good at talking the talk. But when the basket would pass, I could or would not contribute. I always had something more important I had to buy. I was sponsoring women, but was not sponsored, and I had not worked the Twelve Steps from our book. I would pass in meetings or sometimes talk for too long on topics I thought were helpful to me, not the newcomer. I was the treasurer of the group, and stealing from the basket of the group that was trying to save me. I would go home at night and I would pray to this God I wasn't sure existed, and I would ask him this one short question: "Please, God, if you are there and love me, please take my life." I could not let my family down one more time. "So I need you to do this for me."

God answered my prayer. He put a woman in my path who introduced me to our program. Before this, I would always say "my" program. She reminded me that we have only one program, and that is the program of Alcoholics Anonymous. She started me on a rigorous program of action. I knew if I did not change, my sobriety date was going to. She started with little suggestions like, "Let's put a dollar in the basket when it comes around"; "Let's share for three minutes on the topic so we can help the newcomer." We talked about our primary purpose in A.A., and that when I am sharing I need to remember to talk about my alcoholism.

We started the Steps out of our book and one day she gently reminded me, "I am glad that you have them memorized. Now let's work them." I continued on with the Steps, and started to learn about our Traditions and then our Concepts. I started to get involved in service work, first at the group level. This time, not just in name only, but to really get involved. I started to attend business meetings and I was excited. I was like a sponge. Then I got involved in the district. I got elected as the C.P.C. chair, and I was on fire. My committee was doing presentations all over the district. I was giving back to A.A. I was sharing our message with whoever would hear it.

I share this message with the women I sponsor today, about the importance of participating in our common welfare through contributions. This is done in many ways, including how I shared with you; sharing in meetings; contributing in the basket; and sitting down with another woman, getting in our book, and sharing our recovery program with them. Participate in the Birthday Plan to G.S.O. on your sobriety birthday. Find a service position at group or district level. Whether it is chairing a meeting, wiping tables, or picking up butts outside, it is about giving back.

It is about participating in your own recovery. My biggest joy today is sitting down with a new gal, opening up our book, and starting with our very first page. I explain our program, the history, the circle and triangle: Recovery, Unity and Service. We read the forewords in the Big Book, "The Doctor's Opinion," and then on through the first 164 pages. We work our Steps right from the book, and we placed our feet on a path that really goes somewhere. I see their eyes light up and their lives start to transform.

I will never be able to repay what has been given to me. But I have been taught how to participate by contributing back what I have been given. My hope for me is that my great blessings never spoil me. Thank you so much for my life God, and for leading me to A.A. With Love and Service.

Sheryl Figley, Iowa

Inventory — A Guiding Tool to Our Future

I want to thank you for this loving invitation to participate in the 64th General Service Conference to present on the topic "Inventory—A Guiding Tool to Our Future," while keeping in mind the Conference theme "Communicating Our Legacies—Vital in a Changing World." The early members of our Fellowship gave us a great gift when they solidified our release from the alcohol obsession by publishing our book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in 1939. From *The Language of the Heart* (p. 21), having attained this goal we em-



barked on “seven years of [gaining] vast experience with our next great undertaking—the problem of living and working together [and with the world around us]. This is today our main concern. If we can succeed in this adventure—and keep succeeding—then, and only then, will our future be secure.” Self-assessment through inventory is a tool that can provide insight into the specific actions we need to consider. Each of us tackles this personally when we put the Twelve Steps of recovery into action in our own lives. I have learned much about my character defects of pride, sensitivity and procrastination, to name a few, by practicing them in the light of day inside and outside the fellowship.

The first ever General Service Conference Inventory is underway and this week all of us will participate in the second of a three-year process. In reviewing the 2013 *Final Conference Report*, I found that the inventory has already provided insightful recommendations and suggestions to enhance and change the Conference process in the areas of effective communication, leadership, and increased Fellowship participation. Since I began serving as a Panel 63 delegate it has become a saying of mine that I am just the guy wearing the (delegate) shoes right now. That idea comes to life for me when I realize I am blessed to be a small part of this inventory process, as I get to participate in the first two years and then new trusted servants, whom I have never met, will see it through to the end.

I would like to share one example of how inventory and action may help the future of Alcoholics Anonymous, especially with what I see as an area of concern, our Fellowship’s potentially divisive ideas on singleness of purpose. As an A.A. member and delegate, I have participated and listened to many members discuss singleness of purpose at my home group, district, and area meetings. I have come to the conclusion that we have a lack of unity regarding our single purpose. Searching for historical experience and solutions I located a 1957 Bill W. talk on singleness of purpose. In addition, the pamphlet “Problems Other Than Alcohol” (P-35) as well as several A.A. Grapevine archival articles provide strong reasons for why the Fellowship should stand on this principal in unity. Early members of our Fellowship wanted to share a focused message with hopeless alcoholics. However, then they became aware that our solution might be beneficial to others. In Bill W.’s 1957 talk he shares about how dually addicted A.A. members felt compelled to start carrying the message of recovery to addicts. These alcoholics, who were also addicts, understood the pure addict’s agony, and naturally wanted to provide them with a solution. Some dually addicted A.A. members wanted to invite the pure straight addicts to A.A. meetings and bring them into full membership. Bill asked the questions; are we going to take on all of the world’s problems, and can anyone with a problem join Alcoholics Anonymous? No, he answers. We decided long ago that A.A. is for drunks.

He continues sharing an idea of a possible better solution. Could these A.A. members invite the pure addicts to open A.A. meetings to learn about the principles of recovery, with the intention for them to start their own groups? This could be more helpful instead of having them stay and believe they are A.A. members. Bill shared that he did not see how we, as a Fellowship, could go any further than this. This is an example of how we can take inventory and learn from past experience. Using the tool of inventory, should we determine if Alcoholics Anonymous is off track with practicing our Fellowship’s singleness of purpose? Do our current actions, public relations policies, and messages to newcomers

help or hinder our common welfare and legacy of unity? Is there something we need to change? It is my hope that we as a Fellowship do not let dissension creep up on us as it has for other fellowships in the past.

From a different vantage point, I will share about some personal attempts to introduce new and effective communication tactics in our area while serving as a delegate. Several past delegates shared with me that the best thing a new delegate can do is take what they had learned and implement and improve upon it. This is certainly an example of the spirit of the inventory process. Page S48 of *The A.A. Service Manual* states one of the delegate’s duties is to “communicate the actions of the conference.” I decided to focus a section of my quarterly delegate report to the area on the importance of communication flowing up and down the general service structure. Lynda B., a current A.A. Grapevine director, stated in a presentation that she believed that communication through our existing service structure stopped at the area level, where it then becomes two entities: the Conference and the area. How effectively is the General Service Conference information being collected and reported to the groups in each area? Does the age-old excuse that “My group doesn’t care or want to hear about that service business and politics” stand in the way of disseminating the information? If a group is unwilling to listen to an oral report, in what other ways can information be provided? Our area implemented several new communication ideas over the past year. First, area officers, standing committee chairs, and district committee members attempted to attend our Spanish inter-district meetings. One member commented that this is the way it should be, no Spanish or English members, just Alcoholics Anonymous members. This idea never really took off, but it was attempted. Second, every delegate is faced with the dilemma of how to obtain the area’s collective group conscience on the Conference agenda items. Area 67 implemented an idea from Area 6 in California to summarize the agenda items and background material into a report, coupled with the provision of a response template for members to provide feedback to the delegate.

Since effective communication is the keystone of our general service structure, I am grateful the three-year General Service Conference Inventory is affording our Fellowship the opportunity to discuss new suggestions to ensure that information flows up and down the service structure. Learning from past experience will grant us vision for tomorrow.

Patrick Claymore, Southeast Texas

THE A.A. GRAPEVINE — 70 YEARS

Following a coffee break Tuesday afternoon a PowerPoint presentation on the A.A. Grapevine was moderated by Albin Zezula, general service trustee.



This year the A.A. Grapevine celebrates 70 years of carrying the A.A. message. To commemorate the anniversary a PowerPoint presentation was presented by Ami Brophy, Grapevine’s executive editor/publisher.

The PowerPoint presentation may be viewed until the end of 2014 on aagrapevine.org/gv70 or contact the Grapevine office to receive a copy.

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE ARCHIVES

Wednesday afternoon G.S.O.'s Archivist gave a PowerPoint presentation on the history of the Big Book. Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O.'s general manager, was the moderator.

It is a privilege for me to serve as your Archivist, and it is my pleasure and good fortune to speak with you today and celebrate the 75th anniversary of the first edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*. This is a milestone in the life of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous, and in a world where other organizations come and disappear in a flash, 75 years is indeed a long time.

Before I begin, I would like to welcome the new Panel 64 delegates to New York and hope that you will all feel free to use G.S.O.'s archives as a valuable resource. Secondly, I would like publicly to commend the Archives staff for their commitment in helping to fulfill the Archives mission, as well as for their professionalism and effort in sharing the Fellowship's history with A.A. members and the scholarly public around the world.

Archival collections are vital because they capture historic evidence and provide unique testimony to the life and achievements of any organization's past, while remaining neutral to political or religious schism. Without archives, we wouldn't have a record of temperatures, we wouldn't know about the lives of significant individuals, of how early civilization existed and perished or, in our own lives, a sense of heritage. Without being consciously aware of it, many people benefit from archives. The Archives of the General Service Office ensures the retention and long-term availability of A.A.'s historical and business records. The latter records constitute evidence of the corporations' functions, policies, decisions, and other activities. At the same time, it is imperative that we not work in isolation. We support the work of local area and district archivists, who embark on a number of initiatives and face challenges and problems in gathering A.A. archives and history. Let's continue to work collaboratively to assist them to achieve their mission because they serve Alcoholics Anonymous, which not only benefits our A.A. community but the information profession as a whole.

Bill W. loved to spin "yarns" about A.A.'s rocky beginnings. His stories are preserved in the Archives in writings and speeches. The series of events leading to the publication of *Alcoholics Anonymous* started, in Bill's own words, "in the living room of Doc and Annie Smith" on a Fall afternoon in 1937. From Lois's diary, another primary resource, we read that Bill W. actually left for Akron on Saturday October 9, along with Bill R., an early member, and his wife in their car. From a talk that he gave at the Texas State Convention in June 1954, Bill recalled how it all happened: "Smithy and I were talking together in his living room, Anne sitting there, when we began to count noses. How many people had stayed dry; in Akron, in New York, maybe a few in Cleveland? How many had stayed dry and for how long? And when we added up the total, it sure was a handful of, I don't know, 35, 40 maybe. But enough time had elapsed on enough really fatal cases of alcoholism, so that we grasped the importance of small statistics. Bob and I saw for the first time that this thing was going to succeed.... How could this handful carry its message to all those who still didn't know?"

Bill, Dr. Bob and the handful of Akron members excitedly discussed the prospect of building missions, hospitals and perhaps publishing a book. Bill, being the Wall Street guy, foresaw great sums of money to be made, but the projects needed to be financed. As the story goes, Bill returned to New York and sold the idea of raising millions to the New York members, who showed more enthusiasm than the folks in Akron. Together with Hank P., who was formerly an executive in the oil industry, the two began to canvas the rich for money. However, and in Bill's own words:

"We thought that we were wonderful salesmen, but we couldn't make even a dent. Not a cent was raised."

Most of us are familiar with the story about the meeting of Bill, Dr. Bob and a few others at the Rockefeller office on Monday, December 13, 1937. He hoped that the philanthropist John D. Rockefeller would provide the money to finance the venture. The series of events following the meeting with Mr. Rockefeller marked a momentous turning point in A.A.'s destiny. The beginning of A.A.'s principle of self-support took root at that time. Reflecting on this meeting some years later, Bill remarked, "On what slender threads our destiny sometimes hangs." Let's listen to Bill as he tells this segment of the story:

[Audio Recording] "Mr. Rockefeller read the report, called Willard Richardson back and he said, 'Somehow I am strangely stirred by all this. This interests me immensely.' And then looking at his friend Willard, he said, 'But isn't money going to spoil this thing? I'm terribly afraid that it would and yet I'm so strangely stirred by it.' Then came another turning point in our destiny when that man whose business is giving away money said to Willard Richardson 'No,' he said 'I won't be the one to spoil this with money. You say these two men who are heading it are a little strapped? I'll put \$5,000 dollars in the Riverside Church treasury. You folks can form yourself into a committee and draw on it as you like. But, please don't ask me for any more. But I want to hear what goes on.' Well the \$50,000 is then shrunk to five. We raised the mortgage on Smithy's house for about three grand that left two and Smithy and I commenced chawing on that two. Well, that was a long way from a string of our drunk tank, books, missionary. What, in thunder, would we do? Well, we had more meetings with our new-found friends, Amos, Richardson, Scott, Chipman, and those fellows who stuck with us to this day, some of them now being gone. And in spite of Mr. Rockefeller's advice, we again convinced these folks that this thing needed a lot of money. What could you do without it? So, one of them proposed, 'Well, why don't we form a Foundation, something like the Rockefeller Foundation?' 'Well,' I said, 'I hope it will be like that with respect to money.' And then one of them got a free lawyer from [name of firm inaudible] firm who was interested in the thing. And we all asked him to draw up an agreement of trust, a charter for something to be called the Alcoholic Foundation. Why we picked that one, I don't know. I don't know whether the Foundation was alcoholic, it was the Alcoholic Foundation, not the Alcoholics Foundation, no. And the lawyer was very much confused because in the meeting in which we formed the foundation, we made it very plain that we drunks did not wish to be in the majority. We felt that there should be nonalcoholics on the board and they ought to be in a majority of one. 'Well, indeed,' said the lawyer, 'what is the difference between an alcoholic and a nonalcoholic?' And one of our smart drunks said, 'Well, that's a cinch. A nonalcoholic is a guy who can drink and an alcoholic is a guy who can't drink.' 'Well' said the lawyer, 'how do we state that legally? I wouldn't know.' So at length, we had a Foundation and a board which I think then was of about seven, consisting of four of these new friends, including my brother-in-law, Mr. Richardson, Chipman, Amos and some of us drunks. I think Smithy went on the board but I kind of coyly stayed off it thinking, well, it would be more convenient later on. So we had this wonderful new foundation. These friends, unlike Mr. Rockefeller, were sold that we needed a lot of dough, and so our salesmen around New York started to solicit the money, again, from the very rich. We had a list of them and we had credentials and letters from friends of Mr. John D. Rockefeller. How could you miss, I ask you, salesmen? The Foundation had been formed in the spring of 1938 and all summer

we solicited the rich. Well, they were either in Florida or they preferred the Red Cross, or some of them thought that drunks were disgusting and we didn't get one damn cent in the whole summer of 1938, praise God!"

This recording is an example of one of the many oral histories preserved in the Archives. The rich, historical narratives create a mosaic of memory; they reveal nuances of past experience for reference in the present and future.

The group conscience, as written in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, "is the collective conscience of the group membership and thus represents substantial unanimity on an issue before definitive action is taken." The practice of this very significant A.A. principle, initiated with the development of the Big Book, firmly holds today. It was demonstrated as early as 1938, when Bill sent copies of the first two chapters he had written, "Bill's Story" and "There Is a Solution," to members of the New York and Akron groups for review. How do you suppose this newly sober and cantankerous bunch of drunks handled the stories? According to Bill, he received "nothing but the warmest support" from Akron but a "real mauling" from the New York members. What Bill called the "backbone of the book" was Chapter 5, "How It Works," which introduced the numbered layout of the Twelve Steps. Before the Twelve Steps were written, there was a verbal program consisting of Six Steps. The chapter though, received a mixed response and in Bill's words: "...the hot debate about the Twelve Steps and the book's contents was doubled and redoubled." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 162)

The group was still penniless, so a pamphlet entitled "Alcoholics Anonymous" was created circa November 1938 and was sent along with the early chapters to procure funds. The proposal, as outlined in the pamphlet, was to form the One Hundred Men Corporation to publish the book provisionally entitled, "One Hundred Men," though the group was already referring to themselves as "Alcoholics Anonymous." As for the name Alcoholics Anonymous, it was described in the Foreword of the pamphlet "as being adopted because of the nature of the work, because of the desire to keep away from notoriety, and because the work is strictly non-sectarian."

The Archives is a treasure-trove of history, where little-known mysteries are still being discovered. For instance, in an early unedited draft of "There Is a Solution," Bill had begun the chapter with a quote from Dr. Carl Jung as follows: "I have never seen one single case in which alcohol-mindedness was established in the sense you have it, that ever recovered." When the chapter was sent to one of the editors, she suggested that "it would have been smoother, to start Chapter 2 [with] 'We, of Alcoholics Anonymous, know one hundred men who were once just as hopeless as Bill.'" For an archivist or historian, this letter is an incredibly valuable primary resource and adds to the uniqueness of A.A.'s Archives. The editor's suggestion focused the narrative on the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous rather than the words of Dr. Jung. It also shows that the manuscript underwent changes and edits and the published book was the work of several individuals.

Finally, on April 10, 1939, the book came off press, but not without much tribulation beforehand and the magnanimous efforts of many. They printed 4,650 copies; the paper was of the thickest there was, bounded in a bright red cloth; the jacket cover was in brilliant red and yellow tones — all intentional — to make it attractive to the purchaser. The book was so bulky that it soon became known as the "Big Book." Bill later encapsulates, in the Foreword to the Second Edition, the essence of the struggles: "It was now time, the struggling groups thought, to place their message and unique experience before the world. This determination bore fruit in the spring of 1939 by the publication of this volume.

The membership had then reached about 100 men and women. The fledgling society, which had been nameless, now began to be called Alcoholics Anonymous, from the title of its own book. The flying-blind period ended a new phase of its pioneering time." Let's listen to Bill as he closes the story:

[Audio Recording] "And before we were through, the stockholders were sending in five bucks a month. We sold shares of the unpublished book to the local drunks, five dollars a month, ten bucks a month to keep things going, then there was a slight embezzlement of funds.

"Well, I would really like to tell you about this book. And finally with the last \$500 we could lay hold of, we went up to the Reader's Digest that promised the piece and we said, 'Boys, we're all ready to shoot.' And the editor that had talked to us once before said, 'Shoot what? Oh, yes, you were the fellows in the Alcohol Society. We were going to do this piece and mention your new book, but we changed our mind after discussions and we forgot to tell you.' And the collapse was very great. We lost the house, the printer, dear man almost took the book, but withheld. We went into a terrific promotion piece. One of the drunks got on the radio with Gabriel Heatter, we put out a shower of 20,000 postal cards to all of the doctors east of the Mississippi River saying buy the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*, sure cure for alcoholism, \$3.50, to listen to Heatter.

"We locked a guy up so he wouldn't get drunk. He appeared on Heatter's program, the market in A.A. had gone because all the people who wrote stories had got a free book and all of those who had bought stock, they got a free book, but now we can see the books going out in carloads. And we went down to the post office after waiting a few days and we looked in the box and you can see a few postal cards in there and my friend who had helped me so, Hank Parkhurst, always the optimist, said 'My God, they couldn't get them in the box, Bill, there must be mail bags full!' So we went to the window, the clerk handed us an even dozen postal cards. Ten of them were from doctors drunk, so much so they couldn't write, berating us; and we had two orders for the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*."

A mere two orders for the books were received in 1939. Today, through four editions and 75 years later, we have sold over 34.5 million copies of *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

By the spring of 1941, membership exploded to about 2,000 in part due to the stimulating articles about A.A. in *Liberty* magazine and the Cleveland Plain Dealer. Books were soaring off the shelf. However, it was not until the famous Jack Alexander article was published in the March edition of the *Saturday Evening Post* that, in Bill's words, "really put A.A. on the map." In the Archives there are thousands of letters from alcoholics and others, hungry for information about the Fellowship and for a copy of the book. Writes one notably prominent American businessman to Bill (1957), "I have read *Alcoholics Anonymous* and loaned it to several. I shall read this with great pleasure. As you know, I am deeply appreciative of A.A. for the saving of my boy. Twelve years have passed since my son and his wife affiliated with A.A. If I were to pass on today, I could die happy, in the thought that both Roswell and his wife were safe."

The collection of letters is authentic, pure and unique; they hold such tremendous historical value that we could not document the growth of Alcoholics Anonymous around the world without them. As the A.A. message reached around the globe, the need for translations of the Big Book naturally emerged. One historical narrative passed down to us claims that the earliest translation of the Big Book was accomplished by the wife of a Spanish-speaking member, Ricardo P. in 1946, which was done in an effort to reach his

fellow Mexicans. The manuscript was allegedly given to Bill W. by Ricardo. Tucked away in the Archives, I recently found a copy of a handwritten note from Bill to Ricardo, dated July 1946, which may give some validity to the story. It reads, "In testimony and deep gratitude for his arduous labors of translation—that our Spanish-speaking brothers throughout the world may be led out of darkness into light." This is an example of the wonderful and rich material that makes up the collection of G.S.O.'s Archives. Around 1952, another Spanish-speaking member from New York, Frank M., translated the book, and by the end of 1959, there were completed translations in German, Afrikaans and Norwegian. In 1963 the French translation of *Alcoholics Anonymous* was published. The Big Book is now printed in 69 languages, including English.

These translations have helped to carry the A.A. message to alcoholics in foreign lands, and efforts were made to help those with special needs as well. The G.S.O. Archives possesses a letter from September 1946 written by a staff secretary to the American Red Cross Service for the Blind. It recounts a meeting between the secretary and the first blind A.A. member in Ohio. It further shows that the blind member transcribed the Big Book into Braille and donated it to the Cleveland Public Library. This same letter sparked a conversation between the American Red Cross and the Library of Congress who, after receiving permission from Works Publishing, Inc., consented to transcribe the book by hand for distribution to libraries for the blind.

Though the book publishing process was a discouraging venture, once published, it led to the successful and phenomenal spread of A.A. The early members had, according to Bill, "contrived an approach so effective and inherently sound that it moves from person to person almost entirely upon its own momentum." (Letter, 1940). The book received mixed responses; an early review by the *New York Times* in June 1939 referred to it as a "strange book" and that "it is not a book of personal experience, except in a limited sense, any more than it is a book of rules and precepts." Over seven decades later, *Time* magazine placed the Big Book on its list of "100 best and most influential" nonfiction books written in English since 1923. One year later, it was selected for a special exhibition by the Library of Congress that ran from June through September 2012. The exhibit, which was titled "Books That Shaped America," highlighted 88 books written by Americans that influenced national identity.

The need to carry the message had proven crucial back in 1937, in the living room of Dr. Bob and Anne Smith. And, as Dr. Bob concluded in his own story in the Big Book, "If you think you are an atheist, an agnostic, a skeptic, or have any form of intellectual pride which keeps you from accepting what is in this book, I feel sorry for you. If you still think you are strong enough to beat the game alone, that is your affair. But if you really and truly want to quit drinking liquor for good and all, and sincerely feel that you must have some help, we know that we have an answer for you."

As we celebrate the 75th anniversary of the Big Book, there are now over two million alcoholics, in approximately 170 countries, all because nearly 80 years ago, one drunk shared with another.

Michelle Mirza, Archivist

2015 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

Tuesday evening G.S.O.'s International Convention coordinator gave a Presentation on the upcoming Convention, celebrating A.A.'s 80th Anniversary. Following the Presentation the 475 Riverside Drive Players put on an informative and humorous skit covering possible happenings at the Convention. Corliss Burke, Class A trustee, moderated the session.

Just think! In a little less than 15 months, we will join together to celebrate A.A.'s 80th Birthday at our International Convention in Atlanta, Georgia. July 2-5, 2015, are the dates — so mark your calendar! Plans are well under way to make this a joyous and memorable event.

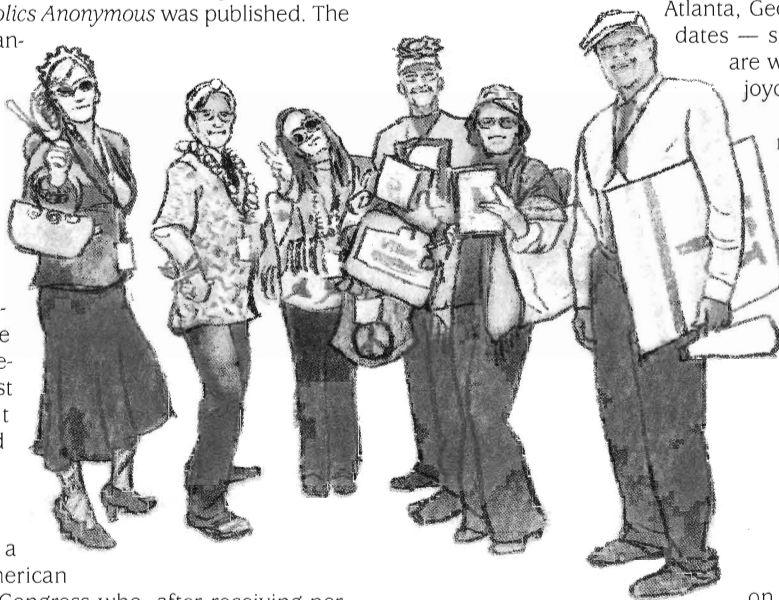
Atlanta is a vibrant and modern city. At the heart of the South is its people, where you will likely be greeted with a big helping of "How y'all doing" hospitality. When we get there, we'll pack the Georgia World Congress Center with handshakes, hugs, kisses, and lots of meetings, panels, workshops, and more. And, of course, we'll have those extraordinary Big Meetings in the Georgia Dome right next to the Convention Center.

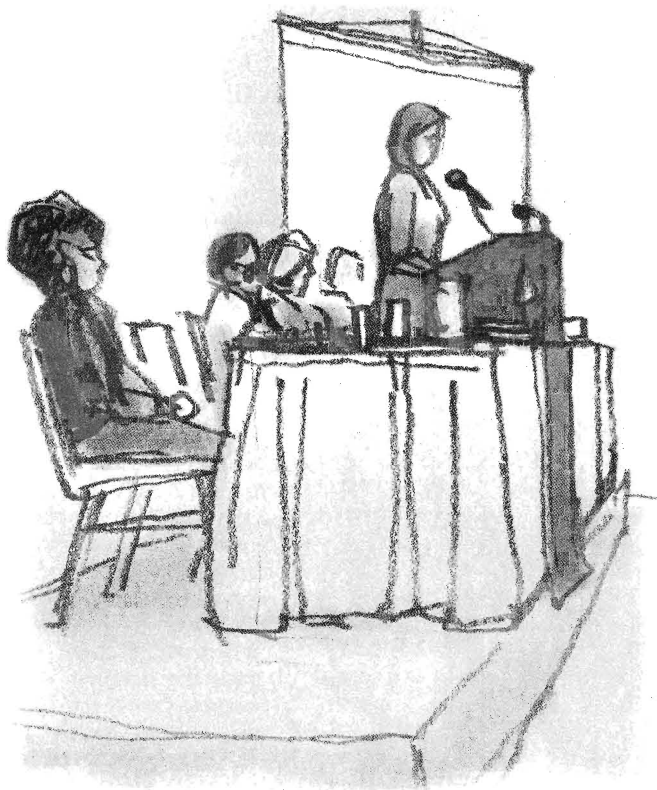
We will start the festivities on Thursday night with a party in Centennial Olympic Park. Dances and celebrations will flow from the Park to the Convention Center and back out to the Park. Music and happy vibes will surely fill the southern summer night! At midnight on Thursday, marathon meetings will begin and continue through Sunday morning.

Starting on Friday morning, hundreds of meetings will be held at the Convention Center and that evening in the Georgia Dome, the Opening Flag Ceremony will take place, followed by the three-speaker Big A.A. Meeting. Again on Saturday there will be more meetings. The wonderful Oldtimers Meeting will take place on Saturday night in the Dome, where oldtimers will be selected from the hat to share with us. What a great way to honor our history and hear first-hand what we used to be like. Sunday morning it's back to the Dome, where we will have our customary three-speaker Big Meeting to close out the weekend and say farewell until 2020 in Detroit.

Early International A.A. Conventions were focal points for important moments in A.A. history. At the first Convention, in Cleveland in 1950, our Twelve Traditions were confirmed, helping to ensure the future of our Fellowship. At the same time, the members had the sad privilege of hearing Dr. Bob speak before an A.A. audience for the last time. At the 1955 Convention in St. Louis, Missouri, at 4 o'clock in the afternoon, Bill W. declared that A.A. had "come of age" and the leadership of A.A. was turned over to the General Service Conference. As noted in *A.A. Comes of Age*, the Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service were turned over to the movement by its oldtimers.

International Conventions offer the occasion for rich and varied experiences, some dramatic and historical, others quiet and serene. Those who talk about attending an International Convention will often speak of it as the highlight of their sobriety, and the





emotion universally expressed is one of gratitude — gratitude for sobriety in A.A. and for having had the opportunity to celebrate sobriety with tens of thousands of A.A. members and their loved ones in a spectacular gathering. Every member who attends an International Convention takes away their own cherished and memorable experiences.

Many A.A.s will travel to Atlanta with old friends, sponsors or home group members, and will have those on-the-road meetings that form such an important part of our Fellowship sharing. Not surprising, those A.A. “coincidences” may occur during the Convention — someone you lost track of will show up sober. The distant member who Twelfth-stepped you will suddenly appear or someone on your Step Eight list will provide you with the opportunity to make amends; perhaps you will be on their Eighth Step list, as well. New and lifelong friendships will be made—perhaps in the wee hours of the morning, as we fellowship over ice cream and coffee. Opportunities for on-the-spot Twelfth Step work will arise. We have all heard the stories of alcoholics who got sober during an International Convention.

As you can imagine, there are countless stories to be told and here are some gems from our past experiences from the non-A.A. perspective: A cab driver in one city stated that we were the nicest convention they had ever had. A female taxi driver in another city commented, “You people have something special. You make me feel good. I’m usually dragged out by these summer conventions, but this time I’m looking forward to each run. Even when one of you gets cranky, the others talk him out of it. I’ve never seen anything like it. I wish I could send my kids.” And, in another city a city department manager was crotchety through all of the planning. When setting up refreshment stands in the park before the Convention, she was there demanding that every city ordinance be followed to a tee. Following the closing on Sunday afternoon, she shouted “I have one thing to say to you guys...don’t go home!” During the course of the weekend, the love and fellowship expressed among the attendees had converted her into an A.A. fan. She said in all her years of city service, she had never seen such cooperation and harmony among such a varied group.

At A.A.’s 75th celebration at the 2010 International Convention in San Antonio, members from ninety-six lands were present. So, one day at a time, we are preparing for an international celebration of A.A.’s 80th Birthday. We know this Convention will be another powerful example of living sober — happy, joyous and free. And amid the festive crowds, we will be reminded that “In spite of the great increase in the size and the span of this Fellowship, at its core it remains simple and personal. Each day, somewhere in the world, recovery begins when one alcoholic talks with another alcoholic, sharing experience, strength, and hope.” (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. xxii)

The International Convention truly enables attendees to witness the success and growth of A.A. around the world. Not only does this event affect members in attendance and provide the opportunity for a rededication to A.A.’s primary purpose, it also provides a chance for the public to see us first hand and lets the world know that A.A. is still alive, flourishing and available as a community resource, locally and internationally. International Conventions present wonderful moments to let the newcomer and world know we are not a glum lot!

As you may be aware, when planning International Conventions, we try very hard to emphasize to hotels and convention centers in Convention cities the magnitude of our event, yet the message doesn’t always get across — during one Convention disaster struck when all the major facilities in the city ran out of coffee — we drank them dry. But worse was yet to happen — in the same city, they ran out of toilet tissue!

As members of the General Service Conference, you will have a large part to play in the success and tone of the Convention. Most of the speakers will come from your recommendations. You have already received the request to suggest non-A.A. speakers from professional fields. This fall, we will be asking you to send us suggestions for A.A. members to participate in the over 800 meetings taking place over the weekend.

Another major part in organizing this event is working with the Volunteer Host Committee. We would not be able to welcome so many members from around the world without an able and enthusiastic volunteer committee. The volunteer core committee is in place and eager to start. They will begin gathering names of volunteers with a Kickoff Event in January. We anticipate that upward of 4,000 volunteers will be welcoming Convention-goers to Atlanta.

Information on the 2015 International Convention is available on G.S.O.’s A.A. website, in Box 4-5-9, and through special Convention mailings. In August, we will be mailing out the Registration Forms for the 2015 International Convention to all members of the General Service Conference, to the G.S.R.s of all active groups and to others in the service structure, as well as to Intergroup/Central Offices and General Service Offices around the world.

Registration and housing will open September 3. Because of the large number of hotel rooms in downtown Atlanta, we will be making rooms available on a first-come, first-served basis. As in the past, members will be able to register online or by mail. Once you have registered, you will be able to book your hotel room.

And now we are gearing towards celebrating A.A.’s 80th Anniversary! The theme for this, our 14th International A.A. Convention, is “80 Years — Happy, Joyous and Free.” In the closing of Chapter Eleven in our Big Book, it reads: “Abandon yourself to God as you understand God. Admit your faults to Him and to your fellows. Clear away the wreckage of your past. Give freely of what you find and join us. We shall be with you in the Fellowship of the Spirit, and you will surely meet some of us as you trudge the road of Happy Destiny.”

In so many ways, at each International Convention, paths do cross and we are given a rare glimpse of the breadth of A.A.

Eva Sanchez, International Convention coordinator

■ Report of the 2014 General Service Conference Inventory

“Since effective communication is the keystone of our general service structure, I am grateful the three-year General Service Conference Inventory is affording our Fellowship the opportunity to discuss new suggestions to ensure that information flows up and down the service structure. Learning from past experience will grant us vision for tomorrow.”

— Patrick Claymore, Southeast Texas delegate
“Inventory — A Guiding Tool to Our Future”
2014 Conference Presentation

Setting the stage for the second year of the General Service Conference's three-year Inventory Plan, as seen through the lens of the 2014 General Service Conference theme, rotating general service trustee Roberta Lindeman, spoke directly to Conference members in her Keynote Address: “It is most exciting to be at the 64th General Service Conference and to focus on ‘Communicating Our Legacies — Vital in a Changing World.’ This theme is no surprise as better communication is usually the motive for everything we do. Each of you in this room is well aware of our Three Legacies: Recovery, Unity and Service, and we know how essential these three are to the survival and effectiveness of Alcoholics Anonymous.

“Our agenda for this particular Conference,” she continued, “includes many important items that will impact the Fellowship today and in the future. Some items will stimulate animated and maybe even slightly heated discussion, or a motion, a vote, a minority opinion, or even a change of outcome with the final vote.

“As we continue our Conference Inventory and work on agenda items in this 64th General Service Conference, we must look for ways to better carry the message in a world where the barrage of media and the Internet can be utilized to reach the still-suffering alcoholics. Along with this consideration, we must continue to retain the proven Twelfth Step face-to-face interaction of one alcoholic talking with another. The issues we deal with here have not really changed. What is different now is the explosion of technology that adds a new dimension when communicating our Legacies.

“Most likely we will begin something here that could be the start of something bigger, that might be enhanced and enriched by those who come after us. It is our responsibility to make sure that whatever that is, we are ‘Communicating Our Legacies’ in a complete and accurate manner.”

A Brief History

Dating back to 2005, when the General Service Board began the process of taking its own inventory and subsequent inventories of its two operating corporations, A.A. World Services, Inc. and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., it was suggested that the inventory process might also expand to cover the General Service Conference itself, examining its structure, processes and procedures.

Some of the possible items that could be given thorough study, it was suggested, were: the effectiveness of the current committee system, the impact of new technologies on A.A.'s group conscience process, a creeping politicization of the Conference process versus the policy of delegation and trust, and the role of the trustees in the Conference process.

The idea developed over time and a General Service Board subcommittee was formed in August 2008 to discuss the proposal for a General Service Conference Inventory. Such an inventory, it was determined, would be a natural outgrowth of that which is done to maintain individual sobriety throughout the A.A. Fellowship. However, when applied to A.A.'s general services and for the pur-

poses of the General Service Conference inventory, the Twelve Concepts for World Service, not the Twelve Steps for Recovery, would provide the context through which to evaluate current Conference practices and procedures.

As noted in the Keynote Address at the opening of the 2013 General Service Conference, the inaugural year of the Inventory Plan, “Self-assessment is a pervasive part of our A.A. program; fully half of our Steps are directly related to it. Inventory of the Conference and personal inventory in the Steps are not quite the same, however. At the Conference, the emphasis will be on effectiveness in carrying out the purposes of the Conference, not on ‘character defects.’

“Honesty, both with ourselves and with others, is a core value of A.A. ... We don't take inventory simply because it is, in and of itself, a good thing (like kindness, or generosity), but rather because it is an important element of our continued sobriety. The same holds true for our service inventories, including the Conference inventory which we are now undertaking. We are not here to take pride in doing the responsible thing by taking an inventory. We are here to help assure the unity and effectiveness of A.A. in its mission to carry the great message of hope to anyone, anywhere, who has a desire to do something about his or her drinking problem.”

In August 2009 the GSB established a subcommittee to fulfill the charge of putting together a process or procedure by which a Planning Committee with representation from all membership segments of the General Service Conference could be established. The subcommittee determined that representation should be proportional, as representation is at the GSC, and that participants be selected by lot. These conclusions were accepted by the GSB, along with some additional suggestions regarding the establishment of a Conference Inventory Planning Committee, and were ultimately referred back to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee in 2010.

The Inventory Plan

After evaluation and discussion by the 2010 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions and deliberation by the entire Conference, a detailed Advisory Action was passed to develop a comprehensive inventory plan.

The 2011 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions reviewed the inventory plan and proposed to the full Conference “that the General Service Conference conduct a thorough inventory of itself in accordance with the Comprehensive Plan formulated by the Conference Inventory Planning Committee.” The areas covered by the inventory plan were:

- I. **Logistics** (suggesting that the inventory be conducted at three consecutive Conferences: 2013, 2014 and 2015);
- II. **Participation** (outlining the categories and terms of rotation of Conference members to serve on the Planning Committee);
- III. **Reporting** (detailing a methodology for reporting the Conference inventory, including publication of a thorough report in the *Final Conference Report* of each year of the inventory, along with summaries of each years' inventory for publication in the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and Box 4-5-9, and a separate comprehensive report of all three years' input to be prepared after the inventory process is completed);
- IV. **Finance** (developing a cost structure for conducting and reporting the inventory);
- V. **Inventory Questions** (covering the overall effectiveness of the Conference and the Conference process; the composi-

tion of the Conference; the committee system; the effectiveness of the yearlong process; Conference preparation, in terms of background, content, delivery, etc.; the Conference week schedule; the General Service Board and corporate boards; and the question of leadership and what might be the most desirable qualities considered for leaders in A.A.)

The recommendation was accepted by the full Conference and passed as an Advisory Action of the 2011 General Service Conference, with implementation to begin in 2013.

First-Year Results

In 2013, the first year of the Inventory Plan, a number of common and interconnected themes surfaced which were reported to the Fellowship through the 2013 *Final Conference Report*, The Grapevine, Box 4-5-9, and La Viña. The major topics were: *COMMUNICATION* and the flow of information throughout the Fellowship, from the trustees to the delegates, from delegates to the areas, from areas to districts and groups; *USE OF TECHNOLOGY* in today's changing digital world, for the dissemination of information and communication at and relative to the General Service Conference; *CONFERENCE ORIENTATION AND PREPARATION* to help provide delegates and the Fellowship a clearer picture of what happens at the Conference and how decisions are arrived at; *PARTICIPATION AND TIMING* for the development and distribution of agenda items and background information to best facilitate thorough discussion and review by the Fellowship; *INFORMATION* on which much of the Conference is based: its volume, dissemination, purpose and derivation.

These issues and the suggestions made by 2013 Conference members, along with the sharing and suggestions of this year's Conference and the upcoming 2015 Conference (the final year of the Inventory Plan), constitute the focal point of the inventory process for the General Service Conference.

Noted Southeast Texas delegate Patrick Claymore in the 2014 presentation "Inventory — A Guiding Tool to Our Future," "The first ever General Service Conference Inventory is underway, and this week all of us will participate in the second of a three-year process. In reviewing the 2013 *Final Conference Report*, I found that the inventory has already provided insightful recommendations and suggestions to enhance and change the Conference process in the areas of effective communication, leadership, and increased Fellowship participation."

Year Two — The Inventory Continues

To address the 15 inventory questions proposed for the 2014 GSC and to allow for an equitable and representative cross-section of Conference members, three different groupings were created to address questions 1-5, 6-10, and 11-15, with each segment further broken down into 5 subgroups for each set of questions. Conference members were then assigned to one of the 15 different workshop groups, each with a moderator and reporter, and each containing 9 total participants. Meeting for two-and-a-half hours during the Conference on Wednesday, April 30th, the full range of inventory questions was covered by Conference members, with reports prepared from each workshop group.

Subsequently, each group reported directly to the full Conference on Friday, May 2nd, with additional discussion and commentary on the Conference floor following each workshop report.

Some Common Concerns

Over the course of the second year of the Inventory, a number of significant issues relating to Conference practices and procedures surfaced that cut across many different questions and Concepts:

- **Language Equality:** An overriding concern expressed throughout a number of different workshop reports was the issue of language equality and the need to reach a level of parity in terms of the preparation and distribution of Conference agenda items and background information in all three languages represented by the Conference to ensure full participation throughout the Fellowship and to make certain that the Conference is not giving the impression that there are second-class members. Timely translation of Conference materials into French and Spanish was seen as tangible evidence of the statement made in one workshop, "There is no us or them — it's all us." Recognition was made that the timely translation of Conference materials represents a difficult task, given the schedule, deadlines and fiscal constraints under which the General Service Office operates to provide support services for the Conference as a whole. However, consensus suggested that this was a highly compelling issue for Conference members and should be given appropriate attention by the trustees, evaluating all professional and volunteer resources that might be necessary to facilitate timely implementation.

(Note: the following Advisory Action was passed at the 2014 GSC: "It was recommended that: Because all Conference members are considered equal, all members should have equal access to Conference material and that a plan be created by the General Service Office to translate Conference Material (background material, Conference Manual, etc.) into French and Spanish for use during the Conference, with a report being presented to the 2015 General Service Conference. This plan may include coordinating the use of the volunteer network throughout the Fellowship, hiring professional translators or any other facilities that the office deems necessary. The report should include costs and any other considerations deemed necessary to allow timely translations to occur.")

- **Diversity:** Full participation in the Conference process was also related to the question of diversity, as many workshop groups reported, and it was noted that the Conference itself could pay attention to this issue — especially to the question "where are the young people?" — as the average age at the Conference was reported as 59. It was suggested that the Conference, and delegates in particular, find ways to reach out to underrepresented populations of all kinds. Said one Conference member, "I would like to see a deaf delegate one day." It was understood that this effort required strong leadership and the ability to encourage and support members of the Fellowship, and while the structure provides opportunities for members to serve, many may choose not to participate. "We need to recognize the value of all kinds of leaders: good organizers, good talkers, good listeners, good cheerleaders, and the multiple roles we need to fill." Noted one workshop report, "We need to be mindful of how we carry ourselves: We may be the only copy of *The A.A. Service Manual* some A.A.s ever see."
- **Conference Agenda:** In the spirit of full representation at the Conference and to reflect more of the Fellowship's ongoing concerns, the question of how agenda items are developed was widely discussed, with requests made for more input from delegates in the determination of agenda items. It was expressed by some that the lack of input into each year's Conference agenda by delegates can create a sense of inequality, as those who ultimately make the decisions about the agenda can be perceived as having unqualified authority over others.

A number of avenues were suggested to allow for greater delegate input, including broader participation by Conference committee chairs at the January board meeting, greater involvement of the Conference Committee on Agenda throughout the year, and refinements to the schedule soliciting agenda items to encourage broader and ongoing input.

(Note: the 2014 Conference Agenda Committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the Conference explore the potential role that the Conference Committee on Agenda might play in the selection process of Agenda items in the future and provide a report to the 2015 Conference Agenda Committee.)

- **Conference Deadlines:** The Conference itself is a model of cooperation and collaboration throughout the Fellowship, yet the suggestion was made that full participation in the Conference process from groups and delegates is sometimes curtailed. Recognizing the need for deadlines, many felt that the timing and distribution of Conference agenda items and background information limited input from the Fellowship, noting that getting an informed conscience from the groups depends on providing the information to them in a timely manner, which allows the Fellowship as a whole to better understand the issues and to respond. In this vein, requests were made for the trustees to reevaluate the scheduling and deadlines for the final receipt of Conference agenda items, redefining the process to facilitate greater exposure, discussion and reporting throughout the Fellowship. One suggestion made was to consider expanding the agenda development process to a full year. This would create time for the Fellowship to discuss topics in advance, time to develop more balanced and complete background material, and time to have that background material translated into Spanish and French.
- **Conference Theme:** It was expressed that the Conference theme could be a powerful way to encourage greater involvement in the Conference process from the Fellowship, but that the themes, in general, were not utilized in any meaningful way throughout the year. The themes are often unwieldy and unrelated to the general membership. Delegates and G.S.O. were encouraged to incorporate the Conference theme more prominently on a yearlong basis to help establish focus on the Conference and increase participation throughout the Fellowship.

(Note: the 2014 Conference adopted the following theme for the 2015 Conference: "Celebrating 80 Years of Recovery, Unity and Service — the Foundation for Our Future.")

- **Communication:** It was noted that the concept of hearing minority opinion and reports was well utilized throughout the Conference and was a concept that could be more fully utilized throughout the Fellowship itself. Continued and regular focus on the minority voice is a helpful and beneficial element in fully evaluating the issues and concerns that come before the Fellowship, yet we should always encourage full debate before voting, which may preclude the need for minority views to be expressed. Additionally, regarding the flow of information throughout the Fellowship, from the board of trustees to the delegates, from delegates to the areas, from areas to districts and groups and back, concern was expressed that key information was sometimes missing in the two-way system of communication. Communication is a key element in the Conference process and is one of the facets upon which trust is built. It was generally felt that more intensive year-round communication between trustees' committee chairs and Conference committee chairs would be beneficial to help keep the Fellowship current on board meet-

ing topics and discussions, and that the flow of information from regional trustees to delegates helps provide a bridge between the board and the Fellowship at large. When these channels are not well utilized or become clogged, misunderstanding can grow, the perception of "us-versus-them" takes root, and we lose our spiritual focus and effectiveness. Transparency regarding decisions taken on behalf of A.A. and the spirit of true collaboration throughout the Conference structure help to build trust and restore effectiveness.

Conclusion: 'Vision For Tomorrow'

As planned, the General Service Conference Inventory will continue in 2015 with a new influx of Conference members, new questions to evaluate, and new perspectives to inform the comprehensive process undertaken by the General Service Conference in the spirit of Bill W.'s reflections in *A.A. Comes of Age* (p. 231), "Just as each A.A. must continue to take his moral inventory and act upon it, so must our whole society if we are to survive and if we are to serve usefully and well."

"Self-assessment through inventory," noted Southeast Texas delegate Patrick Claymore, "is a tool that can provide insight into the specific actions we need to consider.... Using the tool of inventory, should we determine if Alcoholics Anonymous is off track with practicing our Fellowship's singleness of purpose? Do our current actions, public relations policies, and messages to newcomers help or hinder our common welfare and legacy of unity? Is there something we need to change?"

In closing, said Patrick of the Inventory, "Since effective communication is the keystone of our general service structure, I am grateful the three-year General Service Conference Inventory is affording our Fellowship the opportunity to discuss new suggestions to ensure that information flows up and down the service structure. Learning from past experience will grant us vision for tomorrow."

Summary of 2014 Inventory

Question 1:

Reflecting on Concept Four, how effective are we in treating all Conference members as equals (no one regarded as second class)?

The use of Concept Four throughout the general service structure ensures that we are all treated as equals — with different service roles, but each serving the Fellowship equally; mutual respect and finding similarities are key; trustees want to hear from delegates — whether they have good things to say or bad; people sometimes hesitate to ask questions, however, and we need to transcend ego to bring forth all the issues that need to be discussed; communication styles based on kindness and courtesy reflect the spirit of equal participation; "We want to hear from everyone, but we need to use good judgment on how often we speak on a particular subject"; There is no us or them — it's all us; this is "our" Conference, we each have one vote.

Nevertheless, we can give the impression that there are second-class members due to the level of language accommodations made throughout the Fellowship relating to Conference background material; additionally, the lack of input into each year's Conference agenda by delegates can create a sense of inequality, as those who ultimately make the decisions about the agenda can be perceived as having unqualified authority over the others.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Pay more attention to linguistic minorities; translate all Conference background material into Spanish and French.*

- Encourage diversity; think about who is not in the room — for example, young people — as the average age at the Conference is 59.
- Review process of selecting Conference agenda items to include more input from delegates.
- Continue utilizing the “buddy system” at the Conference, as it encourages camaraderie and the feeling of equality.

Question 2:

Reflecting on Concept Five, how well does the Conference facilitate the hearing and resolution of minority appeals/reports? How could it be improved?

There is a difference between minority opinion — usually verbal and taken after every vote — and minority appeals/reports — which are written and follow a specific process for submission to the Conference; the minority appeal/report is the last resort for issues to be brought to the Conference and the process should be respected; the spirit of the principle of minority reports is stressed through the understanding that what is done at one Conference can be changed or corrected at another; however, “as important as the use of minority appeal is, we should always encourage full debate before voting, which may preclude the need for minority views to be expressed.”

The concept of minority opinion, reports/appeals doesn’t just happen at the Conference — an area can bring back an item if they don’t agree; the concept should be used in many places, in many ways; floor actions are sometimes also a form of appeal; through minority opinion we have the opportunity for our voice to be heard — we may not get our way, but we have been heard.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *The process for submitting minority appeals/reports is not well known and needs to be clarified to Conference members.*

Question 3:

Does the structure encourage each individual in the Fellowship to feel and act as a member of a “society of alcoholics in action”? If not, how could we improve?

The structure allows everyone to serve, regardless of the language and origins; all service is equal — even Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees feel like members; however, while the structure provides opportunities for members to serve, many choose not to participate.

Throughout the Fellowship, membership is not increasing and many groups are not contributing at the same levels as in the past; demographics and geography pose challenges; the structure can sometimes be a hindrance to transparency; negative perceptions can be developed, as in the confidentiality statement signed by trustees, which can be perceived as the flip-side of transparency; members often don’t participate in their group’s business meetings and so are uninformed about the service structure; sponsorship and service sponsorship is vital; delegates need to “connect the dots” of service to the alcoholic who still suffers; demonstrate that each voice can be heard; transmit the passion.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Find ways to reach out to underrepresented populations — young people, etc. “I would like to see a deaf delegate one day.”*
- *Translate all background material.*
- *Find avenues to pass the service message along to those who are unaware of how the structure works to support A.A. In this effort we need to be mindful of how we carry ourselves: “We may be the only copy of The A.A. Service Manual some A.A.s ever see.”*

- *Explore ways to utilize P.I. and C.P.C. to create excitement and enthusiasm about A.A. membership.*
- *Encourage attendance at Regional Forums.*
- *Promote greater use of unusual service connections and innovative service tools that have aided and enhanced the sobriety of members in many different circumstances.*
- *Continue to acknowledge and support all types of service, not just general service.*

Question 4:

Does the yearlong Conference process effectively encourage all Conference members to lead (or serve) in the spirit of our upside-down service structure? If not, how can we encourage all Conference members to do so?

For delegates, the Conference is a yearlong process as they visit districts and take the pulse of the Fellowship in their areas; communication takes place throughout the year through the website, Dashboard, board weekends and the minutes generated from them; some areas are quite participatory in responding to agenda items while others have more work to do to get individual members to understand their importance in the upside-down structure and to interact with the delegate.

Most Conference committees do not meet or communicate much during the year — perhaps more regular communication could be encouraged; some committees need more time at the Conference, as the workload can be overwhelming; the upside-down process can be made more transparent by providing information more widely throughout the Fellowship — “by providing everyone with whatever I receive,” says one Conference member.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Delegates need to teach people what to do with the information they get from our service entities.*
- *Preparation of background material could benefit from more participation and oversight from trustees’ committees.*
- *Delegates should share amongst themselves online or otherwise about how to be more effective in getting out the information from the Conference.*
- *Consider establishing or supporting “G.S.R. schools,” where everyone is invited to learn more about their service responsibilities, how agenda items are developed, and how the upside-down process works.*

Question 5:

Should regional divisions be based on membership numbers, the number of areas contained in each region or some other criteria. Please explain.

There is a process in place to split areas when they become too big, but nothing similar for regions; nevertheless, regional divisions should not necessarily be made on membership numbers or number of groups; it is critical that the regional trustees be able to visit all areas in their region.

But, some ask, “is it fair for an area with 300-500 groups to have the same vote as an area with 2,000 groups?” — perhaps creating more or reconfiguring existing regions would even things out.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *More information is needed on the history of how regions were created and how they grew; more data is needed before an informed decision could be made, though many felt the situation is fine as it is.*

Question 6:

What is the right balance of participation among committee members (delegates, staff) and how can we best achieve that balance?

The balance of participation between staff and delegates in Conference committees is good; staff role is supportive, not directive — extremely helpful as resources in gathering information; when asked, staff should feel free to voice opinions; balance of first- and second-year delegates is also important within each committee; committee system works well.

Balance in joint trustees/Conference committee meetings can pose challenges, especially for first-year delegates — 10 or more trustees, directors and staff members can be a formidable presence, particularly when contentious agenda items are up for discussion.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *It could be helpful for new delegates to develop a document that explains the role of staff in committee to give clear expectations ahead of time, or have the secretary remind the committee of staff's role within the committee.*

Question 7:

How well is the message of the Conference theme being carried out throughout the year?

Throughout the year, in most areas, the Conference theme is given very little attention: the theme often gets lost and the focus shifts to agenda items, especially controversial ones; theme is sometimes complicated, seems more like a corporate theme; in many areas the theme is never mentioned until it starts into Conference time.

Conference as a whole needs to acknowledge the importance of institutionalizing the practice of observing the Conference theme all year long to establish it as part of the area culture; delegates, trustees and G.S.O. need to encourage use of the theme throughout the Fellowship and build it into yearlong events.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Long themes can be unwieldy — short themes are more easily utilized.*
- *Keep theme for two years for a better and more complete discussion by the Fellowship.*
- *Utilize present technology to inform members of the theme.*
- *Develop Conference theme material to come from G.S.O. — one Box 4-5-9 article is not enough; put Conference theme on letterhead (like International Convention logo), add Conference theme as home page banner on G.S.O.'s A.A. website, use theme as a header on office e-correspondence throughout the year.*
- *Delegates can make sure to mention next year's Conference theme in delegate's report and suggest districts do workshops on it; put Conference theme and logo on area communications throughout the year; put theme on newsletter banners.*
- *Grapevine could assist with series of articles on the theme and how it relates to the Fellowship.*
- *Develop special literature packets related to the theme.*
- *Regional trustee reports could focus on Conference theme in addition to raw data and business information.*

Question 8:

What other suggestions do we have for how to improve the effectiveness of the yearlong process?

Ongoing communication throughout the service structure is the key; the flow of information goes both ways — from Conference

to the Fellowship and from the Fellowship to the Conference; find ways for G.S.R.s to stay involved and interested — educate and engage G.S.R.s in the Conference theme.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *General Service Board should get board reports out as quickly as possible.*
- *Send out background material — in English, French and Spanish — throughout the year.*
- *Use the Dashboard year 'round; post information as it comes in.*
- *Trustees' committee chairs can correspond regularly with Conference committee chairs to keep current on board meeting topics and discussions.*
- *Reorganize committee structure to focus on areas of interest to the Fellowship, like anonymity or how to carry the message, to keep group members interested in the work of the Conference.*
- *Consider moving back the deadline for agenda items to avoid huge crunch in the beginning of the year.*
- *Consider a two-year process, with a Conference every other year.*

Question 9:

How can we improve the manner in which Conference background material is developed and distributed?

Gratitude was expressed for the three formats available for the delivery of background material; however, an overriding concern was voiced that background material be distributed, at the same time, in all three languages of the Conference, to clearly manifest the right of decision and the right of participation; "we aren't operating as a society of equals."

It was recognized that this would have to come at a cost, though consensus seemed to indicate that the issue is critical enough that it should be addressed sooner rather than later, with funding pulled from other services, derived from literature price increases, developed through volunteer resources, or solicited from increased Fellowship contributions.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *Translate all background material into Spanish and French and distribute simultaneously with English.*
- *Consider expanding the agenda development process to a full year. For example, the 2016 agenda would be proposed at the January 2015 board meeting. This would create time for the Fellowship to discuss topics in advance, time to develop more balanced and complete background material, and time to have that background material translated into Spanish and French.*
- *Dashboard could be more user-friendly with updated technology.*
- *Take proposed Conference agenda items that the trustees' committees and/or boards declined to move forward and pass them through the Conference Committee on Agenda for further review and possible consideration.*

Question 10:

At the Conference, what is the difference between being a leader or being a reporter? Can a person be both at the same time?

The delegate is both a leader and a reporter — one job is subjective and the other objective; reporting to the areas requires delegates to be both: sharing facts in a balanced way, while reflecting thoughts, feelings and emotions; leader has the capacity to accept the ideas of others, while reporter informs the Fellowship about what happens; can be both, but may have a tendency to move more toward one and may not accurately carry the group's thoughts.

Being both is difficult because one leads from passion and one reports facts; one can't *do* the tasks of leader and reporter simultaneously, but one can *be* both at the same time.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *"As members of the Conference, if we have a solution or something we can bring to the Conference, as leaders we have a responsibility to go to the microphone and say it. We also have a responsibility as reporters to bring our local conscience to the Conference and to bring back the conscience of the Conference."*
- *"Listen like you have no opinion."*

Question 11:

Reflecting on Concept Eleven, does the General Service Board exercise serious care in having the best possible assistance in carrying out their duties? How can this process be improved?

The General Service Board has exercised due diligence and informed care to insure the best assistance in carrying out its duties; "with the lens that I have as delegate, I see qualified people serving as nontrustee directors, G.S.O. staff, etc."; in selecting people for service positions on the boards, "we look for the person who will best serve A.A."

Communication issues can sometimes be problematic, however, as board reporting is not detailed enough in some instances regarding the activities of the trustees (ie, quality of minutes) and the distribution of information about openings on the board and staff can be too limited; trust is important, but so is transparency; the time, respect and willingness to have disagreements and extended discussions are important to healthy functioning; it may be that pockets of the Fellowship think that service at the board level is about being part of the "in crowd": if a person is a delegate, then appointed committee member, then nontrustee director, then general service trustee, they may be around for too long, like "when a G.S.R. keeps the position for many years — it's not good"; taking an honest inventory and raising awareness of challenges the board faces can help develop trust; there is a tricky balance between flexibility and openness, which are important to innovation, while still maintaining the principles that sustain A.A.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *The board should encourage balance and trade-offs in utilizing consultants, staff and appointed committee members to insure that we stay current in both functional expertise and being up-to-date in utilizing the latest technology.*
- *Consider allowing nonalcoholics to serve as nontrustee directors.*
- *Discussion about the selection of executive editor/publisher and general manager positions must be very transparent and open. To do otherwise will deepen mistrust/suspicion.*
- *Continue to encourage new initiatives for better communication between boards.*
- *Involve Class As more deeply at the area level to help them learn more about us and how we function — "it's up to us to get our Class*

As up to speed."

- *Expand the distribution of announcements for open positions — being limited to the advertisement of positions to Box 4-5-9 may be restricting who we recruit.*
- *Consider having a more extensive trustees' orientation program.*
- *The board might want to look at developing a communications position at G.S.O.*

Question 12:

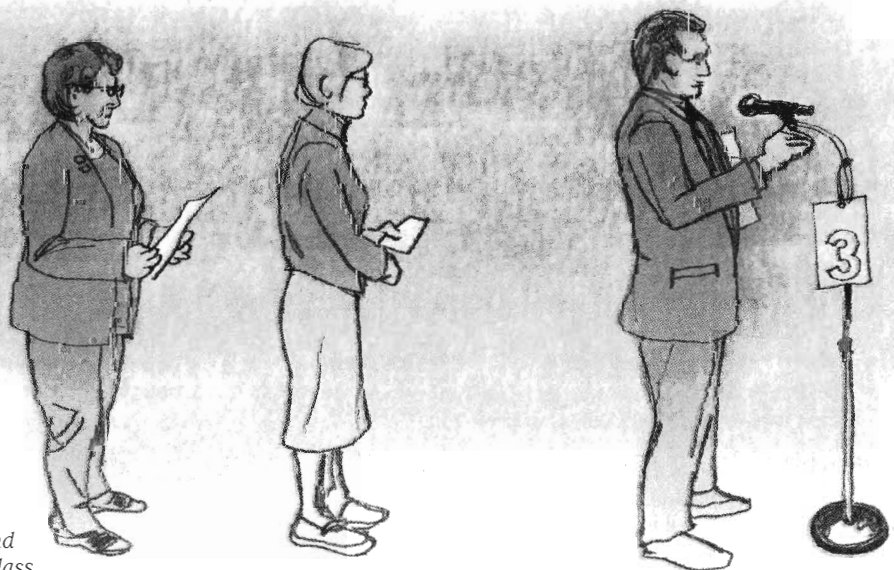
Does the current role of the board most effectively address the needs of the Fellowship? If not, how should their role be changed?

The board does an admirable job of addressing the needs of a diverse and far-flung Fellowship; we need the board to be an anchor for the core principles of A.A. — "to always have a beacon to find our way back."

To address the needs of the Fellowship more effectively, however, there needs to be more communication between the board and the delegates regarding the Conference agenda; is the less-than-half level of group participation in contributions and general service an indication of a deep problem between the Fellowship and the board; Communication is a two-way street and needs encouragement in both directions; the challenges of dealing with policy matters, the balance of power and questions of delegated authority have always been with us; when we seek to criticize or place blame it is hard, if not impossible, to keep the focus on spirituality and unity; throughout the Fellowship we need to admit when things are difficult and ask for help; "the service structure is only as good as the people in it."

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- *The board is responsible for vision for the future, but sometimes seems to get bogged down in details — perhaps even minutia — and may not be looking at some of the critical issues.*
- *Strategic planning for communicating with the Fellowship about self-support and the Seventh Tradition is vitally important.*
- *Forums could be more interactive and responsive regarding questions and concerns brought up by the Fellowship — a patronizing/pandering tone that sounds like agreement with the assurance that action will occur (when the idea is*



later forgotten or ignored) isn't helpful, nor are short answers from the board such as "we don't have the time" or "we don't have the money." If a question isn't answerable at the Forum, someone could follow up later with pertinent information.

- The board should encourage more participation from Conference committee chairs during the January board weekend.
- Develop a mechanism for greater involvement of the delegates in the yearlong process of the Conference, allowing for more active participation, especially as it relates to developing the agenda.

Question 13:

Is the selection/election process for trustees and directors effective and impartial/fair? How would you change it?

"A.A. is like a self-cleaning oven. I don't believe any one person can make or break A.A. I trust the process. I believe what Bill said — that A.A. will be around as long as God will have it. I believe in the Alpha and the Omega in the entire process."

The system for selecting regional trustees, with regional delegates, randomly-selected nonregional delegates and trustees, etc., really helps to deter manipulation of the election; the selection of nontrustee directors is vigorous and thorough; widening the pool of candidates would help develop diversity, as sometimes we miss the quieter-voiced candidates; we need more information on the slate of officers proposed for each board to better evaluate candidates; trustee-at-large elections can be strongly influenced by size of the regions; it takes real courage and dedication to set aside personal/geographic loyalties in the selection of the most qualified candidates.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- Widen the pool of candidates for Class A trustees to encourage diversity; utilize About A.A. to announce openings and solicit applications; have potential Class As serve on trustees' committees; find more grassroots Class A candidates instead of high-level professionals.
- Consideration needs to be given to the impact of large regions vs. small regions in the selection of trustees-at-large.
- Consider persons outside the service structure for board positions, A.A.s who may have a different and refreshing perspective.



Question 14:

How can we improve the methods of selecting effective leaders and nurturing leadership qualities in our trusted servants?

"In my area, when I see someone I think has something that would be a great help, I encourage them to get involved"; "train, support, share, walk with, review reports, get notes on reports — these are what people have done for me. It is so important to help the person along. It's our responsibility"; sponsorship at all levels is essential; "leading by example can only be encouraged by leading by example. Leadership that drives by mandate generates more leaders of that nature"; emphasis on selection of G.S.R.s is the foundation for good leadership throughout the Fellowship.

We need to recognize the value of all kinds of leaders: good organizers, good talkers, good listeners, good cheerleaders, and the multiple roles we need to fill; for elections at the Conference, a review of the qualifications for the *position*, not the candidates, prior to voting would be helpful in keeping the focus on what A.A. needs; it is our responsibility to educate people to serve and to provide a much more extensive orientation for our trusted servants — the investment would be well worth it.

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- Continue explaining the broader picture of our service structure at Forums and throughout the Fellowship.
- Consider the possibility of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine chairs serving for two years instead of automatic rotation after one.
- Utilize our service pamphlets such as "Circles of Love and Service" to help explain the service structure throughout the Fellowship and develop literature specifically on the topic of service sponsorship.

Question 15:

What more could be done to ensure broad diversity of representation in our A.A. leaders?

How are we encouraging A.A. members to be active at all levels of our service structure? "Efforts like translation to increase inclusivity at events are helpful, but what needs to be broadened is personal acceptance of others"; "we have a lot to do as a Fellowship in the area of diversity. Lots of barriers. If we can show we are making advances in language areas, we can make a difference in diversity"; "diversity is not a reason to elect someone. Diversity is a concern for our entire Fellowship. We need to nurture people into leadership. Service teaches loud people how to listen and quiet people to have a voice"; "we not only need to reach out, but to do so in a sensitive and informed manner"; "differences should be recognized and respected, but if emphasis is kept on our common problem and our common solution these differences don't need to be perpetuated or become problematic to overall unity."

Recommendations/Suggestions:

- Include and encourage more diverse members, including special needs members, into leadership roles throughout the Fellowship.
- Continue addressing the language needs of members throughout the service structure.
- Consider having a military or ICYPAA service desk at the General Service Office.

■ Reports from the General Service Board, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: We come together to conduct our 64th General Service Conference under the theme "Communicating Our Legacies—Vital in a Changing World." The theme seems particularly relevant as we continue the Conference Inventory Process, which began last year with encouraging results. In spite of a few time-management apprehensions the Conference moved ahead, thoughtfully covering the inventory questions and attending to the work placed before them. This year we will once again consider 15 inventory questions, as scheduled in the three-year inventory plan, and consider many and diverse items placed before each of our Conference committees. In each case we will look for guidance in the spirit of our Legacies: Recovery, Unity and Service.

Since our last Conference we have said farewell to two dear friends. Wayne Parks, past Southwest regional trustee and past G.S.O. general manager, passed away in Rogers, Arkansas on January 26, 2014. Marty Watters, Western Canada regional trustee, died peacefully and surrounded by the love of his family on March 4, 2014. Both Wayne and Marty expressed their love and gratitude to A.A. through their tireless and dedicated service. Let's take a minute of silence to remember our friends Wayne and Marty.

Since the 63rd Conference, the General Service Board has hosted Regional Forums in Cromwell, Connecticut; Charleston, West Virginia; Bloomington, Minnesota; Oklahoma City, Oklahoma; Fort Wayne, Indiana; and Winnipeg, Manitoba.

This last year our General Service Board welcomed two new Class A trustees, the Hon. Ivan L.R. Lemelle, and David M. Morris, C.P.A. Additionally, the board welcomed Bob Wilcox, trustee-at-large/U.S.; Chet Parker, Southeast regional trustee; Bill Farnsworth, East Central regional trustee; and general service trustees Bill Noonan and Albin Zezula.

There have also been changes at G.S.O. Adrienne Brown retired after 17 years as a G.S.O. staff member and Eva Sanchez rotated full-time onto the 2015 International Conventions assignment. Two new staff members joined G.S.O. in the last year. Racy Joseph, from Brooklyn, NY was hired in October, 2013 and started work on the Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) desk. Clement Cann joined G.S.O. from St. Louis, MO. in January 2014, and dove right into the Corrections assignment.

Since our last Conference the General Service Board has met four times. Aside from the meeting of the members of the General Service Board at the conclusion of Conference last year, the trustees held three quarterly meetings at the Crowne Plaza Times Square in New York, N.Y.. At their July meeting, the board reviewed the 14 Initiatives shared with the General Service Conference to improve efficacy and cooperation between the A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine corporate boards as part of the General Service Board proposal to the Conference in 2013. The board agreed that initiatives relating to governance (stewardship) would be ad-

ressed by the General Service Board directly and that the A.A.W.S. Board and Grapevine Board would work together to address implementation of the remaining initiatives with interim reports provided to the General Service Board. The board decided to add a 15th Initiative with the working title of "Serving the Fellowship." Each trustee was asked for a list of their five most important questions/issues to be considered in working to better carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.

The site-selection process for the 2025 International Convention came to conclusion at the board's November meeting with the recommendation that Vancouver, British Columbia, be the site for the 2025 Alcoholics Anonymous International Convention.

At their November meeting, the chair appointed an ad hoc committee to conduct the annual review of the General Service Board section of *The A.A. Service Manual*. The board also noted that, as suggested by the 2013 Conference Committee on Public Information's Additional Committee Consideration, trustees' committees review existing literature that discusses how A.A. members apply

the Eleventh Tradition at all possible opportunities. Also in November, the board heard A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. status reports regarding progress made on the Initiatives. It was evident that positive efforts were underway on all fronts. To date, however, the two corporate boards had discussed the issues essentially in isolation. Both reports recommended that representatives from each board (and perhaps trustees not serving on either board) collaborate to move these efforts even further. Additionally the board received a report from an ad hoc work group on Initiative 15 with the working title of



"Serving the Fellowship." The committee unanimously approved a concept memo entitled, "Self-assessment and Strategic Planning for the General Service Board." Two work groups were appointed to study elements of putting a planning process in place.

In February 2014, we had the pleasure of welcoming the Conference delegate chair and the chairpersons of the Conference committees at the First Quarterly 2014 meeting of the General Service Board. Delegate chairpersons attended an orientation meeting at G.S.O., met with their committee staff secretaries, and attended sessions of corresponding trustees' committees as guest observers. The practice of inviting Conference committee chairpersons to the First Quarterly Board Weekend began in 1991 and continues to benefit the Conference process in helping delegate chairpersons fulfill their trusted service responsibilities to the Conference and A.A. as a whole.

At its February meeting the board approved updates to Nominating procedures for selection of the G.S.B. chair, G.S.O.'s general manager and the Grapevine's executive editor/publisher.

Also in February, the board received an oral report on cultural sensitivity in A.A. literature. An example used was the term "dark districts," a phrase that at times was referred to in describing "inactive" districts. Although this was never intended to be insensitive

to any culture, it was acknowledged that it could be for some. Reviewing our Conference-approved literature, it was found that this term did not appear, but that it had been used in *Box 4-5-9*. We were reminded of the need to be vigilant about such issues as we develop and modify our literature.

The board has also discussed the 2020 International Convention site and reviewed information regarding downtown Detroit's growth, development and plans for the future.

The board received reports from the two working groups addressing our self-assessment and strategic planning. These groups are currently addressing the following questions:

1. What is the mission of the GSB?
2. To whom should the GSB be providing services, now and in the future?
3. What is valued or needed by those we serve?
4. What are the results of the GSB?

The two working groups will continue their work on their original charges, and when that work has been completed, they will come together to deal with the final question,

5. What is our plan?

The board received a progress report from the ad hoc committee on the General Service Board Confidentiality and Code of Conduct. The work to date has focused primarily on a Confidentiality Policy, which was presented to and accepted by the board. The committee will now turn its attention to a Code of Conduct.

The board received a report from the GSB ad hoc committee on group safety. The report reaffirmed the findings of a 2009 GSB report on the same topic and supplied additional thoughtful suggestions. The board agreed to refer a request to the trustees' Literature Committee and a separate request to the trustees' Committee on Public Information related to safety and anonymity in A.A.

At the February 2014 meeting the board discussed a January 2013 report from the ad hoc committee on trustees emeriti participation. The board unanimously agreed that a letter be sent to the trustees emeriti, expressing our gratitude for their continuing service, and encourage them to continue to share their experience and wisdom with us and attend board meetings and Conferences at our expense. In February the board also approved a plan from the trustees' Joint Task Force on the Initiatives, formed by representatives of both the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Boards. The plan carefully assesses the current and future use of office space for both the A.A. Grapevine and General Service offices.

Some trustees, G.S.O.'s general manager and staff were invited to travel overseas to Ukraine, South Africa, Russia, Ecuador, Germany and Poland. Highlights of trustee and staff travel include: Phyllis Halliday, general manager, and G.S.O. International desk staff member Mary Clare Lynch attended the 15th Ukrainian A.A. Service Conference, and Mary Clare attended the 6th Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting in Johannesburg, South Africa. Mary Clare also traveled, with Greg Tobin, Publishing director, to Irkutsk, Russia for the 10th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting (AOSM). Trustee-at-large Bob Wilcox attended the 18th REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) in Salinas, Ecuador. Phyllis Halliday and Rick Walker, staff member on the International desk, attended the European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany. Zonal service meetings are invaluable to emerging countries and are held in the Americas, Asia-Oceania, Europe and Sub-Saharan Africa; they provide opportunities to discuss the challenges of creating service structures, literature distribution and practicing A.A. principles in all their affairs.

This year we will be celebrating the 23rd World Service Meeting in Warsaw, Poland. The theme is "The Three Legacies: Vital for All

Generations." Once again, delegates from around the world will share their experience, strength and hope in carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics everywhere.

At the close of this Conference, three trustees will rotate—Rod Betonney, Donald Cusson and Roberta Lindeman. We are grateful for their dedication, self-sacrifice and tireless service on behalf of the Fellowship.

This week we will share much that will enable us to reach decisions based on an informed group conscience. The communication among us will allow and encourage us to participate. Putting thought into actions should be our measure of success. The Conference process truly embodies the Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. Let us continue to carry out the vision given to us by our cofounders and early Conference pioneers.

Terrance Bedient, chairperson

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation, composed of nine directors. Members of A.A.W.S., Inc. are the 21 trustees of the General Service Board, who elect the nine directors responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), group services, printing and distribution of Conference-approved literature and service material. A.A.W.S. owns copyrights on A.A. literature, and is responsible for translations of A.A. literature, including titles licensed to A.A. boards in other countries.

A.A.W.S. directors include two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three nontrustee directors; and G.S.O.'s general manager and staff coordinator. Essential nonvoting support personnel attend each board meeting: director of staff services, G.S.O. staff, chief financial officer, publishing director, human resources manager, archivist, and board secretary.

Each year directors serving on Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. report to the General Service Conference on A.A. publishing, group services provided by G.S.O., and other activities linked directly to A.A.'s primary purpose. I am privileged to present this report on behalf of my fellow directors. The purpose of the publishing activities and group services provided by A.A.W.S. and G.S.O., as requested from the Fellowship, is to support members' and groups' Twelfth-Step efforts to reach the still-suffering alcoholic. The structure, composition and responsibilities of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. are described in Chapter 10 of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The A.A.W.S. Board has met seven times since the 63rd Conference to receive reports from G.S.O. management and staff, review updates on group services activity, track progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations related to A.A.W.S., review financial reports, price new and revised publications, consider publishing operations and G.S.O. administrative matters, discuss requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s seeking permission to reprint A.A. copyrighted literature, and to address other pertinent matters. The A.A.W.S. Board also met three times since the 63rd Conference to conduct its strategic planning sessions.

The A.A.W.S. Board utilizes the committee system to address extensive agendas, to gather background material, and to thoroughly consider requests. The board, in turn, discusses committee reports and votes on any recommendations presented by a board committee in these reports. In addition, the board conducts long-range and strategic planning. Committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services (addresses the needs of service assignments, reviews G.S.O. communications with the Fellowship, and oversees G.S.O.'s A.A. website); Publishing (reviews reprints, international translations of literature and other publishing matters); Finance (oversees

budgeting and financial results); and Nominating (recommends candidates for nontrustee director and general service trustee vacancies).

Group Services — A net total of 1921 new A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada were listed at G.S.O. last year. Each new group's general service representative (G.S.R.) or contact receives A.A. literature and basic information to encourage the group to link with their local structure and support Twelfth Step activities.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Website — Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. website is the responsibility of the A.A.W.S. Board of Directors, acting through its Services and Publishing Committees and in accordance with the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous.

- **Website Redesign:** The www.aa.org website redesign is scheduled to be deployed in the Spring of 2014. The redesign is a collaborative effort within the office and is intended to provide visitors with greater ease in navigating the site, more intuitive search functionality, and a more contemporary design. Some of the new features include an enhanced "Find A.A. Near You" page and an updated Archives portal, as well as a more user-friendly organization of information for A.A. trusted servants.

- **Online Store:** The A.A.W.S. Online Store was launched in two stages in 2013: in May for bulk-order customers and in October for general consumers. Traffic on the two Online Store sites has steadily increased over the past several months. Currently we are achieving about 40 % of our total literature sales online.

- **Activity Reports:** The board approved the 2013 Quarterly and Annual Website Activity Reports, and forwarded them to the trustees' Committee on Public Information. These reports detail requests for changes and additions to the website and how they are addressed. The annual report is provided to the Conference Committee on Public Information by the trustees' Committee on Public Information.

Forums and Other Events — Throughout the year, G.S.O. staff members are invited to attend and participate in many local and area service events, conferences and conventions. These trips help provide information about G.S.O. to A.A. gatherings and help staff to gather local experience to add to other collected experience available from G.S.O.

- **Regional and Additional Forums:** Since the 63rd General Service Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff have participated in five Regional Forums in 2013: the Northeast Regional Forum in Cromwell, CT in June; an "Additional" Southeast Regional Forum in Charleston, WV in August; the West Central Regional Forum in Bloomington, MN in September; the Southwest Regional Forum in Oklahoma City, OK in October; and the East Central Regional Forum in Fort Wayne, IN in November.

- **National A.A. Archives Workshop:** G.S.O. Archivist Michelle Mirza attended the 17th Annual National A.A. Archives Workshop, in Springfield, IL, September 12-15, 2013, where the theme was "Our Past and Beyond." There were approximately 155 registered participants, including archivists serving at the area and district levels, archives committee chairs, a few past delegates and past trustees.

- **Day of Sharing — 2013:** Practicing rotation among participants, G.S.O. hosted the 2013 Day of Sharing on October 15, 2013. Stepping Stones attended for the first time and was joined by Al-Anon and NCADD. This yearly gathering continues to be an important venue for sharing among these organizations.

- **Intergroup/Central Office/A.A.W.S./A.A. Grapevine Seminar:** The 28th Annual Intergroup/Central Office/A.A.W.S./A.A.G.V. Seminar was held in Palm Springs, California, October 25-27, 2013. Members of the A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. Boards, as well as management and staff from both offices attended, including the G.S.O. staff member serving as liaison to intergroup/central offices. Seminar

participants included attendees from approximately 95 local offices. The main topics of interest were the G.S.O. Online Store and the 75th Commemorative Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

- The International Conference of Young People in A.A. (I.C.Y.P.A.A.) was held July 11-14, 2014 in Phoenix, Arizona. Bill Noonan, A.A.W.S. trustee director, and Rick Walker, G.S.O. staff member, attended and represented the A.A.W.S. Board and General Service Office.

International — Trustees, G.S.O. management and the International desk staff member receive invitations from A.A. in other countries to share information regarding licensing and translations, as well as experience with A.A. groups and trusted servants in local service structures. Highlights include:

- **47th Mexico General Service Conference:** At the invitation of Mexico's General Service Conference, Phyllis Halliday (G.S.O.'s general manager) attended their 47th General Service Conference, held March 24-29, 2013 in Mexico City, Mexico. Through presentations and sharing, she provided scope and procedures of boards; Conference structures; placing principles ahead of personalities in services; the Twelve Concepts for World Service; and the relationship of service entity and structure. Phyllis also participated in their board inventory as an observer, answering questions regarding U.S. sponsorship of the Mexican structure.

- **Ukraine 15th General Service Conference:** Phyllis Halliday and Mary Clare Lynch (G.S.O. staff member) attended Ukraine's 15th General Service Conference which was held May, 2013. Although there are fewer than 90 groups in all of Ukraine and the service structure is new, Phyllis and Mary Clare witnessed a vital structure reflecting A.A.'s principles in action throughout the Conference process, and love and service every step of the way.

- **Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting:** Held in Johannesburg, South Africa June 5-11, 2013, Mary Clare Lynch (participating as an observer) joined 23 delegates from 12 nations at the 6th Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting. Reflecting an increase in attendance from the 2011 convening, delegates in attendance represented the nations of Botswana, Ghana, Kenya, Lesotho, Malawi, Namibia, South Africa, Swaziland, Tanzania, Uganda, Zambia, and a "Class A" observer from Nigeria.

- **Asia-Oceania Service Meeting (AOSM):** 2013 marked the year of A.A. Zonal Meetings. Greg Tobin (A.A.W.S. Publishing director) and Mary Clare Lynch journeyed to Irkutsk, Russia in Siberia to attend the 2013 AOSM, which was held July 19-21, 2013.

- **European Service Meeting:** The 18th European Service Meeting (ESM) was held October 17-20, 2013 in Frankfurt, Germany. Speaking on the theme "Carrying the Message Through Service," Phyllis Halliday and Rick Walker (representing the General Service Office) were among the 47 country participants, representing 28 countries.

- **Al-Anon International Convention** — G.S.O. staff members Eva Sanchez and Julio Espallat coordinated the A.A. meetings held at the 2013 Al-Anon International Convention, which took place in Vancouver, British Columbia, July 5-7, 2013. The theme was "Celebrating Worldwide Unity." Of the approximate 4,000 attendees, 400 or so were A.A. members. Eva and Julio had a wonderful showing of 90 A.A. volunteers to help them out.

Financial — Complete audited financial details for 2013 are included in the Conference Manual and Final Conference Report. Here is an overview: Total contributions for the year ended December 31, 2013, were \$6,906,371, 3 % more than budget and 5.3 % greater than 2012 as well. Net sales for the year 2013 were \$12,604,720 (.5 % more than budget) and \$239,961 more than the year 2012. Gross margin from literature sales was \$9,614,638, approximately \$202,638 more than budget and \$223,107 more

than 2012. For the year 2013, net revenues were \$535,667 (3.7% more than budget) and operating expenses were \$107,127 (.7% less than budget). For the year 2013, total operating expenses of \$14,984,663 were approximately \$107,127 less than budget and \$701,111, or 4.91%, greater than the prior year. Total personnel costs were approximately \$81,300 less than budgeted and \$695,022 greater than 2012. For the year 2013, a profit of \$31,554 was realized, compared with a \$611,240 budgeted loss, and year 2012's positive result of \$152,446.

Over the past few years, the A.A.W.S. Finance Committee has centered its focus on self-support through member contributions — continuing to look at ways to help assure that our service structure can become self-supporting through contributions from A.A. members and groups. We are especially pleased to report that with the closing of 2013, December was noted as the highest month in contributions ever recorded. Total contributions for 2013 were recorded at 3% over budget and 5.3% over year-end 2012. We want to give a special thanks to delegates and trustees who have carried the message of self-support and its spiritual meaning throughout the Fellowship.

2014 Budget: The A.A.W.S. Board approved the 2014 budget of the General Service Office with a net profit of \$295,444; after review by the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, the budget was approved by the General Service Board.

Publishing — Sales: We ended the 2013 year with \$12,841,973 in total gross sales vs. an annual estimate of sales of \$12,800,000 (\$41,973 and 0.33% over budget).

- **Digital Publishing:** Endorsed as a 2013 Conference Advisory Action, negotiations with distributors resulted in A.A. literature being published with Apple, Barnes & Noble, and Amazon. The first publication, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, Fourth Edition (English) went live in mid-December 2013, followed by *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* (English) in early January 2014. Currently, both the Big Book and the 12 & 12 volumes are also on sale in French editions, with Spanish to come shortly. *Daily Reflections* and *Living Sober* are scheduled after the first two titles, with more publications to follow in the near future! A.A.W.S. began to receive royalty reports and payments for these publications very recently (a few months into the publishing program). It is anticipated that financial results of the new ebook publishing effort will be reported to the A.A.W.S. Board later this year.

- **International Translations:** As of December 2013, there are 69 translations of *Alcoholics Anonymous* in distribution, with 17 new translations pending. A.A.W.S. prints the Big Book in 38 languages, with 34 printed by local service structures. Fifty-two countries are licensed to print and/or distribute 1,597 publications in 50 languages. A.A.W.S. has published literature in an additional 43 languages, for a total of 93 languages.

- **75th Anniversary Commemorative Alcoholics Anonymous:** We are extremely pleased to report that by February 28, 2014 (the end of the preorder period), we received preorders for more than 100,000 units of the special edition Big Book. Preorders started shipping the beginning of April, and our warehouses were instructed to distribute all preorders by April 15, 2014.

G.S.O. and Staff Operations

- **2015 International Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous:** Eva Sanchez is in the midst of early planning for our 2015 International Convention (July 2-5, 2015 in Atlanta, Georgia), which will celebrate A.A.'s 80th Anniversary with the theme "80 Years—Happy, Joyous and Free." Registration packets will be sent to G.S.R.s, Conference members and others in the service structure, international G.S.O.s, and U.S./Canada and international Central

Offices and Intergroups in the fall of 2014.

- **Employees:** At year-end 2013, G.S.O. had 82 full-time employees, 5 part-time employees (2 of whom are part-time retirees), and 1 temporary employee. The service piece, "Services Provided by G.S.O./A.A.W.S.," describes in detail the services provided by the A.A. staff assignments and other employees at G.S.O.

- **New Employees:** In 2014, we were delighted to welcome newly appointed staff members Racy Joseph (C.P.C. assignment) and Clement Cann (Corrections assignment). Racy and Clement are quite busy getting up to speed in their respective assignments. On March 3, 2014, we welcomed David Rosen, our new Licensing manager. A veteran of the trade book publishing business for more than two decades, David will be responsible for managing the voluminous and often complicated A.A.W.S. translations and licensing functions. In accordance with the General Service Board Initiatives, David will also manage the licensing and translations for A.A. Grapevine.

Retirees: In October, 2013, we bid a fond farewell to retiring G.S.O. employees Joan Alleyne (retiring after 23 years in the Contributions department) and Adrienne Brown (a 17-year G.S.O. staff member). We also said goodbye to Joe Moglia (the last G.S.O. employee personally hired by Bill Wilson) who retired in April 2014; and staff member Mary Dargan who will retire as of September 2014. We wish all of our retirees well as they journey on to their next adventures.

G.S.O. Visitors: In 2013, G.S.O. welcomed 1,942 visitors (including several groups of 10 to 60 members). It is not unusual to see visitors standing quietly with tears in their eyes in front of the multiple translations of the Serenity Prayer in the entrance hallway — many of whom have traveled great distances to visit G.S.O. and to express their gratitude for their sobriety.

Archives: One of the main highlights for members is a visit to the G.S.O. Archives where the welcoming Archives staff provides information and answers questions. Last year, the Archives staff responded to 1,480 requests for information and research — a clear indication of the Fellowship's continued interest in Archives and A.A. history.

Reprint Requests: During 2013, A.A.W.S. granted permission/ did not object to 100 requests to reprint from A.A. literature, and denied permission (including lack of authority to grant permission) to 48 requests.

The directors of A.A. World Services, Inc. and the staff of your General Service Office continue to make every effort to help carry our message of hope and recovery to those both in and out of our rooms. We much appreciate the continuing support of our great Fellowship in helping to further these efforts, and look forward to another year of "trudging the Road of Happy Destiny" together.

J. Gary Lutz, chairperson



Literature Distributed — 2013

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	441,164
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	346,856
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	42,819
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	142,311
Daily Reflections	139,364
Daily Reflections (large print)	12,710
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	148,449
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	5,891
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	154,425
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	20,037
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	42,859
A.A. Comes of Age	8,359
As Bill Sees It	25,159
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	24,171
As Bill Sees It (large print)	6,138
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	7,860
"Pass It On"	6,143
Experience, Strength & Hope	9,631
Total	1,584,346

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	22,128
Living Sober	131,277
Living Sober (large print)	8,836
Came to Believe	44,406
Came to Believe (large print)	4,048
A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate	17,653
Total	228,348

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	12,542
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	29,131
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	27,698
A.A. for the Native North American	17,995
A.A. for the Woman	77,639
The A.A. Group	78,255
A.A. in Your Community	33,322
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	16,581
A.A. in Treatment Settings	19,616
The A.A. Membership Survey	29,669
The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs	82,741
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	22,490
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	10,283
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	109,724
Circles of Love and Service	35,476
Bridging the Gap	30,789
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	13,049
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	10,214
Do You Think You're Different?	96,831
Frequently Asked Questions	170,495
Frequently Asked Questions (large print)	6,945
G.S.R.	35,428
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	15,074
How A.A. Members Cooperate	13,598
How It Works	60,747
If You Are a Professional	25,085
Inside A.A.	34,653
A.A. for the Black and African American Alcoholic	26,987
Is A.A. for You?	329,072
Is A.A. for Me?	91,029

Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	13,979
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	57,823
It Happened to Alice	28,132
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	42,006
The Jack Alexander Article	17,115
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	7,550
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	37,885
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	28,971
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	8,125
A Newcomer Asks	299,857
Problems Other Than Alcohol	96,561
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	266,632
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	12,614
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	29,821
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	58,606
Twelve Tradition Flyer	5,301
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	55,663
This Is A.A.	238,230
This Is A.A. (large print)	5,804
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	15,711
A.A. for the Older Alcoholic (Lrg Print)	43,234
Too Young?	47,740
Understanding Anonymity	53,885
What Happened to Joe	27,679
Young People and A.A.	80,611
A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs	13,929
Total	3,156,622

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards — Preamble, 12 & 12, Serenity Prayer	234,674
Wallet cards — I Am Responsible	36,288
Wallet cards — Anonymity	27,202
Anonymity Display Card	2,392
Parchment-scrolls	1,420
Placards	504
C.P.C. Workbook	1,130
Archives Workbook	422
Corrections Workbook	1,090
P.I. Workbook	1,368
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,306
Treatment Facility Kit	350
Special Needs Workbook	429
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk 12	
A.A. Guidelines	73,412
Group Handbook	1,983
Wire Racks	1,472
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	10
Audio CDs	621
DVD's	4,006
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	44
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cassette album)	9
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cd album)	2,177
A.A. Comes of Age (cd album)	353
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	17
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cd album)	1,093
TV Public Service Announcement	338
Radio Public Service Announcements	121
Twelve Steps Shade displays	1,459
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,374
Fact File	1,691
Table Top Display 12 & 12	419
Pioneers of AA (cassette album)	1
Pioneers of AA (cd album)	74
Living Sober (cassette album)	18
Living Sober (cd album)	284
Total	399,563
Grand Total	5,368,879

SPANISH

Books & Booklets

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	11,970
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	8,156
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	5,524
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous Large Print)	3,441
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	4,194
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	2,428
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	1,992
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	2,495
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	8,917
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	10,225
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./ Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	3,461
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	14,200
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	6,026
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	4,253
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	3,791
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (large print)	4,353
De las tinieblas hacia la luz	2,906
Total	98,332

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	6,504
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	23,053
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	16,200
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	47,234
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	7,976
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	4,894
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	2,295
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	1,932
Seamos amistosos con nuestros amigos (Let's be Friendly with our Friends)	650
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	2,841
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	7,639
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	4,787
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	5,141
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	2,386
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	7,108
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	7,051
El Miembro de A.A. — Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs)	4,390
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	4,935
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	1,037
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	9,393
La Tradición de A.A. — ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition — How It Developed)	1,725
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	9,857
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	1,511
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	4,930

Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	4,956
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	663
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	2,031
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,094
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	1,087
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	2,689
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	5,846
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	4,443
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	911
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	8,450
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,753
¿Hay un alcohólico en el lugar de trabajo? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	2,003
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	8,691
A.A. para el alcohólico de edad avanzada (A.A. for the older alcoholic)	4,324
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	5,173
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	2,349
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	912
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	2,561
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,839
El Legado de Servicio de A.A. (A.A. Legacy of Service)	636
Si Usted es un Profesional (If you are a Professional...)	1,307
El Grapevine y La Viña de A.A. (Grapevine...Our Meeting in Print)	1,140
¿Demasiado Joven? (Too Young?)	3,506
Alcohólico Necesidades Especiales AA for the Alcoholic with Special Needs	592
Total	255,425

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	7,327
Parchments, Spanish	359
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	10,963
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	7
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cd album) (Big Book on cd)	636
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	8
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (cd album)	715
Total	20,015
Grand Total	373,772

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous — format relie)	3,561
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous — format souple)	786
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous — format poche)	603
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous — large print)	1,654
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions	

(Twelve & Twelve — format relie)	1,512
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve — format souple)	811
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve — large print)	772
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve — format poche)	626
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	243
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	1,966
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	3,404
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	288
(Expérience, Force & Espoir) (Experience, Strength and Hope)	337
Transmets-Le (Pass It On)	469
Les A.A. en Prison (A.A. in Prison)	1,476
Total	18,508

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus à croire (Came to Believe)	1,516
Vivre... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	2,971
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,006
Total	5,493

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	8,002
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	3,325
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	8,532
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	1,507
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	370
Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans Votre Milieu de travail? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	1,132
Le membre des A.A. face aux médicaments et à la drogue (The A.A. Member — Medications & Other Drugs)	1,735
Les A.A. — Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	526
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	514
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	3,213
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	1,564
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	193
La Tradition des A.A. et son développement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	910
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	1,458
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	807
Jean face à son problème d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	865
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	1,970
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	1,588
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	366
Les Douze Traditions illustrées (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,810
Les A.A. dans les établissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	299
Ça vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	852
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	1,994
Les membres du clergé se renseignent	

(Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	325
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	557
Message à l'intention d'un détenu (Memo to an Inmate)	808
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	306
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	2,006
Les Douze Concepts illustrés (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,643
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	1,936
Trois causeries à des sociétés médicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	784
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,452
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,686
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	180
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,747
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,156
L'Héritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	319
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	1,310
Vous croyez-vous différent? (Do You Think You're Different?)	873
Sondage sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	2,019
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	1,445
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	1,367
AA pour l'alcoolique plus âgé (AA for the older alcoholic)	1,322
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	3,631
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,596
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	293
Les Douze Etapes Illustrées (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,626
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	438
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amérique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	599
Pour L'alcoolique Besoins Spéciaux (A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs)	543
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	1,477
Total	76,976

Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	1
12 & 12 (cd album)	364
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (cd album)	424
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	1,432
Carte anonymat (Français/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	750
Carte Je Suis Responsable (I am responsible wallet card)	100
Video Cassettes	0
DVDS	29
Notre Méthode (How It Works)	11,226
Manuel de Groupe	34
Pochette de l'Information Publique	29
Pochette des Centres de Detention	23
Pochette de la CMP	1
Prière de la Sérénité (12x16) (Parchment Serenity Prayer)	21
Pochette des Centres de Traitement	6
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	83
Total	14,523
Grand Total	115,500

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Directors' report: A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is one of two affiliate corporations of the General Service Board and the multimedia publisher of Grapevine magazine content, available on various platforms and in a variety of formats. A.A. Grapevine, Inc. also publishes Spanish-language content in La Viña magazine and its related book, CD and audio formats.

By charter, the A.A. Grapevine Board consists of seven to ten directors. Since the 63rd Conference, there have been eight directors: two general service trustees; a Class A trustee; two regional trustees; two nontrustee directors; and the executive editor/publisher.

As a rule, the purpose of the Grapevine Corporate Board is to serve the A.A. Fellowship in the following ways:

- To oversee the publishing operations of A.A. Grapevine, Inc.
- To provide sound financial management of the corporation.
- To establish corporate policies and set corporate priorities.
- To engage in the ongoing process of strategic planning.
- To operate in accordance with the principles of A.A. as expressed in the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and Twelve Concepts.

The board strives to engage the Fellowship, to ensure members' awareness of the myriad possible uses for the tools provided!

The A.A. Grapevine Board met in person seven times since the last Conference and once via an all-day teleconference. In 2013-2014, two standing committees were active: the Nominating Committee, chaired by Clayton Vandivort, facilitated all facets in the selection of candidates for board openings and drew a revised policy for hiring a new EE/P, and the Finance & Budget Committee, chaired by Andrew Ware, which provided oversight for the budget process. Three new ad hoc committees were established: the Governance Committee, chaired by Michele Grinberg, the Grass Roots Committee, chaired by Ed Martin, and the Carry the Message Committee, chaired by Albin Zezula. The Editorial Advisory Board, consisting of members with particular expertise in media, was re-established in 2012 and met five times, always by teleconference in 2013.

Since the last Conference, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. has produced 12 issues of Grapevine, six issues of La Viña, an annual wall calendar and pocket planner, and eight ebooks. La Viña magazine continues to be published in 64 pages in response to the 2010 Conference Advisory Action to maintain spiritual parity with Grapevine magazine.

A.A. Grapevine, Inc. distributed 103,727 Grapevine and La Viña books, CDs, and other items, including the two latest book titles: *One on One*, about sponsorship, and *No Matter What*, which deals

with sobriety in adversity. The 25th anniversary edition of *The Language of the Heart* was well received and was featured on a dedicated webpage on AAGV.org and the Amazon marketplace.

Circulation — Grapevine's average monthly print circulation was 77,126 in fiscal year 2013 (this is less than budget by 1,634 and less than 2012 by 6,132). Following the May 2011 relaunch of www.aagrapevine.org, an online subscription was introduced as Grapevine Online (GVO), which as of December 2013 averages 5,175 subscribers. The average bimonthly circulation of La Viña was 10,145 (this is 945 greater than budget and 988 above 2012 levels).

The Grapevine's 2010 subscriber survey conservatively shows that the magazines are passed on to approximately 2.5 readers per copy, thereby reaching an estimated 192,815 readers per Grapevine issue and 25,362 per La Viña issue.

Operations — During 2013, A.A. Grapevine continued operational cost-control measures resulting in lowered expenses, notably savings earned from a full year of outsourced circulation services as well as 56 % savings in Occupancy Costs when compared to 2011.

Financial — Complete and audited financial details for 2013 are included in the Conference Manual and *Final Conference Report*. Here is an overview:

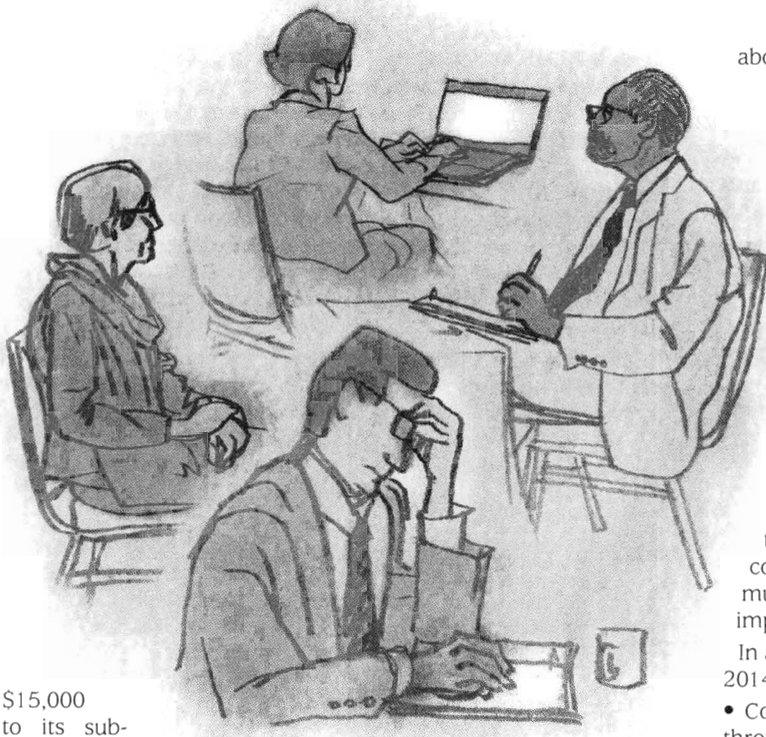
- Grapevine ended 2013 with net income of \$315,007 against budgeted net income of \$11,954.
- Revenue for the magazine and subscription products reached \$2,242,000. Gross Profit on the magazine was ahead of budget by almost \$93,000.
- Gross Profit on books and related items was above budget by \$81,000.
- Overhead Costs were budgeted at \$1,824,205 versus an actual of \$1,688,811.

This was a savings of \$135,394. This savings occurred mainly in Website Expenses and General and Administrative Expenses.

La Viña — La Viña is published by A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and expenses not covered by income are funded by the General Service Board as a service to the Fellowship. La Viña had an average circulation of 10,145 per issue. Gross Profit on the magazine was \$54,758. This is ahead of budget by \$1,127. Revenue was ahead of budget by \$9,716. Gross Profit on Related Items was below budget by about \$2,349, and overhead exceeded budget by \$14,271. The net cost for 2013 was \$142,545, or \$15,491 more than was budgeted.

A.A. Grapevine and the Reserve Fund — A.A. Grapevine maintains a balance in the Reserve Fund to fund its unfulfilled subscription liability. The balance at December 31, 2013 was \$1,928,500, and the actual subscription liability as of that date was \$1,984,816, meaning that the liability was 97.2 % funded. Not only was no drawdown from the Reserve Fund required during 2013, but (in March 2014) A.A. Grapevine, Inc. has contributed an additional





\$15,000

to its subscription liability fund and has been

able to make a donation of \$260,000 to the Reserve Fund itself! The A.A. Grapevine Board is deeply grateful to the staff for these tremendous achievements.

Website — The website was redesigned to better serve the Fellowship and to engage a wider and more diverse audience; it remains central to Grapevine's current and future plans. Month end February 2014 reports indicate that an average of 38,789 unique visitors visit an average of 3.31 pages on aagrapevine.org each month. A dedicated web page, aagrapevine.org/GV70, was created to provide information and downloadable resources to assist anyone who wants to have a GV 70th anniversary event. Featured also is a calendar for local events throughout 2014 and seven new free audio stories. A centralized audio page was established on the website for Grapevine's audio offerings, including a showcase for the Audio Project, offering up to 7-minutes-long recorded stories submitted by members; 144 audio stories have been received and have been archived to date.

Grapevine offers a complimentary Grapevine Daily Quote, featuring excerpts drawn from the archives of classic Grapevine literature. Selections are posted daily on aagrapevine.org and may be requested on an opt-in basis for daily email delivery. Subscriptions number 26,174 as of mid-March 2014.

Grapevine and La Viña subscribers are committed to the print magazine, for personal use and as an invaluable Twelfth-Step tool, and, in keeping with the Fellowship's desire and support, the print publications will continue. At the same time, Grapevine's online offerings have the potential to continue to attract new subscribers with few conversions from print. Aagrapevine.org is becoming the premiere connection with the Fellowship; the majority of subscriptions/purchases now occur online, and digital communications are both effective and cost saving. About 25% of AAGV's online subscribers opt for both the online services and the print magazine. Offered as a bundle, the Grapevine Online subscription provides unlimited access to previously unpublished stories, Audio Grapevine, the Story Archive and the current online issues of both Grapevine and La Viña.

At current prices, GV's basic online subscription costs subscribers

about ten cents a day, and the print subscription is eight cents per day. The GVB and management team's efforts continue to broaden awareness of the magazines, books, audio and website to carry the message through an expanded subscriber base.

Limited Fellowship New Vision (FNV) list-sharing efforts with A.A.W.S. have contributed to the growth of the new informational quarterly email newsletter "Grapevine and Your Group." Further efforts to establish connections and to underscore the value and relevancy of Grapevine and La Viña to the Fellowship are central to the GV70 celebrations and the Carry the Message and Grassroots/Events ad hoc committees. Organization-wide support remains important to the continued health of AAGV, Inc.

The AAGV Board and management team are committed to self-support, and A.A. Grapevine, Inc.'s continued financial vitality, with member support, while growing and evolving. The focus on financial health as demonstrated throughout 2013 will continue in 2014. It is understood that cost reduction represents only one piece of the break-even formula, while new approaches to additional revenue are equally important.

In addition, the grapevine Board is considering the following for 2014 and 2015:

- Continue expanded communications with groups directly through broader use of group contact information provided through Fellowship New Vision (FNV).
- A commemorative item for GV 70th anniversary.
- Publish *The Language of the Heart* in audiobook format.
- Include Grapevine and La Viña subscription options in the International Convention online registration forms.
- Publish a GV commemorative item for the International Convention in Atlanta in 2015.
- Offer existing GV CD content in MP3 formats.
- Reimagine the GV website for increased currency and relevancy.
- Publish audio content through third party vendors.
- Expand the digital subscriber base and communications.
- Secure appropriate office space. Current lease expires year-end 2015.
- Provide a rewarding and supportive work environment for staff, including training and development in line with stated objectives.

As a mirror of the membership, Grapevine both reflects and belongs to the Fellowship. For 70 years, Grapevine has conveyed the "Voices of A.A." as a tool for many in recovery, evolving over time and reliably carrying the message to anyone who reaches out for the hand of A.A. Should the Fellowship desire that Grapevine and La Viña continue into the future — for alcoholics and friends, many of whom may not know about A.A. yet — additional subscribers will be required. Organization-wide support for A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is integral to our history and our future.

Nancy Haynes,
chairperson



AA Grapevine Literature Distributed — 2013

Books

Best of Bill (Hard Cover)	2,095
Best of Bill (Soft Cover)	4,787
Best of Bill — Large Print (Soft Cover)	976
Best of Bill — French (Soft Cover)	1,793
The Home Group — French (Soft Cover)	190
Le Langage Du Coeur	363
Best of the Grapevine I (Soft Cover)	6
Best of the Grapevine II (Soft Cover)	555
The Language of the Heart (Hard Cover)	4,094
El Lenguaje del Corazón	1,443
Best of the Grapevine III (Soft Cover)	454
A.A. Around the World	325
The Language of the Heart (Soft Cover)	4,204
Thank You For Sharing	967
Spiritual Awakenings	2,658
The Home Group — Revised (Soft Cover)	1,258
I Am Responsible: The Hand of AA (Soft Cover)	674
Emotional Sobriety (Soft Cover)	6,186
The Language of the Heart (Large Print)	689
In Our Own Words	733
Beginners' Book	3,672
Voices of Long-Term Sobriety	1,064
A Rabbit Walks Into a Bar	2,255
Spiritual Awakenings II	1,325
Step By Step	2,255
Emotional Sobriety II (Soft Cover)	3,342
Young and Sober	2,373
Into Action	2,313
Happy, Joyous & Free	3,275
One On One	7,773
No Matter What	5,891
Best of Bill — Spanish	2,703
Lo Mejor de la Viña	711
El Grupo Base	1,077
Total:	74,786

E-books

The Language of the Heart	1,260
Best of Bill	1,378
Best of Bill — Spanish	68
Step by Step	193
Emotional Sobriety I	873
Emotional Sobriety II	269
Spiritual Awakenings I	281
Spiritual Awakenings II	118
Young and Sober	67
Into Action	132
Happy, Joyous & Free	211
Other	813
Total:	5,663

CDs - English

3,006

CDs - Spanish

1,907

Total: 4,913

Miscellaneous

18,365

GRAPEVINE SUBSCRIPTIONS* — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	APRIL 2014	APRIL 2013	INCREASE/ DECREASE
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	575	599	(24)
Alaska	370	437	(67)
Arizona	1,434	1,494	(60)
Arkansas	394	397	(3)
California	6,613	7,018	(405)
Colorado	1,330	1,426	(96)
Connecticut	1,003	1,145	(142)
Delaware	300	322	(22)
District of Columbia	138	169	(31)
Florida	3,970	4,101	(131)
Georgia	1,713	1,703	10
Hawaii	334	336	(2)
Idaho	477	549	(72)
Illinois	2,385	2,508	(123)
Indiana	1,038	1,206	(168)
Iowa	694	722	(28)
Kansas	746	832	(86)
Kentucky	635	709	(74)
Louisiana	568	582	(14)
Maine	466	462	4
Maryland	975	1,041	(66)
Massachusetts	1,763	1,955	(192)
Michigan	2,261	2,443	(182)
Minnesota	1,895	1,965	(70)
Mississippi	326	312	14
Missouri	1,178	1,245	(67)
Montana	486	453	33
Nebraska	610	645	(35)
Nevada	673	691	(18)
New Hampshire	481	550	(69)
New Jersey	2,092	2,243	(151)
New Mexico	483	509	(26)
New York	4,172	4,353	(181)
North Carolina	1,664	1,635	29
North Dakota	300	350	(50)
Ohio	1,780	1,865	(85)
Oklahoma	526	569	(43)
Oregon	1,166	1,207	(41)
Pennsylvania	4,039	4,362	(323)
Rhode Island	227	268	(41)
South Carolina	685	726	(41)
South Dakota	265	299	(34)
Tennessee	791	828	(37)
Texas	2,699	2,817	(118)
Utah	421	426	(5)
Vermont	268	312	(44)
Virginia	1,801	1,843	(42)
Washington	2,027	2,203	(176)
West Virginia	268	299	(31)
Wisconsin	1,735	1,891	(156)
Wyoming	223	208	15
Puerto Rico	15	18	(3)
U.S. Possessions/APO	42	48	(6)
Virgin Islands	31	32	(1)
Subtotal US	63,551	67,328	(3,777)
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	708	799	(91)
British Columbia/YKN	923	897	26
Manitoba	288	309	(21)
New Brunswick/PEI	232	222	10
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	345	319	26
Ontario	2,832	2,955	(123)
Quebec	235	182	53
Saskatchewan	342	353	(11)
Subtotal Canada	5,905	6,036	(131)
FOREIGN	728	761	(33)
Grand Total	70,184	74,125	(3,941)
LA VIÑA SUBSCRIPTIONS*			
	Mar./Apr. '14	Mar./Apr. '13	Diff.
	8,273	7,426	847

(*does not include monthly orders)

■ Trustees' Committees and G.S.O. and Grapevine Reports

ARCHIVES

Trustees' report: The trustees' Archives Committee was established by the General Service Board and held its first meeting in October 1973. This committee is responsible for developing and implementing the policies that govern the Archives services and makes recommendations to the General Service Board on Archives procedures and budget. Through its group conscience, and guided by A.A.'s principles and professional standards, the committee undertakes and upholds responsibility and authority for the maintenance and use of the Archives.

The committee supports the G.S.O. Archives' commitment to permit access to members of Alcoholics Anonymous and others for research purposes. Each request is carefully considered through recommendations from the Archivist and established Archives policies. The permission to conduct research is granted on condition of a signed agreement to strictly maintain the anonymity of all members, alive and deceased, including A.A.'s cofounders. The committee has had three meetings since the 2013 General Service Conference, and granted permission to 16 researchers for use of archival materials.

At the committee's first meeting in July, we made our annual review of the History and Actions and noted some significant actions and Archives policies. We discussed three Conference Archives Committee Advisory Actions:

Markings on the Journey — In July, we reviewed a progress report on the production of the video *Markings on the Journey* as recommended by the 2013 General Service Conference. After viewing

a draft of *Markings on the Journey* at the November meeting, the committee agreed to forward the revised draft video *Markings on the Journey* to the 2014 Conference Committee on Archives for approval.

Commemorative 75th Anniversary Edition Big Book — As recommended by the 2013 General Service Conference, a commemorative 75th Anniversary Edition of the first edition, first printing of *Alcoholics Anonymous* will be published in April 2014. At the July 2013 meeting, the Archivist informed the committee that a memorandum concerning this item was sent to A.A. World Services, Inc. and G.S.O.'s Publishing director for further action.

Posting anonymity-protected audio clips on G.S.O.'s A.A. Website — The committee discussed the 2013 Conference Archives Committee Advisory Action that freely accessible, anonymity-protected archival clips be posted on G.S.O.'s A.A. website. In accord with this action, we agreed that the selection and posting of the clips will be done at the discretion of the Archivist. At our November meeting, the Archivist presented a list of three audio clips that were selected and added to the new audio library on the "Archives" portal of the A.A. website.

The committee discussed the ongoing audio cataloging project and requested that the Archivist compose a report on the extent of the digitized recordings yet to be cataloged. We reviewed and discussed the report and requested that the Archivist keep the committee apprised of the project's status.

We also discussed how new materials are accessioned into the G.S.O. Archives collection and requested that the Archivist prepare a report detailing this process, specifying materials created or compiled by the General Service Office and the A.A. Grapevine. Following a review of the report, the committee suggested that a copy of the report be included in the Archives Policies packet that is provided to the committee in July, and included in the orientation binder for new trustees. We also suggested that the A.A. Grapevine Board minutes be included in the Archives' collection.

Throughout the year, we were kept apprised of projects executed by the Archives staff, as well as tabulated research inquiries handled by the staff. The Archivist also apprised the committee of projected goals outlined for the upcoming year.

The trustees' committee is extremely pleased with the work of the Archivist and her staff. The committee believes that under the Archivist's supervision we are making progress in properly handling and securing the archival materials for future generations, while providing current members of the Fellowship with tangible links to A.A.'s past through mechanisms such as the *Markings* newsletter, the audio clips on the aa.org website and displays in the G.S.O. archives' space. It is a privilege to serve as chair of this committee.

Michele Grinberg, chairperson

Archivist report: The mission of the General Service Office Archives is to permanently document the work of Alcoholics Anonymous, to make the history of the organization accessible to A.A. members and other researchers, and to provide a context for understanding A.A.'s progression, principles and traditions. The Archives staff assumes full ownership of the materials under our care. This means that we exercise professional judgment in acquiring, appraising, organizing, preserving, securing and managing the vast array of historical materials we manage.



The year 2013 marked the 38th anniversary of the G.S.O. Archives official opening. We serve the Fellowship by providing resource material and service to A.A. members, researchers and others about A.A. history, respond to worldwide information requests, and offer professional support to local A.A.s interested in researching their group or area's history. In 2013, we responded to over 1,480 requests for information. This is one of the many ways that we are committed to rendering service to the A.A. community and others. We welcomed new local archivists and committee chairs serving either in the area or district position and furnished each individual with an Archives Workbook, Guidelines and other resources.

We also endeavor to raise awareness of A.A.'s history and archives through our newsletter, which is now known by its new title, *Markings: Your Archives eNewsletter*, formerly, *Your Archives Interchange*. This is an electronic newsletter published three times a year, in English, Spanish and French, and delivered to subscribers via A.A.'s Digital Delivery system.

We have been reporting on our ongoing multiyear project that involves the development of the Archives audio catalog. This is a multiple-phase project that requires listening to thousands of audio recordings arranged by category. In 2012, we began cataloging a series comprised of over three thousand recordings of oldtimers, early friends of A.A. and others. It is an incredibly worthwhile project because these recordings provide a glimpse of A.A.'s way of life in the past. Thus far, we have completed listening to and cataloging over 1,000 recordings.

In keeping with our mission, the Archives associate archivists worked with several personal collections and papers to preserve, arrange and create Finding-Aids. One of the collections include the papers of Hart Sonju, an A.A. member who served in the United States Air Force and who translated works, letters, etc. for Norway and Sweden on our behalf. The Archives staff also has begun a two-year project of photographing and cataloging each edition and printing of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, stored onsite. The photographs are to be added to the Archives library for the purpose of building a comprehensive Big Book catalog. This endeavor also serves to support preservation aims by decreasing physical handling when locating a particular book.

We commenced another multiyear project of preserving our photograph and negative collection. Once completed, the next step entails cataloging each print or negative at the item based level. Another new project instituted last year entailed the scanning of thousands of early group correspondence from the United States, Canada and around the world (1940s through 1950s). The original records are being preserved for permanent storage in the Archives' secured offsite facility. We also scanned many of the early pamphlets published by the Alcoholic Foundation and Works Publishing (predecessor to the General Service Board and A.A.W.S., Inc.), as well as every discontinued and one-time printed pamphlets. This endeavor will help reduce the handling of those pamphlets and enable efficiency in conducting research.

The Archives' onsite exhibits are intended to stimulate interest and inform visitors about a particular aspect of A.A.'s history or of a specific collection. These are just a few of the exhibits we highlighted last year: a history of the A.A. Grapevine; 24th Street Clubhouse; Founders Day; publishing histories of foreign Big Books; and an exhibit featuring recognition of A.A. from former United States Presidents.

None of this work would be possible without the help of a very capable team of Archivists, working to ensure that we fulfill our mission and goals.

Finally, the Archives staff extends gratitude to those members and others who have generously donated material to the Archives within the past twelve months.

Michelle Mirza, archivist



AUDIT COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Audit Committee, formed by the General Service Board in 2003, is composed of a minimum of three and a maximum of five trustees who are appointed by the chairman of the General Service Board. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The committee meets with the outside auditor and G.S.O. and Grapevine management; separately with the auditor; and in executive session without the auditor. The Audit Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews such items as audit process, audit results, internal controls, best accounting practices, and management integrity. The Audit Committee also recommends appointment of the auditor to the board.

David Morris, chairperson

COMPENSATION COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Compensation Committee, formed in 2006 by the General Service Board, consists of at least four trustees. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The Compensation Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews and advises A.A. World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. (A.A.G.V.) on such items as overall compensation philosophies and policies, best compensation practices, and compliance with the IRS for executive compensation for non-profit organizations.

The committee revised its composition, scope and procedure document for clarity, and worked with A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. to obtain the services of Astron Solutions to prepare compensation studies for the highest paid executives in each corporation. The committee received the reports and met with Astron Solutions via teleconference, both in general session and in executive session. The reports indicated that all salaries reviewed are within reasonable levels and do not represent excessive compensation.

The committee requested and received a report from Corporate Consulting Services regarding post-employment health insurance benefits. The G.S.B. treasurer also provided his analysis of all health insurance benefit costs. A future committee may wish to continue this review.

Michele Grinberg, chairperson

CONFERENCE

Trustees' report: The committee met three times since the 2013 General Service Conference. During that period, we reviewed the Report of the 2013 Conference Agenda Committee and the Advisory Actions pertaining to the Conference, including the theme chosen for the 64th General Service Conference, "Communicating Our Legacies — Vital in a Changing World."

The committee discussed the Summary of the Evaluation Form from members of the 63rd G.S.C. and the notes of the G.S.O. Sharing Session and agreed to create a subcommittee to review the evaluation summaries from the three most recent General Service Conferences. The committee reviewed the report of the G.S.C. Summary Evaluation Review subcommittee and discussed several opportunities for improvements:

- Agreed to make discussion of the translation of G.S.C. background a standing agenda item for the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Agreed with the suggestions for a more user-friendly dashboard, more charging stations for electronic devices at the G.S.C., and for WIFI access for all Conference members to be included in the hotel package. The committee asked the secretary to forward these suggestions to A.A.W.S. along with this report.
- Agreed it would be helpful if financial information, such as the PowerPoint presentation that accompanies the Finance Report, could be made available in advance to all Conference members. The committee asked the secretary to forward this suggestion to the trustees' Finance Committee.
- Requested that the secretary compile information regarding current practice and policy regarding distribution of General Service Conference background for the February 2014 meeting.

The committee also:

- Discussed a request to include the Finance Report slides in the *Final Conference Report* and asked the secretary to forward this request to the Publishing Department with the suggestion that a footnote be inserted into the *Final Conference Report* indicating that the slides referenced in the Finance Report are available upon request, which is current practice. It was noted that the Finance Report in the *Final Conference Report* references the slides that were used during the Finance presentation.
- Discussed a request to update *The A.A. Service Manual* to better reflect how the General Service Office's database is utilized for reporting and sharing group information, and asked the secretary to forward this request to the secretary of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter for consideration as part of the annual review process of *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- Reviewed a list of topics submitted to the Conference assignment at G.S.O. for consideration as agenda items in 2014. Thirty-two items were forwarded to trustees' and Conference committees, or to the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Corporate Boards; two items were tabled and on one the committee agreed to take no action.
- Reviewed and approved the schedule for the 64th General Service Conference week, which includes sessions for the fifteen inventory groups to discuss assigned inventory questions, reports from inventory groups, followed by full Conference body discussion as outlined in the Inventory Plan approved in 2011. The committee noted how well the schedule for the 63rd G.S.C. flowed with incorporation of the G.S.C. Inventory and that the 2014 G.S.C. schedule includes time for the Inventory Groups and Reports in the same manner.
- Discussed the interaction between the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and the Conference Policy and Ad-

missions Committee and asked the secretary to invite the chairperson of the 2014 Conference Policy and Admissions Committee to attend the February 2014 meeting. It was noted that this would give the Conference Policy and Admissions Committee chairperson the opportunity to observe discussion of agenda items that might be forwarded to their committee.

The committee forwarded to the trustees' Literature Committee a request that the Conference Literature Committee consider granting the approval to use the "circle and triangle" with the words recovery/unity/service as an unofficial service mark on A.A. Literature where the Publishing Department determines it is appropriate.

- Forwarded to the 2014 Conference Policy and Admissions Committee a request to consider an anonymous electronic voting system to be utilized on all nonelection votes for a trial period.
- Discussed the 2013 Conference Finance Committee Additional Committee Consideration concerning Conference site-selection.

The committee forwarded to the 2014 Conference Policy and Admissions Committee the following agenda item: Reconsider the policy established by the 2008 General Service Conference that the responsibility for General Service Conference site-selection be delegated to General Service Office management, subject to the approval of the General Service Board.

- Forwarded to the 2014 Conference Committee on the Grapevine the following request: "To reaffirm the Right of Decision of the A.A. Grapevine Board to make formatting decisions for the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña magazines."
- Discussed a request that the 2014 Conference Committee on Report and Charter consider adding the list of "Proposed Conference Agenda Items Submitted for G.S.C. on which the Trustees' Committees or Boards Took No Action or Tabled the Item" to the *Final Conference Report* and agreed to take no action. The committee noted that these items are "proposals" and not Conference agenda items; the *Final Conference Report* reflects what takes place at the General Service Conference; and, the list of "Proposed Conference Agenda Items Submitted for G.S.C. on which the Trustee's Committees or Boards Took No Action or Tabled the Item" is made available to all Conference members, who may distribute it as they choose.
- A random drawing was held to fulfill the number of voters required for election of the Pacific regional trustee during the 64th General Service Conference. The committee forwarded to the secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees one additional delegate voter.

The committee agreed to add these topics to their August 2014 agenda: Discuss the process of forwarding proposed agenda items to Conference Committees that do not have a corresponding trustees' committee; and the relationship of the trustee's Committees and the Conference Committees that do not have a corresponding trustees' committee.

The committee tabled discussion on the following topics for their next meeting in August 2014:

Two requests regarding online groups: one request pertained to the policy established by the 2005 Conference Advisory Action regarding listing of online groups and the other pertained to the participation of online groups in the General Service Structure.

Current policy and practice on distribution of General Service Conference background and a suggestion that "the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference develop a policy and procedure that would allow each Conference Committee chair to confer with the corresponding trustees' Committee chairperson and the Committee secretary to discuss the background available and appropriate for the Committees' agenda items."

Our committee sincerely hopes that everyone has a productive and enriching Conference experience and that we will all continue to enjoy the wonderful life that has been given to us.

Clayton Vandivort, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

The annual meeting of the General Service Conference, which first met in July 1955, is the closest thing A.A. has to a group conscience in the U.S. and Canada. A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area structures for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referred directly to a Conference committee. Occasionally topics are submitted that are more appropriately under the purview of either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards. These items are accordingly forwarded to those boards for their attention. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme and presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval. In Conference inventory years 2013-2015 there are no workshops.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publishing Department, the summer edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the *Final Conference Report*.

Mary Cumings

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT/ SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities were combined by action of the General Service Board in April 1998. Then, in August of 2009, the trustees' committee expanded its scope to include service to Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees and oversight of Special Needs literature. The title of the committee has been changed to Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities. Since the 2013 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee has met three times.

Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) — The committee undertook the following tasks this past year:

- In response to the recommendations and additional considerations from the 2013 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, the committee reviewed the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional..." and agreed to forward to the 2014 General Service Conference Committee on C.P.C. changes to the section *How to Make Referrals to A.A.* and a change regarding the title of the section *Referrals from Court and Treatment Fa-*

cilities, along with broadening the scope of this section to address a wider group of professionals.

- The committee reviewed the paragraph on page 6 of the pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional," beginning with "I can't stand the smoking," and agreed to forward to the 2014 General Service Conference Committee on C.P.C. the suggestion to eliminate specific portions of the text.
- The committee continues to explore the use of Class A and Class B trustees in C.P.C. efforts.

Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities:

- In response to the recommendations and additional considerations from the 2013 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities, the committee agreed to insert into the *Special Needs-Accessibilities Committee Workbook* a memo containing text related to the gathering of information regarding local special needs efforts.
- The committee agreed to forward to the 2014 General Service Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities the proposal to consider revising the pamphlet "Bridging the Gap," to expand its scope to include information on related corrections service activity.

John A. Fromson, MD, chairperson

Staff Reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — Experience indicates that many professionals are aware of A.A., yet relatively few know what A.A. is or what we do, and even fewer have been to an "open" A.A. meeting. The staff member on the Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) assignment, along with an assistant, provides information about A.A. and facilitates communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

The C.P.C. desk responds daily to numerous inquiries from professionals. In 2013, 311 professional requests for information on A.A. were associated with visits to G.S.O.'s A.A. website. Hundreds of other requests arrived by letter, email, fax and phone. Many of these professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees who responded with offers for direct contact, information about how to send clients to meetings, offers of literature, or other means to assure that A.A. is a resource for professionals.

The Summer 2013 issue of *About A.A.*, our newsletter for professionals, featured articles on a new Spanish Public Service Announcement that is currently being aired as a way to carry A.A.'s message and an article detailing the production, in American Sign Language (ASL), of the pamphlet "A.A. for the Alcoholic With Special Needs" in CD and DVD formats for those who are deaf, blind, or have learning challenges. In the Fall 2013 newsletter the topic of Anonymity and New Media Technologies is discussed. A continuation of this topic will be highlighted in the Spring 2014 *About A.A.* newsletter. Currently, more than 9,000 professionals receive *About A.A.* Approximately one-third of the list receives the newsletter via A.A.'s Digital Delivery system.

Professional exhibits continue to result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members. The C.P.C. assignment arranged for displays at 26 national or international conferences of professionals in 2013. At these exhibits, G.S.O. provides the booth space, display and literature; local C.P.C. committees coordinate A.A. volunteers who staff the booth to answer questions and provide literature and contacts. Thousands of professionals in a broad range of fields visited the A.A. booth at these national events. In the interest of extending the hand of A.A. to all who suffer, each year some Pub-

lic Information events are also included, such as AARP and La Raza. In addition, 11 local exhibits were referred to area C.P.C. committees. G.S.O. furnished C.P.C. material for several exhibits and events set up by local committees.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O. and encouraged to attend "open" A.A. meetings. During visits in the fall and winter of 2013, topics that often peaked the highest interest among medical students were those regarding A.A.'s Sixth and Seventh Traditions.

The staff member on C.P.C. also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings, such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) and Recovery Month planning meetings.

Racy Joseph

Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities/LIM — The purpose of the Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities assignment is to share A.A. and service committee experience and information with trusted servants involved with these distinct committees. While the two types of services committees which make up this assignment may strive to carry the A.A. message of recovery from alcoholism to different populations of alcoholics, the overall purpose of the assignment is to share A.A. and service committee experience and information through literature, activity updates and other communications. The assignment currently communicates with approximately 981 area, district and Intergroup/Central Office Treatment, Bridging the Gap (BTG), Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) and Special Needs-Accessibilities committee chairpersons.

Communication with these trusted servants begins with a welcome letter from the assignment coordinator, along with some of the service-related materials that might be helpful as the committee chair starts out in their new position. While physical materials are still sent through the mail, the new trusted servants are also directed to G.S.O.'s A.A. website (www.aa.org) where A.A. Guidelines, service committee Workbooks, and other A.A. materials may be read and/or printed. In addition, all area level service committee chairs receive a list of other area level service committee chairs to facilitate sharing experiences and activities.

During their term of service, committee chairs receive updates on other committees' activities through articles in *Box 4-5-9*, and receive updates from the assignment coordinator that may contain ideas, activities, questions and solutions from other committees. These assignment updates also contain items of interest from the General Service Office, requests for sharing on a particular question when appropriate, and efforts to address possible areas of confusion.

Correspondence from newly sober clients in treatment centers, and from professionals in those facilities, is always welcome. In addition, communication is received from alcoholics with special challenges (blindness, deafness, brain injury, etc.) asking for A.A. literature in a format that they can understand. Each of these receives a response from the staff member, with as many as possible of these professionals, sober treatment clients and alcoholics with special needs linked to the appropriate local committee in the Fellowship who can serve as an additional resource.

The staff member on this assignment serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities, and as cosecretary to the trustee's Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

The staff member is also a regional correspondent to one of the eight regions in the U.S. and Canada, sharing A.A. experience

with hundreds of A.A. members monthly via emails, phone calls and written correspondence. Finally, the *Loners-Internationalists Meeting (LIM)* is under the purview of this assignment. G.S.O. receives an average of 15-20 shares per month which comprise a *confidential* bimonthly bulletin sent to Loners, Homers, Internationalists, and to Loner Sponsors and Port Contacts—members unable to attend meetings in person. The *LIM* bulletin includes full names and addresses of the 421 participants who correspond with one another year round.

Steve Smith

CORRECTIONS

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Corrections recommends to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Since the 2013 General Service Conference, the committee has met three times.

The committee reviewed a "Sample Letter of Introduction" to Correctional Facilities and "A Sample Correctional Facility Fact Sheet" in addition to suggestions submitted from the 2013 Conference Corrections Committee for inclusion of these samples in the Corrections Workbook. The committee agreed on additional revisions to the sample letter and "A Sample Correctional Facility Fact Sheet," which are now included in the current Workbook.

As requested by the 2013 Conference Corrections Committee in an Additional Committee Consideration, the staff worked with the Publishing Department to incorporate text in the Corrections Workbook section "Ideas to Stimulate Corrections Twelfth Step Work Within A.A." to reassure all A.A. members that they can participate in corrections service by sharing A.A.'s basic message about getting and staying sober. The trustees' Corrections Committee accepted the changes to the section "Ideas to Stimulate Corrections Twelfth Step Work Within A.A.," which included suggestions from the 2013 Subcommittee on Corrections Engagement Strategy. These changes will be included in the next printing of the Corrections Workbook.

Following up on an Additional Committee Consideration, the committee approved the updated service piece "Suggestions For Using the A.A. Grapevine Magazine (or La Viña) as a Tool in Corrections Service" that is retitled: "Suggestions for Using Grapevine Magazine and La Viña as Tools in Corrections Service." These changes are reflected in the current Corrections Kit.

The committee noted that the number of requests from male inmates (U.S.) for Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS) continues to increase at a rate significantly higher than the number of "outside" male volunteers available. Additionally, the committee continues to discuss the topic of developing CCS for Canada. The committee requested that staff send a communication to Corrections chairs in Canada to request shared experience on existing or developing local corrections correspondence services for inmates in Canada.

The committee discussed the 2012 Subcommittee on Corrections Engagement Strategy regarding resources and practices in support of corrections Twelfth Step work and agreed to continue the work of the subcommittee. In July 2013, the subcommittee was reappointed, which included two appointed committee members with Corrections experience. The scope of the subcommittee is to review available resources for carrying the message into Correctional Facilities and to take a strategic look at how the A.A. message is currently carried to incarcerated alcoholics. The subcommittee is reviewing all available resources with a lens of engaging more members in Corrections service.

We agreed on a proposal from the Subcommittee on Corrections Engagement Strategy that a stand alone service piece be de-

veloped on ways to engage more members to participate in Corrections service and that a questionnaire be sent from staff to area Corrections chairpersons to solicit shared experience for inclusion in the service piece.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2014 Conference Corrections Committee the following agenda items for consideration:

Revisions to the section "What A.A. does NOT do" in the pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals" in order to be consistent with similar text in C.P.C. literature that was approved by the 2012 General Service Conference.

Development of a new video to replace "It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell" (DV-08).

Frances Brisbane, chairperson

Staff report: The Corrections assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Approximately 600 pieces of mail a month arrive from inmates, many requesting free literature, others asking to participate in our Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS) or for help in making contact with A.A., either by asking for a meeting in their facility or for a prerelease contact. While not everyone who writes to G.S.O. has a problem with alcohol, all letters are answered; those indicating they have a drinking problem are provided with basic literature, information about Twelve Step services specifically designed for the alcoholic who is incarcerated, and a warm invitation to participate in the Fellowship and program of recovery of A.A.

If an incarcerated alcoholic requests free literature, he or she may be sent a Big Book, a copy of the Grapevine or La Viña, a selection of pamphlets, and often the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, with an explanation that the enclosed literature is made possible through the voluntary contributions of A.A. members throughout the United States and Canada. However, this assignment tries to avoid being viewed as the primary source of A.A. literature, since "carrying the A.A. message" in this way is an A.A. service opportunity. Requests for multiple copies for an inside group, or ongoing requests from the same facility, are usually referred to those local A.A. members doing this type of Twelfth Step service. This practice is also in keeping with past recommendations of Conference and trustees' Committees on Corrections.

The Corrections Correspondence Service, coordinated by this assignment, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many alcoholics who are incarcerated are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. To fill their requests, this assignment puts out regular pleas to the Fellowship through various channels for new correspondence volunteers — especially males. One of the challenges to this staff assignment is explaining why — when A.A. members continue to volunteer their time — we can never completely close the gap. The short answer is that every day more and more alcoholics in correctional facilities discover that the root of their problem is alcohol and decide to do something about it. Once they come across the message of Alcoholics Anonymous, they want to share their journey with someone, just like the rest of us. In 2013, we linked 1,180 male and 415 female alcoholics in prison to an outside A.A. correspondent through the C.C.S. In order to meet those requests, we needed to be able to match the inmates with 1,595 outside A.A. volunteers. Although many of those offered to write to more than one incarcerated alcoholic at a time, the number of male volunteers needed remains large.

One of the most gratifying aspects of the assignment is communicating with area and district Corrections, Hospitals and Institutions, and Bridging the Gap committees. The desk fields daily calls and emails from A.A. members doing corrections service

work. In 2013, we passed along to area Corrections committee chairs 592 requests from inmates, corrections professionals, and A.A. members taking meetings into correctional facilities for prerelease contacts, outside support, or A.A. literature. We send out a periodic activity report to each of these committee chairs with updated information about new tools or shared experience on how to use those tools. This past year included notice that all Corrections service material could be accessed online to download, print out, and copy; news of updates to the Corrections Workbook; a call for sharing on the need for a remake of the video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell"; a call for Grapevine stories for the annual prison issue and a new Bridging the Gap issue; a call for male participants in our Corrections Correspondence Service; news of Canadian corrections service work; and a reminder that Corrections committees can connect with one another directly to find prerelease contacts for inmates going home to other areas.

G.S.O.'s A.A. website has a special section where most Corrections service material can be found, including current and past issues of the newsletter *Sharing From Behind the Walls* (SFBTW). This quarterly publication contains excerpts of sharing from A.A. members in prison who have written to G.S.O. This desk prepares selections from these A.A. members' letters and sends them a copy of the excerpt along with a request to reprint it in a future issue of SFBTW. The permission letter also mentions the possibility that the newsletter might be posted on G.S.O.'s website. Posting this anonymity-protected newsletter on the website and inviting members who take meetings into correctional facilities to print out copies is another way of ensuring that the sharing from this population of alcoholics gets into the hands of those who need it most.

A.A. members involved in Corrections service frequently ask how they can get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. Often, people in the Fellowship unfamiliar with this type of Twelfth Step activity express the fear that the alcoholic in prison will not identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and are reluctant to commit to the amount of time institutions sometimes require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into their correctional facilities. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in Corrections service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

The A.A. journey can be a lonely one inside a correctional facility, but we get many messages of gratitude from inmates who have found solace and hope in the A.A. literature that gets delivered inside prisons and jails and in the connection made to an outside member through an A.A. meeting at the institution or via our Corrections Correspondence Service.

Clement Cann

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' report:

General Service Office — At last year's Conference, we reviewed the proposed budget for 2013 and reported that G.S.O. expected a loss from operations of approximately \$611,240. However, for the year 2013, G.S.O. turned in positive results from operations of \$31,554, a net improvement of \$642,794. This was due to revenues being greater than budget and expenses being less than budget.

Net sales of publishing activities for 2013 were \$12,604,720, approximately \$64,720 (.5%) more than budgeted. Manufacturing and royalty expense were \$138,000 less than budgeted, and shipping and warehousing expenses were \$123,900 less than budgeted as well. This resulted in a gross profit of \$8,109,342 or

\$326,542 (4.2%) greater than budgeted. Adding to these positive publishing results were the Fellowship's actual self-support contributions of \$6,906,371, which were \$209,000 (3.1%) more than budgeted. Finally, operating expenses were \$107,127 (.7%) less than budgeted.

A.A. Grapevine — The 2013 Grapevine budget anticipated a net profit of \$11,954. Instead, the actual results were significantly better for the Grapevine, a net profit of \$315,205. For the year, Gross profit from other Publishing income was approximately \$80,928 better than budgeted, while interest was \$5,800 less than expected. Expenses for the year were \$135,394 less than budgeted as well.

Reserve Fund — At December 31, 2013, the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 10.9 months of operating expenses, compared to a budgeted 10.8 months of the 2013 operating expenses.

2013 Actual Results vs. 2012 Actual Results

General Service Office — Our revenues essentially come from two sources: contributions from the Fellowship and profits from literature sales.

Contributions of \$6,870,241, received from *groups and members* (excluding funds received from World Service Meeting countries) were approximately \$347,299, or 5% more than the \$6,522,943 received during 2012. The \$6,870,241 in contributions came from 27,481 groups, individuals, and service entities. That, for comparison, represents approximately 42.5% of the 64,694 groups listed with G.S.O., up just .1% from the 42.4% reported last year. As shown on the Contributions Statistics report, included in the Conference material, there are 64,694 groups, some 280 greater than the 64,414 groups reported last year. It is important to remember, however, that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us.

During 2013, 79,363 contributions were received, approximately 1,500 fewer than the 80,936 received in 2012. This compares with 80,683 received during 2011 and 77,185 in 2010. Beginning in June 2010, we implemented the online Contributions function. For the period June through December 2010, we received approximately 1,056 contributions via the online method, representing approximately \$82,500. During 2011, we received approximately 1,748 online contributions, \$156,553, and in 2012, 2,346 contributions, or \$213,400, were received. During 2013, 2,980 were received for a total of \$302,230. Beginning in 2002, we commenced recording funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O. Total contributions of \$6,906,371 received by G.S.O., reflected in our 2013 financial statements, include approximately \$36,130 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. The comparable comparisons for prior years were: 2012, \$34,665; 2011, \$74,588; 2010, 129,518; 2009, \$133,715; 2008, \$137,600; 2007, \$144,400; 2006, \$145,000; 2005, \$135,000; 2004, \$128,357; 2003, \$102,900; and 2002, \$108,000.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$12,604,720, an increase of \$239,961 over the prior year. During 2013, approximately 973,000 Big Books were sold compared with 947,430 Big Books in 2012 and 945,500 in 2011. Printing and manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were in the aggregate, \$8,500 greater than 2012. The Gross profit of \$8,109,342 was \$231,418 greater than 2012. The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$15,016,217, \$580,219 greater than 2012. Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2013 were

\$14,984,663, approximately \$701,111 greater than 2012, but \$107,127 less than budgeted. For the year 2013, there were no significant variations from 2012 expense lines. The single largest unusual item was in Furniture and Equipment expenses where a decision was made to write off \$125,000 of unamortized costs of the A.A.W.S. ebook project following the A.A.W.S. Board decision to stop offering the A.A.W.S. proprietary ebook product and switch back to Third Party Vendors.

Expanding on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services to the Fellowship — in 2013, \$9,507,582 was spent to provide Services to the Fellowship, approximately \$253,451 more than the \$9,254,131 spent in 2012. This compares with \$8,747,139 in 2011; \$8,642,112 in 2010; \$8,783,762 in 2009; \$9,447,300 in 2008.

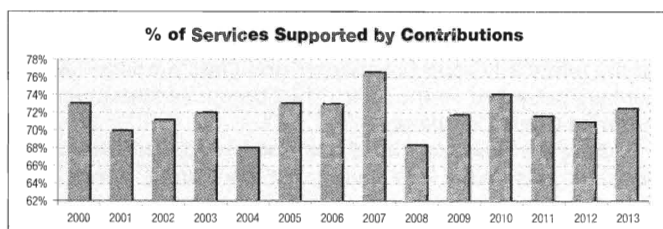
The 2013 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 32.5% (which includes various group contact-type costs in addition to Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 14.2%; Loners, International Assignment and Overseas Services, 7.5%; trustees' and directors' activities, 6.3%; Regional Forums, 7.2%; Archives, 10.1%; C.P.C., 5.2%; Public Information, 4.4%; Correctional Facilities, 4.7%; Treatment Facilities, 2.0%; Special Needs, 1.8%; Nominating, 3.7%; and other various 0.4%.

Contributions provided 72.6% of the support for these services and 27.4% came from the profit from literature sales. This compares with 70.9% and 29.1% in 2012; 71.6% and 28.4% in 2011; 74.2% and 25.8% in 2010; 71.7% and 28.3% in 2009; and 68.1% and 31.9% in 2008.

2014 G.S.O. Budget — Sales for 2014 are budgeted approximately 19% higher when compared with 2013. Ongoing unit sales are expected to be approximately even with 2013, however, the 2014 budget anticipates sales of the 75th Anniversary Edition of the first edition of the Big Book and a general price adjustment that is scheduled for late in the year (October 2014). With Contribution revenue up by \$348,000 in 2013, we have budgeted approximately 1.5% increase in 2014 based on ongoing self-support communication efforts. Dividing **total** Contributions received (\$6,906,371) by the 64,694 groups listed gives us an average of about \$106.75 up from last year's \$102, while expenses to support services to those groups amounted to approximately \$146 (up \$2 from last year).

Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services provided. We are trying to make more use of electronic communications wherever possible to reduce costs of postage and supplies. One should remember that as we continue to strive to have literature available throughout our Service Conference, in Spanish and French as well as English, lower print runs in non-English languages usually result in higher production costs. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost; therefore lower overall gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages and make price increases necessary from time to time.

Recent pricing history — In 2005, after reviewing financial matters, trusted servants recommended an increase in prices of books and booklets (except the Big Book), as well as an imposition of a small shipping charge effective July 1, 2005. This followed, by one year, the restoration of the price of the Big Book on July 1, 2004. Previously the price of the Fourth Edition was set at \$5.00 (a \$1.00 per book reduction from \$6.00), reducing the expected Gross Profit with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. Projections at that time anticipated that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years. Prices of books and booklets were increased effective July 1, 2009, anywhere from \$.25 to \$2.00. While



reviewing and recommending the 2014 budget, the A.A.W.S. Board continues to consider that revenue and expense assumptions ultimately affect the long-term fiscal health of the General Service Board and its Reserve Fund. Accordingly, the budget assumes a price adjustment October 1, 2014.

The 2014 budget anticipates approximately a 6% increase in costs when compared with 2013 actual results, with "People Costs" being the principle driver due to inflation and new staff. For 2014, we have hired two full-time staff members; an assistant on the International Convention assignment and a publications licensing manager. We have been able to reduce the cost to the corporations by several hundred thousand dollars a year as the General Service Board approved a transfer of \$1,500,000 from the Reserve Fund to the Pension Trust.

Based on these preliminary assumptions — approximately a 16% increase in sales, a 1.5% increase in contributions, and an increase in total operating expenses—the projection for 2014 is for a profit from operations of \$299,444. During the budget process, the A.A.W.S. Board, as well as the trustees' Finance Committee, remains cognizant of the level of the Reserve Fund. Management continues to assess expenses and operations with an eye towards reducing costs.

The Reserve Fund (and Historical Reference for price adjustments) — In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was at that time approaching the upper limit of 12 months of combined operating expenses established by the General Service Conference. In subsequent years, it became necessary to restore the revenue stream with pricing adjustments. As noted in previous reports, G.S.O. management was charged with presenting a 2009 budget with sufficient revenue that, with all things being equal, would maintain the Reserve Fund at a nine-month level of operating expenses after three years. The adjusted balance used for the calculation at December 31, 2013 of \$15,301,653 amounts to about \$237 per listed A.A. group.

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, gross magazine income for 2013 of \$2,242,363 was approximately \$100,547 less than the prior year. Total magazine income includes the print magazine, single copies, back issues, Digital Magazine Subscriptions, GV Online, Digital Archives Project Subscriptions, and the Audio Grapevine. The average paid circulation for print magazines of 77,126 for 2013 compares with 83,263 for 2012; 90,493 for 2011; 93,104 for 2010; 102,281 for 2009; and 104,993 for 2008. Subscriptions for the Online magazine averaged 5,175 during 2013, compared with 5,535 during 2012 and the 2013 budget of 4,653.

Gross profit on the magazine of \$1,477,689 was \$47,558 less than 2012, but \$92,729 greater than budgeted. Other publishing income of \$776,976 was \$92,159 greater than 2012 actual and \$80,928 greater than budgeted. Total income, including interest earned, was \$2,004,016, \$40,300 greater than 2012, and \$167,857 greater than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,688,811. Costs and expenses were \$17,901 less than 2012, and \$135,394 less than budget. The Grapevine reported a profit from operations of \$315,205, which was approximately \$58,202 greater than the 2012 result of

\$257,003, and \$303,251 greater than the budgeted profit of \$11,954.

The Grapevine's 2014 budget, anticipates magazine income of \$2,132,851 (approximately \$109,512 less than the \$2,242,363 realized in 2013), a decrease in magazine direct costs of \$13,941, and a gross profit of \$1,382,118 is anticipated. Gross profit from magazine is anticipated to be approximately \$95,571 less than 2013. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase approximately \$5,174 to \$521,001, while interest income is estimated slightly higher than 2013. A profit for 2014 of \$94,232 is anticipated, compared with the \$315,205 profit for 2013.

La Viña — La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2013 average circulation of 10,145. This compares with a 2012 average of 9,157; 2011 average of 8,982; 2010 average of 8,741; 2009 average of 9,663; and 2008 of 10,404.

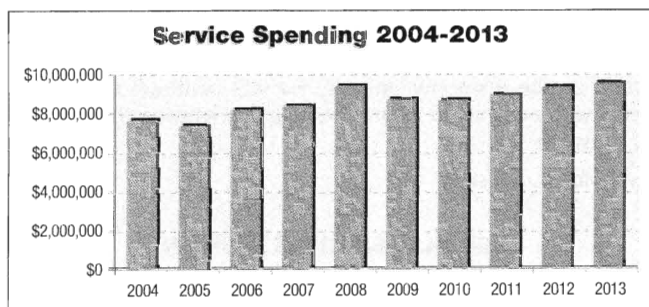
During 2013, subscription income was \$116,549 and direct costs of publishing were \$61,791, resulting in a \$54,758 gross profit. During 2013, La Viña realized approximately \$8,776 from the sales of other items, net of costs. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$206,078. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall net shortfall between revenues on the magazine and all costs to produce and distribute LaViña was \$142,544. This shortfall was covered by the General Service Board. The 2013 shortfall of \$142,544 compares to \$115,820 for 2012; \$69,725 for 2011; \$75,481 for 2010; \$54,472 for 2009; and \$76,260 for 2008.

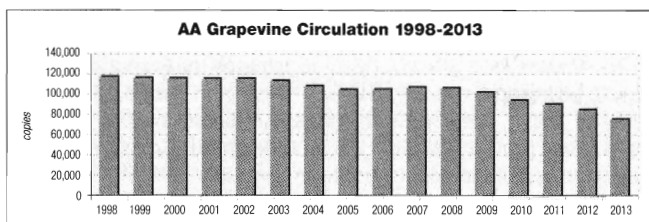
For 2014, the net cost to the General Service Board for the La Viña magazine is budgeted to be approximately \$141,575, (\$969 less than 2013), with circulation anticipated to be slightly higher. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee continue to monitor progress and report results to the Conference. Since the inception of the magazine, nearly \$1.7 million has been invested in La Viña in excess of revenues generated. In 2001, the General Service Board recommended that La Viña continue to be published and agreed to provide the necessary funding.

Other Items

Pension funding — As noted in prior reports, the A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, continue to receive information and recommendations from the Retirement Plan's actuaries concerning funding requirements as a result of 2006 pension legislation enacted by the U.S. Congress. This legislation called for accelerated funding of pensions, which is a departure from the previously accepted method of long-term funding of pensions over the employee's working life.

At the February 2014 General Service Board meeting, the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee recommended and the General Service Board approved a transfer of \$1,500,000 from





the Reserve Fund to the Pension Trust. This action, coupled with the improved stock market results during 2013 and the change in the discount rate, contributed to significantly reducing the unfunded liability of the Pension Trust.

Pension Plan Changes — A subcommittee of the General Service Board was formed in late 2011, the objective of which was to coordinate the review and selection of pension plan options for transitioning from a Defined Benefit Plan to a Defined Contribution Plan for new A.A.W.S. and G.V. employees. During 2012, amendments were approved to close the old Pension Plan to new employees and create a new Defined Contribution Plan for employees hired after January, 1, 2013. During 2013, new employees began participation in the new Defined Contribution Plan.

LaViña — The Committee received a request concerning the reporting of and overall support of the La Viña magazine and forwarded it to a 2014 subcommittee for review and discussion.

Self-Support Policy — Following up on the 2007 subcommittee on a "Consistent Message," the committee recommended and the General Service Board adopted the following policy:

Self-Support of the World Services of Alcoholics Anonymous

The A.A. spiritual principle of self-support enables us to pursue our primary purpose of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic with a shared sense of responsibility for our lifesaving work and without interference or financial dependence on outsiders. From our Fellowship's earliest days, the expenses of the General Service Office, and the world services provided by it, have exceeded the amount derived from contributions of A.A. groups and members. As a result, providing these needed services has necessarily been supported in part by income from the sale of A.A. literature. It is the policy of the General Service Board that income from literature sales should only be in amounts required to allow continued provision of vitally needed services and maintenance of a Reserve Fund. We hope that the day will come when AA groups and members, through their contributions, will be able to fund fully the services provided by the General Service Office. If that is achieved, revenues from literature sales will only be needed in amounts necessary to cover the actual costs associated with literature production and to maintain a Reserve Fund.

In summary, your trusted servants continue to vigilantly monitor the financial affairs of A.A. Steps have been taken over the past several years to enhance the net revenue streams of our publishing activities, to diligently manage the expense side of our support services and to address our long-term obligations, all with the goal of helping insure that the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition. While the economic outlook for 2014 may be uncertain as the economy unfolds, we will continue to monitor events with our goal to insure the financial wherewithal to carry our message.

David Morris, treasurer

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 63rd General Service Conference, the General Service Board has held three General Sharing Sessions. In

July 2013, the topic was "The Informed Group Conscience." Marty Watters, regional trustee, shared on the topic "Necessary Elements for the Informed Group Conscience" and Class A trustee Michele Grinberg presented on the topic "The Committee System and the Informed Group Conscience."

During the November 2013 board weekend, the Sharing Session topic was "What is Our Vision for the Future?" Lynda Bergeron, A.A. Grapevine director, was asked to share on "What is the Role of the General Service Conference Structure?" Bob Wilcox, trustee-at-large/U.S., presented on "What is the Role of the General Service Board?"

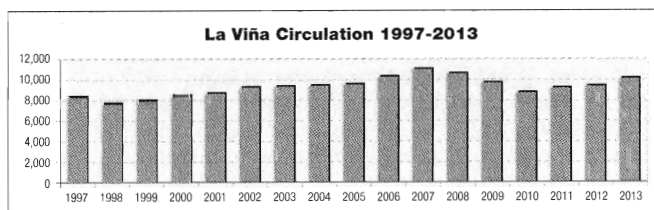
In February 2014 the Sharing Session topic was "Responsibility for A.A.'s Future." Carole Boerner, A.A.W.S. director, shared on "Carrying A.A.'s Message: Are We Growing or Standing Still?" Donald Cusson, regional trustee, shared on "How Do We Keep A.A. Alive and Well?"

Complete copies of these presentations are available and may be requested from the staff coordinator at G.S.O.

Albin Zezula, chairperson

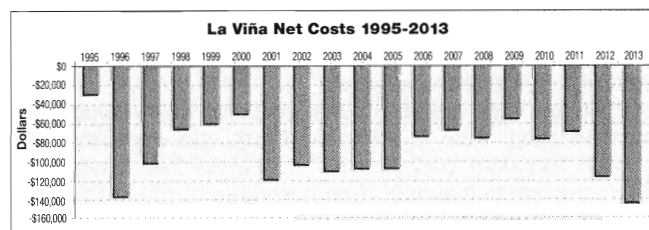
A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Office report: Since the last Conference, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. has produced 12 issues of Grapevine; six issues of La Viña; two new books — *One on One* and *No Matter What*; eight ebooks— *25th Anniversary of Language of the Heart* (updated), *Beginners' Book*, *The Best of Grapevine, Vol.1*, *The Home Group: The Heartbeat of AA*, *In Our Own Words*, *No Matter What*, *One on One* and *Voices of Long-Term Sobriety*; a wall calendar; and a pocket planner.



In 2013, A.A. Grapevine started collecting audio story submissions from the Fellowship. As of January 13, 2014, A.A. Grapevine has collected 87 audio stories. Nine out of the 87 stories have been published on www.aagrapevine.org as of January 13, 2014. They are available free as examples for others who wish to record a story.

The A.A. Grapevine website continues to grow and in 2013 received an average 42,407 unique visitors each month. A.A. Grapevine worked on improving the website in 2013 and continues that work in 2014. In 2013, A.A. Grapevine conducted a user survey and as a result has been implementing improvements throughout the site, including updates to subscriber pages and the email sign-up process. There are more improvements coming in 2014 as a result of the survey findings—such as landing pages, a redesign of the site navigation and home page are currently being considered.



In 2013, for the first time ever, A.A. Grapevine sent emails to interested people, letting them know about new Grapevine books. This has been very successful at generating interest in Grapevine books in general. Sales of books and other items were far ahead of budget as a result of these communications.

Eugene O'Brien, controller

GROUP SERVICES/WEB SERVICES

Staff report: To assist groups, the General Service Office provides service material based on an indicated need, and to share information and experience not found in Conference-approved literature. A seven-page list describes the service items. Examples of service material include: Group Handbooks; G.S.R. and D.C.M. Kits; A.A. Guidelines and Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A.

G.S.O. offers an A.A. website to serve the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous as a resource for A.A. members, those seeking help from A.A., professionals working with alcoholics, the media, and the public at large. G.S.O.'s website provides accurate and consistent information about A.A., as well as information about services coordinated by G.S.O. and encourages participation of A.A. members, groups and committees in A.A. services and activities.

Current ongoing projects involving Group Services and Web Services:

- The Group Services coordinator collaborates with the Special Projects manager regarding the three A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S., and Western U.S.), G.S.O.'s group and service committee records, and intergroup/central office records and lists.
- Supervises the updating of G.S.O.'s available service material upon request, and in Spanish and French, whenever possible.
- Functions as G.S.O.'s liaison to more than 500 intergroup/central offices in the U.S. and Canada. Coordinates A.A.W.S.'s participation at the annual intergroup/central office seminar and serves on the seminar's Policy and Site-Selection Committees. The 29th Intergroup/Central Office Seminar will next take place in Chicago, Illinois, in September 2014.
- Serves as a resource to the managing editor regarding the updating of *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- The Webservices coordinator collects feedback on design and content from users of G.S.O.'s A.A. website, www.aa.org, and collaborates with the Digital Media manager to continually update and improve it.
- Shares collected experience with local website committees upon request and prepares website reports to the A.A.W.S. Board and the Conference Committee on Public Information.

The staff member on Group Services/Web Services serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, as secretary to the A.A.W.S. Services Committee, as chair of the Intra-Office Website Committee, and as regional correspondent for the Eastern Canada region.

M. Tracey Ober

INTERNATIONAL

Trustees' report: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

■ Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2014¹

	Groups	Members
United States	59,565	1,296,037
Canada	<u>5,129</u>	<u>93,565</u>
Sub-Total	64,694	1,389,602
Correctional facilities ²	1,487	35,799
Internationalists	3	6
Lone Members	<u>0</u>	<u>65</u>
Total	66,184	1,425,472
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	<u>49,174</u>	<u>712,949</u>
Grand Total	115,358	2,138,421

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in approximately 170 countries, including 61 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use the previous year's figures

The committee discussed a letter from a trustee expressing concern regarding the inclusion within General Service Conference Areas of groups outside the geographic borders of the U.S. and Canada. The committee agreed that the inclusion of groups from countries outside the U.S. and Canada seems to be helpful to those groups and that development of a policy regarding this matter is not currently necessary.

World Service Meeting — The 23rd World Service Meeting (WSM) will be held October 12-16, 2014 in Warsaw, Poland with the theme "The Three Legacies: Vital for All Generations." We are anticipating close to 60 delegates representing an estimated 35 countries or linguistic zones. Representing our General Service Board will be first-term delegate Bob Wilcox, trustee-at-large/U.S., and second-term delegate Barbara Kelly, trustee-at-large/Canada. G.S.O. general manager, Phyllis Halliday, will be presiding at the event and staff member Rick Walker will serve as WSM coordinator. Other staff members who will serve as secretaries to WSM committees are Jim Malone, Clay Rittenhouse and Steve Smith.

The 2014 Literature Assistance budget of \$50,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund, representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service board. When necessary, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publishing Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board. The Big Book is currently available in 69 languages, and other literature is available in approximately 92 languages.

Zonal Meetings — The United States and Canada were represented at four zonal service meetings in 2013, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not convene. In

June 2013, Mary Clare Lynch attended, as observer, the 6th Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting (SSASM), which was held in Johannesburg, South Africa. In July, Mary Clare Lynch and Greg Tobin attended, as observers, the 10th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting (AOSM) in Irkutsk, Russia. In October, Phyllis Halliday and Rick Walker attended, as observers, the 17th European Service Meeting (ESM) in Frankfurt, Germany. Also, in October, Bob Wilcox, trustee-at-large/U.S., attended, as a delegate, the 18th Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in Salinas, Ecuador.

Perhaps as a reflection on these economic times, the General Service Board and General Service Office received fewer invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits, and regional assemblies. In addition to the zonal events listed above, in 2013 trustees and staff members visited Mexico, Ukraine and Poland. We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards and offices in other countries which carry the A.A. message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Barb Kelly, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 61 international general service offices and/or literature distribution centers.

The International desk is also responsible for communication with structures, groups and members outside the United States/Canada. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the assignment is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and outside professional services. Where there is a nearby office, we provide that contact information. We emphasize our trust in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The International staff member benefits from the experience of G.S.O. staff, cooperation with the Publishing Department, and the support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publishing Department on requests for new translations of literature, and the beginnings of new general service or information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Each year, A.A. World Services receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. The Big Book has now been translated into 69 languages, and additional translations are in progress. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publishing Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available.
- Handling communications related to overseas travel, and attendance at Zonal Service Meetings. Our trustees-at-large (U.S. and Canada) are our delegates to the Meeting of the Americas (RE-

DELA). Other Zonal Meetings include the Asia-Oceania, European, and Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meetings.

- Working closely with our Records Department to insure that our International A.A. Directory (for countries outside of the United States and Canada), which is published annually, contains updated contact information for G.S.O.s, central offices and intergroups, groups, foreign contacts and Loners around the world.

Rick Walker

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' reports:

International Conventions — Since the 2013 General Service Conference our committee has met three times. The purpose of the trustees' committee as it relates to International Conventions is to work on plans for each forthcoming International Convention. The objectives of the 2015 International Convention, with its theme "80 Years — Happy, Joyous and Free" are:

- To provide opportunities for a rededication of attendees to the primary purpose of A.A.
- To enable attendees to witness the success and growth of the A.A. program around the world.
- To let the world know that A.A. is alive, flourishing and available as a community resource, locally and internationally.

The committee acts and makes recommendations in order to fulfill the broad purposes of the General Service Board, as these purposes relate to the strengthening of the Fellowship and the advancement of its message through well-planned International Conventions. The detailed work inherent in putting on the Convention is executed by the Conference coordinator and a professional Convention Consultant.

At last year's Conference, the Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums recommended that three cities be considered as possible sites for the International Convention in 2025. Based on the recommendation of a Site Inspection Team, which visited the three cities, the committee recommended to the General Service Board that Vancouver, British Columbia, be the site of the 2025 Alcoholics Anonymous International Convention. The committee reviewed the General Service Board policy on discounts and subsidies that has been in effect since it was adopted in 1989, and noted that as the staff at the General Service Office moves forward with contracting for facilities and services for the 2015 International Convention, this is the policy that they will follow. The policy reads: "Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, for example, convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined."

The committee reviewed a request for the Conference to form a committee to begin planning A.A.'s 100th anniversary for 2035 and took no action. The committee suggested that the General Service Board include discussion on A.A.'s 100th anniversary in long-term strategic planning. The committee also discussed its concern regarding the anonymity breaks in a documentary produced by an independent filmmaker during the 2010 International Convention in San Antonio. The committee agreed to request that the trustees' Committee on Public Information begin discussing ways to ensure that A.A.'s Traditions on anonymity are adhered to as much as possible at the level of public media during the 2015 International Convention.

The committee also reviewed and accepted the following: 2015 International Convention stationery that will be used by the General Service Office beginning in March 2014; tentative program titles for the 2015 International Convention. A general description of the 2015 International Convention Souvenir book from Publishing was provided to the committee and will be similar to the format of the 1995 and 2005 Conventions.

At the committee's recommendation, the General Service Board approved Patty Lavelly, past delegate, Area 16 Georgia, as the local Volunteer Host Committee Chair for the 2015 International Convention and the committee welcomed her at their fall meeting. The committee also reviewed the 2015 International Convention budget and held discussion about setting the registration fee for the 2015 International Convention, which took into consideration a realistic budget, the committee's responsibilities relevant to International Conventions, and the spirit of self-support. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the 2015 International Convention preregistration fee be \$100.00 (USD) per attendee and that the on-site registration be \$110.00 (USD) per attendee.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2014 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums discussion of an anonymity-protected photo of the flag ceremony to be taken at the 2015 International Convention, and discussion of an encrypted, anonymity-protected, delayed Internet broadcast for the 2015 International Convention similar to the 2010 Flag Ceremony broadcast.

Regional Forums — Since the 2013 General Service Conference, Regional Forums have been held in the Northeast, West Central, Southwest, East Central and Western Canada regions. One "Additional" Regional Forum was held in the Southeast region. All were well attended by enthusiastic A.A. members interested in learning more about the General Service Board, General Service Office and A.A. Grapevine. Many in attendance were experiencing their first Forum. Each Forum was viewed as an opportunity to exchange information among local trusted servants, A.A.s interested in service, trustees, directors and staff of G.S.O. and Grapevine. Equally important was the opportunity to hear sharing of experience, strength and hope, as well as challenges and successes of A.A. members on the front lines of service. Following each Regional Forum the trustees' committee reviewed a summary of the Forum evaluation questionnaires. In July 2013, the committee reviewed the summary of the evaluation questionnaire from the 2013 Northeast Regional Forum, and reviewed and approved the schedule for the 2013-2016 Forums and the board members attending each one. In November the committee reviewed and accepted the preliminary 2014 Regional Forums budget and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. They also reviewed summaries of the evaluation questionnaires for the 2013 Southeast "Additional" Regional Forum and 2013 West Central Regional Forum.

A proposed new section on Regional Forums to be added to Chapter Nine: The General Service Board in *The A.A. Service Manual* was forwarded to the 2014 Conference Committee on Report & Charter.

2014		
July 11-13	Pacific	Boise, Idaho
August 15-17	Eastern Canada	Laval, Quebec
September 26-28	Southeast	Isla Verde, Puerto Rico
<i>J. Gary Lutz, chairperson.</i>		

Staff reports:

The International Convention assignment entails coordinating every aspect of the many processes and plans involved in producing the A.A. International Convention, held every five years. Working with four committees — Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning, and Host — the International Convention coordinator is responsible for making sure that the Convention comes together as a wonderful opportunity for A.A. members to celebrate gratitude and sobriety. In addition, Julio Espallat (the alternate International Convention coordinator) and I coordinated the A.A. meetings held during Al-Anon's International Convention over the July 4, 2013 weekend in Vancouver, British Columbia.

Plans proceed apace for the 2015 International Convention, July 2 – 5, 2015, in Atlanta. The Convention theme, chosen from suggestions sent in by the Fellowship, is "80 Years — Happy, Joyous and Free." Throughout the Convention week, more than 4,000 local A.A.s, coordinated by the Atlanta Volunteer Host Committee, will welcome visitors from around the world. The 2015 International Convention will kickoff with a "Party in the Park" with dances and celebrations flowing from Centennial Olympic Park to the Convention Center (Georgia World Congress Center) and back out to the Park. During the day on Friday and Saturday the Convention Center will be packed with Workshops, Panels, Regional Meetings, Topic Meetings and Marathons. Approximately 750 speakers will participate in over 200 meetings. Friday night, Saturday night and Sunday morning all attendees will come together for the Big Meetings in the Georgia Dome stadium, conveniently located next to the Convention Center. The traditional flag ceremony of nations in attendance will take place at the Friday night meeting in the stadium, and on Saturday night, oldtimers, chosen from the hat, will share about their years of experience, strength and hope in Alcoholics Anonymous.

Information about the Convention is available on G.S.O.'s A.A. website, and will be updated as we move ahead. Registration and housing information will be mailed to groups and trusted servants around the world in August. Registration will open in September, both online and on paper. Excitement is building as this 80th Anniversary celebratory event draws nearer. Georgia on my mind!

Eva Sánchez

Regional/Additional Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums and Additional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. groups, members and trusted servants in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staff. Regional Forums are organized by the General Service Board and regularly scheduled at the invitation of a particular region every two years. With the implementation of Additional Regional Forums, there is currently the opportunity for five Regional Forums annually.

The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes flyers to trusted service workers in the region that includes the registration form, and coordinates Forum details: hotel arrangements, program, displays, on-site registration, etc. The coordinator works closely with the host contact who recruits volunteers to assist staff with hospitality, set-up and registration during the Forum weekend. The location for a Regional Forum is decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O., who also suggest presentations and workshops. The coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "early bird" newsletter at each Forum and forwarding a Forum Final Report to all who attend. Ad-

vance planning and on-site work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

In October 2006, the General Service Board implemented Additional and Local Forums on a five-year trial basis. In July of 2012, the General Service Board agreed to discontinue Additional Regional Forums after completion of the eight region cycle in 2016. The Board noted the cost of each Forum and the impact on the attendance and effectiveness of Regional Forums when three consecutive yearly Forums are held in any one region.

The General Service Board also agreed that regions continue to be encouraged to support Local Forums structured to meet cultural, accessibility and population considerations within their own A.A. communities, and that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums continue to annually approve, at its July meeting, travel of up to two members of the General Service Board, nontrustee directors of the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards or the G.S.O. or Grapevine staff at up to three Local Forums. The staff member on the A.A. Regional Forums assignment serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Mary Clare Lynch

LITERATURE

Trustees' report: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Committee on Literature since the 2013 General Service Conference.

Projects resulting from 2013 Advisory Actions and Additional Committee Considerations of the General Service Conference:

Development of literature which focuses on spirituality — At all three of the trustees' Committee on Literature meetings that followed the 2013 General Service Conference, the committee considered and discussed the comments and suggestions made during the 2013 General Service Conference regarding the recommitted draft pamphlet focusing on spirituality.

In July, the committee offered suggestions to the Publishing Department regarding size, content and format. A revised draft was reviewed at the November committee meeting and minor changes were requested of Publishing. In January 2014, the trustees' Committee reviewed and forwarded the revised draft pamphlet to the 2014 Conference Committee on Literature.

"Circles of Love and Service" pamphlet — At the July 2013 meeting, the committee reviewed and forwarded to the Publishing Department suggestions for changes to the draft revised pamphlet "Circles of Love and Service" from the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature. The committee received sample graphics and reviewed new text in November; at their January 2014 meeting, the trustees forwarded a revised draft pamphlet to the 2014 Conference Committee on Literature.

Additional Items reviewed, discussed and forwarded to the 2014 Conference Committee on Literature:

- Suggested changes to the pamphlet "Questions & Answers on Sponsorship."
- Request for a change to the pamphlet "The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated."
- Suggestion to remove text from *Living Sober*.
- Request to use the circle and triangle as an unofficial A.A. service mark on Conference-approved literature.
- Request to create a pamphlet for alcoholics with mental illness.
- Request to add "Nonalcoholics are welcome to attend open meetings as observers" to the end of the Primary Purpose (Blue) card.
- Correction to inaccurate text related to the addition of appendices in the Preface of *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

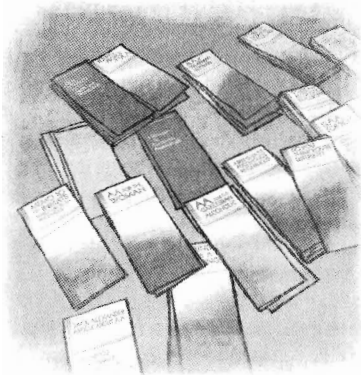
No Action Items: At their quarterly meetings the committee thoroughly discussed and took no action on the following items:

- A suggestion to develop and publish an early history book A.A.'s *Early Adolescence: Rapid Growth and Threats to Unity* (suggested title). They agreed that our current history books are sufficient; that a previous attempt to create a history book was costly in both time and money and posed many problems related to accuracy of historical information. They noted the importance of local archives as a rich resource of A.A. history.
- A proposal to revise the video "Your General Service Office, the Grapevine & The General Service Structure." The committee took into consideration the many years of low sales of this product and the proposed production costs and agreed it was not prudent to remake this video. They agreed that ample information regarding G.S.O, the A.A. Grapevine and the General Service Structure is available in current material and will be more accessible on G.S.O.'s redesigned website.
- A suggestion to add a Table of Contents to the pamphlet "Frequently Asked Questions About A.A." The committee agreed that it is adequate as currently published and due to its short length does not require a Table of Contents.
- A request to add a footnote to "The Doctor's Opinion" in *Alcoholics Anonymous*. The committee noted that there is not a widely expressed need at this time.
- A request to produce an illustrated version of the Big Book for deaf, hard of hearing and less literate members. Again, they noted no widely expressed need in light of the current items we have to serve the deaf, hard of hearing and less literate members.
- A request for a pamphlet of "The Doctor's Opinion" chapter in *Alcoholics Anonymous*. They agreed that the material is sufficient as presented in the Big Book.

Donald Cusson, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Committees on Literature, the Literature coordinator works closely with the editors, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery





pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publishing Department, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all existing recovery books, booklets and pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services Publishing Department.

The Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about A.A. literature. Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, our Customer Service representatives, our Publishing staff and our Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, and intergroup/central office literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 65 area, 320 district and 21 intergroup/central office literature chairpersons listed with G.S.O. The Literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate the responsibilities of this aspect of the assignment.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for *Box 4-5-9*, working closely with the Publishing Department managing editor and the G.S.O. editorial committee to continue to provide the Fellowship with news and notes from G.S.O. These 'news and notes' may include articles containing shared experience from A.A. Conference-approved literature that addresses questions raised in multiple phone calls, emails and letters to staff members. G.S.O. always welcomes committee sharing on service from the Fellowship, which may be included in articles so that *Box 4-5-9* can be an accurate reflection of both Fellowship and G.S.O. activities.

Box 4-5-9 is published in English, French and Spanish with current quarterly distribution of 65,288 copies in English, 2,141 copies in French and 3,467 copies in Spanish. In addition, there are currently 10,451 subscribers to the digital delivery service for *Box 4-5-9* available through G.S.O.'s A.A. website, www.aa.org. Also on the website the interested A.A. member can find a digital copy of every issue of *Box 4-5-9* going back to the original issue from 1956.

As literature is essential in helping to carry our message of recovery, this remains a challenging and rewarding assignment.

Mary Dargan

NOMINATING

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Nominating of the General Service Board was first appointed by the chairman of the board on January 18, 1944. At that time primary responsibilities were to "establish criteria for and to review résumés of trustee candidates and directors and to make recommendations regarding electoral procedures and matters which may affect the composition of the board and election to it." (History and Actions of the Trustees' Committee on Nominating)

Since that time the trustees' Committee on Nominating generally has met three times each year and, with the forming of the General Service Conference in 1951, the committee began to meet annually with the Conference Committee on Trustees. The responsibilities of the committee grew over time to encompass cri-

teria for all vacancies, whether in the ranks of trustees or among key service directors and staff members.

Activities of this committee in the past year:

- **Regional Trustee Elections:** The committee recommended to the General Service Board, as eligible for election in April 2014, all candidates submitted for Eastern Canada and Pacific regional trustees.
- **Board Slates:** The committee reviewed and recommended proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, and A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May 2014, following presentation at the 2014 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any.
- **Nontrustee Directors:** The committee recommended that a non-trustee director be added to the A.A. Grapevine Board and that the outgoing Class A trustee not be replaced.
- **Committee's Composition, Scope and Procedures:** In the past year the committee has worked extensively on revisions to Procedure No. 2 (Procedures for Selecting Appointed Committee Members), Procedure No. 9 (Guidelines for Hiring General Manager G.S.O.), Procedure No. 10 (Guidelines for Hiring Grapevine Executive Editor) and Procedure No. 14 (Procedure for Selection of Chairman of the General Service Board). The committee recommended these revisions to the General Service Board which approved the revisions. The revisions to the above Procedures are detailed in the addendum to this report, which is available upon request.
- **Appointed Committee Members:** The committee recommended the appointment of Caroline Carney of New York, NY for a one-year term to serve as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Committee on Public Information commencing with the August 2014 General Service Board weekend.

The committee recommended the reappointment of Robert Fernando Cordero of Peoria, Arizona and Terrance Flynn of New York, NY for an additional one-year term to serve as appointed committee members on the trustees' Committee on Corrections, the reappointment of Teresa Frohock of Reidsville, North Carolina and Christine Hofer of Redford, Michigan for an additional one-year term to serve as appointed committee members on the trustees' Literature Committee, and the reappointment of Josh Eggleston of Durham, North Carolina for an additional one-year term as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Committee on Public Information.

Roberta Lindeman, chairperson

Staff report: The staff member on this assignment is responsible to the trustees' Committee on Nominating and to the Conference Committee on Trustees, serving as secretary to these committees. Since the last Conference, the staff member prepared background, minutes and reports for three quarterly trustees' committee meetings. The staff member worked with the trustees' committee on vacancy announcements, and also coordinated the transcription and review of résumés for 22 trustee candidates who made their names available to participate in this year's Conference elections procedure.

The staff member also served as liaison with Remote Communities. This includes being the point for shared information about Remote Communities work in A.A., liaison to A.A. members involved in this work, and working with the elected chairs of the pre-Conference Remote Communities Meeting. In addition, the staff member is the correspondent for the Northeast region of the United States.

Clay Rittenhouse

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with the responsibility of helping the membership carry the A.A. message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We do this by recommending and coordinating activities which include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing video and audio public service announcements (P.S.A.s); preparing and posting press releases on aa.org; coordinating health fairs and other community and school exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey; and carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. Projects over the past year have included:

- **Anonymity** — Because this vital principle lies at the heart of all our Traditions, the committee explored a number of topics and related literature:

- **Annual Mailings:** The committee reviewed and accepted the text of the annual Anonymity Letter to the Media, to be sent in early 2014. The committee agreed that including multimedia would improve our communication with the press, and forwarded to the 2014 Conference Committee on Public Information a progress report on the development of a brief anonymity video, as part of the effort to make our annual mailing effective and attractive.

The committee also reviewed and accepted the text of the Memo to Tapers, and asked the staff secretary to follow up with distributing this item in 2014 in the same manner as 2013, including copying all delegates on this mailing.

- **New Service Piece:** The committee asked the staff secretary to bring back a proposal for a service piece highlighting anonymity in current media based on shared experience available in existing A.A. literature. This resulted in the new piece of service material "Anonymity Online," now available from G.S.O.

- **Anonymity Card (F-20):** The committee discussed suggestions to revise the Anonymity Card (F-20) to broaden the purpose of this item for use as an announcement that could be read at A.A. meetings and forwarded to the 2014 Conference Committee on Public Information a draft revision of this item.

- **Anonymity at the 2015 International Convention:** The committee reviewed suggestions for improving communication with Convention attendees and media professionals regarding anonymity and noted the need to help A.A. members and the media better understand the vital importance of anonymity at the public level, including the impact of anonymity breaks on the organization as a whole. The committee forwarded to the 2014 Conference Committee on P.I. a request that they discuss how delegates might stimulate local discussions in light of ongoing anonymity concerns.

- **Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Website** — The committee reviewed quarterly reports from the A.A.W.S. Board regarding changes to aa.org, updates on website activity, a summary of requests from the Fellowship regarding the website, a summary of actions taken by the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests and status reports on the redesign of G.S.O.'s A.A. website. An annual report by the A.A.W.S. Board was forwarded to the 2013 Conference P.I. Committee. The committee noted A.A.W.S. approval of (a) posting full-length videos on G.S.O.'s A.A. website, and (b) the development of

web banners and guidelines for their use for G.S.O.'s A.A. website, for the purposes outlined in the 2014 Comprehensive Media Plan.

The Grapevine/La Viña Website — The committee reviewed reports from the Grapevine Board on the Grapevine/La Viña website activity.

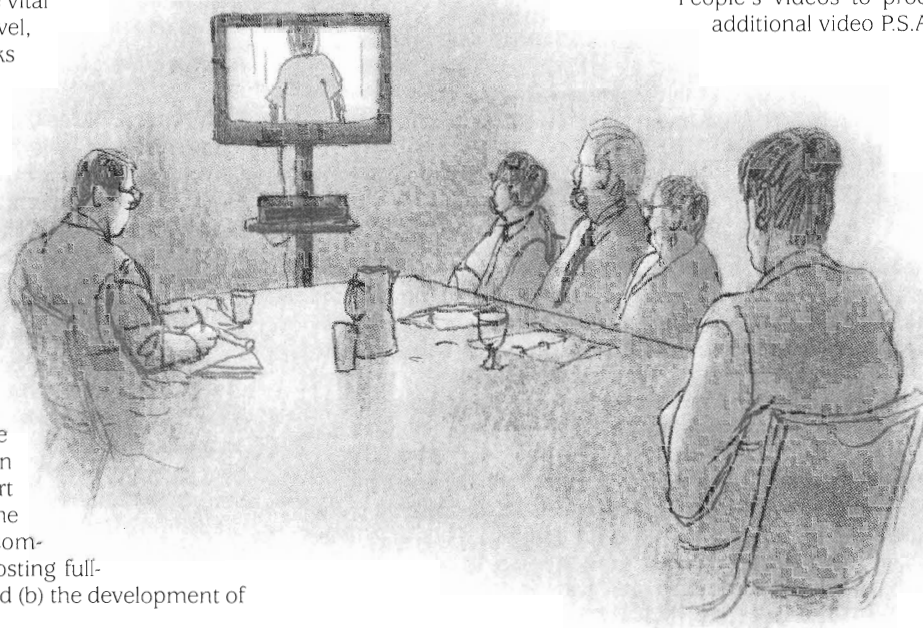
Comprehensive Media Plan — In July, a subcommittee was appointed to explore recommendations for continuing development and implementation of the Comprehensive Media Plan. Annual review and updating of the plan was added to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure.

The committee also received a request to share information about the Comprehensive Media Plan with the corporate boards in the same way the two boards share their website quarterly reports. The committee agreed two-way communication is vital to informed decision-making, and asked the staff secretary to provide the requested information.

The committee agreed with the subcommittee's recommendations regarding suggested items for action in 2014. The staff secretary was asked to follow up on several items with the A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. Boards, and the committee forwarded to the 2014 Conference Committee on Public Information the 2014 Comprehensive Media Plan.

- **Membership Survey** — A subcommittee was formed in 2012 to consider the survey methodology and how the survey information is used as a Public Information tool. The subcommittee asked the staff secretary to gather sharing from the Fellowship regarding the A.A. Membership Survey pamphlet. That subcommittee's report, which culminated in several recommendations, was reviewed at the July 2013 meeting, and served as the starting point for this year's subcommittee, whose final report and recommendations were forwarded to the 2014 Conference Public Information Committee. A summary of the 2012-2013 subcommittee's findings was also included in the report to the 2014 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- **Video P.S.A.s** — At the July meeting a subcommittee was formed to consider the following recurring agenda items for the Conference Committee on Public Information: (a) review current video P.S.A.s for relevance and usefulness, and (b) assess the need for a new video P.S.A. In response to the 2013 Additional Committee Consideration, the subcommittee was also asked to explore the feasibility, target audience, distribution and cost of using the current Young People's videos to produce additional video P.S.A.s.



The committee also asked the staff secretary to research the use of online video posting platforms (e.g. YouTube, Vimeo) for A.A. videos. (Note: The 2008 trustees' P.I. Committee recommended creation of a YouTube account for the purpose of posting television P.S.A.s, with the stipulation that the staff secretary would "discontinue the account if it is found to compromise the Twelve Traditions in any way.") The staff secretary reported back that this platform has evolved to the point that warrants a new look prior to any further action taken. The committee agreed that, based on current efforts regarding the hosting of A.A. videos on the aa.org redesigned website, to table further discussion until after launch of the new site.

The committee reviewed interim and final tracking reports on the video P.S.A. "Tengo Esperanza" and had the staff secretary follow up with local P.I. committee chairs in areas where "Tengo Esperanza" had received significant air time to gather sharing about local efforts that might be passed along to other areas.

The committee forwarded to the 2014 Conference Committee on Public Information the report from the subcommittee on Video P.S.A.s., which included recommendations for retiring several video P.S.A.s and a proposal for a new video P.S.A.

P.I. Kit — Based on suggestions from the 2013 Conference Committee on Public Information, the following changes were forwarded to the Publishing Department regarding the P.I. Kit:

- The address of G.S.O.'s A.A. website, www.aa.org, was added to the front of the new kit packaging.
- The pamphlet "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous" was added to the kit.

The committee remains committed to do all it can to assist the membership in its service of carrying the message of recovery through public resources to the general public and to the alcoholic who still suffers, and welcomes suggestions from the Fellowship as to what more can be done.

Andrew Ware, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment is charged with assisting the A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public — schools, health fairs, community events, libraries, and all forms of the media. Below are some of the ways that this task is carried out:

- Communicate with 850 P.I. committee chairpersons at the area, district and intergroup/central office or group level to provide them with Workbooks, Guidelines, and current shared information on Public Information activity.
- Provide literature to supplement the efforts of local Public Information committees which are serving as a resource about Alcoholics Anonymous at local health and community fairs.
- Provide P.I. committees with information regarding the production and distribution of video and audio Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s), in order to enhance their efforts on the local level, and refer all media requests for P.S.A.s to local committees.
- Respond to all inquiries that come to the office from the media, providing them with accurate information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- Read and process a number of newspaper, magazine and Internet feature stories that mention Alcoholics Anonymous, and receive information from members regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio, films, television and the Internet.
- Pass along instances of anonymity breaks in the media to the delegate in the area in which the break occurred, and provide them with an opportunity to contact the member and share experience regarding our Eleventh Tradition.

- Send out the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media. In April 2013 it was emailed to over 28,000 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services.

- Coordinate the triennial A.A. Membership Survey. The results of triennial surveys are published in pamphlet form and as a table display for visual information about Alcoholics Anonymous at public events.

- Participate as a member of the Interoffice Website Committee (I.O.W.C.), which reviews suggested changes to the aa.org website, a key aspect of our Public Information efforts.

The goal of Public Information work at G.S.O. is to see that the A.A. message of recovery reaches the still-suffering alcoholic by informing the general public about the A.A. program.

Jim Malone

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Eleven A.A. members comprise the "G.S.O. Staff" with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. The staff coordinator shares responsibility for corresponding with members from the Southwest region, covering the busy six months of the year for the Conference coordinator.

In 2013, the staff received 74,261 pieces of correspondence by mail, email and fax, a 7% increase over correspondence received in 2012. The staff also answers many phone calls daily. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects or away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. Mail, email, faxes, etc., are responded to within ten business days.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experience of A.A. groups gathered over many years. These resources are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Requests for guidance received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, so that all responses reflect either research from A.A. literature or service material or the collective experience of G.S.O. staff and archives. Our weekly staff meetings provide a forum for sharing ideas on how to improve services to A.A. groups and members or how to provide the most complete answers to Fellowship inquiries.

G.S.O. staff members serve as secretaries to trustees' and Conference Committees and also are voting members of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

In 2013, G.S.O. welcomed a total of 1,942 individuals, including many English- and Spanish-speaking groups ranging in size from 10 to 50. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" and view a display of Grapevine materials during a tour of G.S.O. Often visiting members and guests attend the open A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays. This is an opportunity for the G.S.O. staff to welcome A.A. members from all over the world or from around the corner.

The staff coordinator has the privilege of serving as a director on A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the dedication and skill of a very capable support staff.

Julio Espallat

■ Area Service Highlights — Panel 64 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

Alaska: Area 2 has a pre-Conference and summer assembly each year, and an election assembly at the end of each panel. In many even-numbered years there is a state convention, which is self-supporting. Monthly area teleconferences are informational only; we make no significant decisions outside of assemblies. We have nine engaged districts comprised of 180 active groups. Another huge district stretches across the north slope. A large part of western Alaska is notably absent in meeting lists and area participation. It was decided several panels back to *not* form an area Remote Communities Committee because all of our committees incorporate a remote component. Parts of the area are active in outreach efforts, one district has sponsored a weekly statewide call-in meeting for the past three years, and some travel to remote Alaskan and Russian villages has occurred. Our state capital of 33,000 people, not accessible by road, may be a remote community. General service seems to be a mystery to many in the Alaska Fellowship, and we get excited when we have more than 40 voting members at an assembly. Our biggest challenge may always be high transportation costs. One topic that returns from time to time has been to restrict assemblies to the road system due to fiscal concerns. This suggestion has failed to date, the prevailing attitude being that the cost of unity makes general service Twelfth Step calls around the state valuable to everyone in Area 2, Alaska. — *Bruce Dinneford*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Area 78 is comprised of Alberta, the Northwest Territories, most of Nunavut Territory, the East Kootneys, the Peace River region, and one group in the province of Saskatchewan. We have 551 groups in 48 districts, with 317 G.S.R.s and 38 D.C.M.s. We hold two area assemblies and two committee meetings each year. We have a complete record of all carried motions from 1967 to 2013 called the *Actions of the Area 78 Assembly*. We started a new G.S.R. introductory meeting prior to the start of our assembly and adopted an Orientation Handout; we are sending our current archivist to the National A.A. Archive Workshop in Philadelphia this year; and we established a standard logo for Area 78. We have created two new subcommittees: the General Policies Subcommittee and the E-Services Subcommittee. The new "Spirit of the North" teleconference meeting on Tuesdays at 7:00 pm (1-559-670-1000, code 449092) continues to connect (geographically, culturally, linguistically) our remote alcoholics who normally would not mix with rural alcoholics by communicating our Legacies. We welcome all areas to participate in this Twelfth Step meeting. In March 2014, our districts and groups made bids to host the 2015 Western Regional A.A. Service Assembly (WRAASA). We look forward to welcoming the western provinces to the warm hospitality of Area 78 and to develop greater unity, to encourage the exchange of ideas and experiences, and to provide an opportunity for members to discuss pertinent aspects of A.A. — *Michelle Dobek-Koinberg*

Arizona: Area 03 has a population of 6.4 million; we are fairly diverse with a large Hispanic population, Native Americans and many people who have moved here from other states or countries. There are over 2,200 A.A. meetings, with 800 of them being registered groups and about 170 G.S.R.s in attendance at our assemblies. There are 54 local districts within our 15 county districts and one overlying Hispanic linguistic district. My vision for this rotation is having more groups participate in general service. Our structure assigns groups randomly to panels that meet at assemblies to consider topics assigned by an

Agenda committee, and then the panels make recommendations to our assembly body. It works much like the delegates being assigned to Committees at the Conference. Our area structure has a service arm made up of 12 coordinators and their committees. Rounding out our structure is our administrative committee, which is made up of seven elected officers and five at-large members. Our four assemblies are bid on by local districts, which ensure that the assemblies are held throughout our area. Our alternate chairperson conducts workshops all around the state, which also increases participation and interest. It has been very exciting for Area 3 as we have been participating in the Navajo translation of the Big Book. Chapter 5 has been completed and this translation will hopefully continue to move forward. Also, our Corrections coordinator and the local committees around the state worked together to get volunteers in to prisons that had no meeting. Two of the greatest joys in Area 3 are 1. Watching the G.S.R.s take on their leadership roles and continue to serve A.A. in our structure and 2. Having enthusiastic coordinators carrying the message of hope through local committees to those who are still suffering. This next two years hold great promise of continued growth through all the many dedicated recovering alcoholics sharing the message of hope. — *Kathi Fowler*

California (Mid-Southern): Area 9 does not have a comparatively large geographical area; however we represent a large and exceedingly diverse population of approximately 2,000 A.A. groups totaling approximately 60,000 A.A. members. We have a total of 24 districts, most of which are further divided into sub-districts. Of our 24 districts, six are Spanish-speaking. We have a total of 12 area meetings per year, including three general assemblies, six Area Service Committee Meetings, a Pre-Conference Workshop, a Servathon, and a jointly hosted event by the Spanish- and English-speaking districts called the FORO. We have nine English-speaking central offices, eight Spanish-speaking central offices and one satellite office. We have an extremely active and enthusiastic Young People in A.A. presence, as well as an active H&I presence, which brings panels of A.A.s to institutionalized persons suffering from alcoholism. Our central offices, H&I committees, and YPAA committees all have a vote at our area assemblies and area service committee meetings. We have a total of 15 standing committees, eight of which have Spanish co-chairs. At each of our 12 area meetings we employ paid Spanish interpreters. Spanish-speaking members wear headphones for which they tune in to a radio signal broadcasted by our interpreter. The FORO event is the opposite. This meeting is run in Spanish while English-speaking members wear headphones for translation. We have an amazing, diverse, enthusiastic, and passionate group of A.A. members serving our area. May God continue to present Himself in our group conscience today and far into the future. — *Cesar Flores*

California (Northern Interior): Area 7 spans from the Shasta Cascade region to the Sierra foothills and mountains, covering 28 districts, including four Spanish-speaking districts. We have 1,048 groups and over 23,000 members. We have four multi-day assemblies each year, and area committee meetings in the intervening months. Our loving discussions include topics on our Three Legacies, Young People, Seventh Tradition, Anonymity, and Sponsorship. We have an Area Service Material Book including a G.S.R. School manual. We hold many workshops for P.I./C.P.C., B.T.G. and other committees, including pre-

Conference workshops to provide for a better understanding of the agenda items. At our annual pre-Conference assembly, we encourage every G.S.R. to come to the microphone and share their group conscience on agenda items with the delegate. This spiritual experience is the foundation of our area's Conference process. We have an active Archives and held the first Pacific Region Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly—PRAASA—in 1968 and are thrilled to be hosting the 50th Anniversary in 2017. This year we funded 13 area officers and appointed chairs to PRAASA, thus providing our trusted servants with an amazing opportunity for growth. Please visit our website at cnia.org. — *Kelley Moran*

California (San Diego-Imperial): In Area 8 we occasionally stumble carrying out the legacy passed on by our founders to preserve the future of A.A. At assemblies some are concerned that we pass financial motions “too quickly,” others say “not quickly enough.” Our standing committees find it hard attracting G.S.R.s that are already overwhelmed with their primary duties. District meetings sometimes struggle, seeing a low level of group participation. Sometimes we slip into “principles after personalities.” Some groups are more deeply impacted by the economic downturn, feeling like their smaller dollar contribution just “isn't enough” but stay committed to service anyway. In another small community the untimely death of the D.C.M. leaves a handful of caring members looking at each other across the table and saying “we can't stop now.” Deep in the heart of the area's 12 Indian reservations a member registers a meeting, thinking even a meeting of one or two is a start. Three Spanish-linguistic districts work hard to cover 10,000 square miles. One deaf member acts as liaison to a growing deaf community. Our YPAAs are far beyond their years when it comes to service leadership. Our districts and committees face some challenges, but we also experience joys of service together. Our area's struggles are evidence of our ongoing and developing work in extending the hand of A.A. and we know the responsibility to help preserve A.A.'s future has no finish line. Together we are like a quilt of diversity, and because we do this for the person not yet born, our path is not limited at all — it is limitless. — *Dean Brady*

Delaware: Area 12 is divided into 13 districts consisting of 182 registered groups, including one Hispanic group. Forty-two percent of the groups support G.S.O. and continue to post high figures for per capita contribution; 60% of our groups contribute to the area assembly, which helps to keep our budget in the black, while maintaining a prudent reserve. These groups are represented by three intergroups and eight active districts. Each D.C.M. holds monthly district meetings and attends the six committee and four assembly meetings. G.S.R.s are expected to attend their district and quarterly assembly meetings. All trusted servants are encouraged to attend NERAASA and many of the service positions are financially supported by those they represent. Our annual mini-Conference focuses on providing the delegate with an informed area conscience about the Conference items discussed. The delegate gives a summary of the Conference at the State Convention, in May. This year a Unity Committee has been established to help the delegate to relight dark districts and “find” unknown groups. Our area website (www.delawareaa.org) continues to be a valuable resource for providing meetings schedules throughout the state. Although Delaware is well known for Rehoboth Beach during the summer we are open year around. So, if you are traveling the Eastern Seaboard at any time during the year, be sure to stop in and visit. — *Veronica Ernst*

Georgia: Area 16 has 784 groups and 51 districts and zones, each represented by a D.C.M. Our linguistic district covers the entire area. The state office in Macon maintains the list of

groups, distributes literature and answers all kinds of questions. We also have temperature controlled room to store our archives. Our archives committee catalogs all donated items. The current project is *We Share II*, which is the history of the groups in GA, oldtimers and delegates. *We Share Our GA Experience* was originally published in 1995. *We Share II* will be published early 2015. We have three assemblies a year, all held in Macon. Also we have a pre-Conference and preplanning meeting with our D.C.M.s and committee chairs. Each year we have eight cluster forums which encourage unity by having the area officers and committee chairs to different parts of the state. The purpose of the forums is to “provide a unique opportunity to share valuable experience, ask questions and spark new ideas.” Our area has maintained our state convention to be “Prepaid” by the groups so there is no registration fee for in-state members. The convention moves throughout the state based on a bid process. Area 16 is excited to host the 80th International Convention in Atlanta. Please come join the world in 2015! — *Rebecca Thomason*

Idaho: Area 18 is a largely rural area of about 62,000 square miles that encompasses most of the state of Idaho and a small section of Oregon. Our estimated 5,000 members are spread out over 233 listed groups. There are 12 districts, with some of our Spanish-speaking groups integrated into these districts. Our Spanish-speaking groups are growing and becoming more involved. Area 18 meets five times a year; three are area committee meetings held centrally, and two meetings are assemblies held in conjunction with area conventions, which are in May and October and they move around our area. The districts take turns hosting the conventions, with local committees being responsible for all of the planning. Area 18 is excited to be the host for the upcoming Pacific Regional Forum which will be held in Boise, July 11-13, 2014. Special Needs/Accessibilities has been gaining momentum as a service that has a definite need in Idaho. We might be small when it comes to numbers, but we are big when it comes to love and service. Because of our small membership we have been given a special bond and the gift of unity. I am honored to call the Fellowship in Area 18 my family and am blessed to serve them. — *Garren Taylor*

Illinois (Northern): Area 20 has over 22,000 members in more than 1,100 groups. We have 25 districts, two of which are Spanish. This year two of our Spanish D.C.M.s have rotated into area service positions, perhaps in part because three years ago we translated our service guidelines and G.S.R. Handbook. In 2014 we will see the full integration of our Spring Assembly and Spring Conference into one event. This effort was done as a partial trial for three years, and required an ad-hoc committee to update our conference procedures. We have a total of four assemblies, preceded by four committee meetings. In addition we have an annual Big Book Conference and rotate a state conference between the three areas. Our area practices Primary Purpose Financing, where all service activities are reported in a Primary Purpose Register. This allows us to focus our discussion on service needs, rather than on dollars; and delegates authority for spending to the service committee responsible, rather than the service chairperson. It also means that our service activities are not bound by the calendar year, or by rotation, thus allowing committees to maintain momentum from year to year. Our hope is that we move our focus toward the work that reaches the alcoholic who has yet to find the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Cheryl Vassau*

Indiana (Southern): Area 23 has 23 geographic districts, one linguistic district, and five intergroups serving parts of central and all of southern Indiana; this includes 680 active registered groups and approximately 12,000 members. We hold a pre-

Conference assembly; four regular area assemblies; a service weekend; a budget meeting; and we host the state convention biennially. Our chair and co-chair conduct G.S.R. schools; our delegate and alternate hold D.C.M. schools. We have orientation for standing committee chairs before our first assembly. Fourteen standing committees assist in carrying the A.A. message by holding workshops for groups and districts; working with the professional, treatment, and corrections communities; and participating in expos and health fairs. Our website has public information and a secure section for area business. Last year, inspired by Bill's *Leadership in A.A.* piece, we addressed the need for increased participation in general service by conducting a survey to gauge members' knowledge of service opportunities, identify roadblocks they face, and encourage them to consider serving; asking trusted servants to tell their service stories and hold Q&As at area assemblies. The result was a record number of candidates at elections, more groups with G.S.R.s, and D.C.M.s in once dark districts. Bill was right. "We have an abundance of men and women whose dedication, stability, vision, and special skills make them capable of dealing with every possible service assignment. We have only to seek these folks out and trust them to serve us." — *Cathi Clark*

Kansas: Area 25 has 28 districts, including three linguistic districts. There are 384 groups and 27 of these groups are Spanish-speaking. We hold our committee meetings in April and October. These are one-day meetings where the agenda is set for the upcoming assembly meeting. The April meeting helps prepare the delegate for the Conference. A mock Conference is held where the upcoming Conference agenda is discussed. In January and July we have our two-day area assemblies. In July of the odd years we hold our elections for service positions. Our committee chairs do an excellent job of delivering the information received from G.S.O. to the D.C.M.s, G.S.R.s, and district committee chairs at these assemblies. Our special needs committee recently upgraded our translation equipment, which has enhanced our ability to communicate with the Spanish-speaking community. You would be hard-pressed to find a weekend without an A.A. event in Kansas. We have group anniversaries; conferences in the northwest, southwest, and southeast; round robins; and roundups in Wichita and the Kansas City area. Our corrections conference is held annually in March. The Kansas State conference is held in September in Wichita. Area 25 is alive and well and it is an honor to serve them as delegate. — *Don Greene*

Kentucky: Area 26 includes the entire state of Kentucky, four counties in southern Indiana, two towns in Illinois, and two towns in south central Ohio. Area 26 is currently comprised of 37 districts (one is a linguistic district), and approximately 726 active groups. Area 26 is served by ten standing service committees, including a quarterly newsletter *The Kentuckiana News*, area registrar and Area 26 website (www.area26.net). We have five intergroup/central offices, and six rotating committees for our annual State Convention. Many of our committees and G.S.R.s enjoy the benefits of attending the S.E. Regional Forums, which provides us with an opportunity to stay current with activities at G.S.O., gain insights from our trusted servants and give voice to our ideas, questions and concerns about the service structure. Now we are quite excited about the opportunity to co-host the 2015 Southern States Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly (SSAASA) with West Virginia. With the support of a very enthusiastic and committed area, I am very grateful to join you in service to Alcoholics Anonymous. — *George Johnson*

Maine: Area 28, Maine, and parts of New Brunswick, Canada, face many challenges that a comprehensive area inventory has helped us become aware of, in addition to giving us direction for dealing with and to better communicate with our A.A. Legacies.

Our P.I. committee has reached out to schools with an information packet for guidance offices and libraries. We have a powerpoint training presentation through C.P.C., and have workshops to generate enthusiasm and disseminate information. Templates can be found on our website. Our standing committees are actively involved with Corrections, Treatment, and Bridging the Gap. We have an active Central Office and Down East Intergroup providing literature, hotline services, newsletters, and meeting lists. Our newsletter, *The Boomerang*, has become theme based and informative, tackling the Traditions and Concepts as tools in developing interest and understanding of service work. We hold weekend-long assemblies twice a year. At registration, members are given *The A.A. Service Manual*, our Area 28 Service Workbook, and a number of pamphlets, along with agenda, motions and background material. To continue passing on our experience, strength and hope in service, we hold an area swap-out meeting for area officers and standing committee chairs after our election assembly. Our expanding Archives, Literature, and Grapevine committees and blossoming website all help us to share our experiences, strengths, and hopes through our history with those stepping into service. — *Mary Lou Quinn*

Manitoba: Area 80 has 14 districts with about 150 active groups and 4,000 members. Roughly 60% of our members belong to one of the 42 groups located in Winnipeg. Many of the remaining groups are located in remote regions and are not represented by G.S.R.s at the four annual area assemblies. We try to hold at least two of our four assemblies at rural locations. Attendance is usually around 75 members with about 10 of our 14 districts represented. Each year our area holds a Gratitude Day event, a Summer Conference, a Keystone Conference and a Winter Conference. This year we also had the honor of hosting the Western Canada Regional Forum. We have eight standing service committees. Our area has one central office located in downtown Winnipeg. The central office space also serves as a meeting place for the Winnipeg Intergroup Association, several of our service committees, and an A.A. group that holds daily lunch hour meetings. We recently purchased a conference phone for our central office and are in the process of setting up conference call accounts for each of our service chairs in the hope that committee members unable to travel to committee meetings will still be able to participate. As an area, we continue to evolve and explore better ways to carry the A.A. message. — *Clint MacKenzie*

Maryland: Due to the continuing population increase it was recently necessary to redistrict Area 29 from 47 to 34 districts, which required the combining of several districts. Area 29 serves in excess of 1,000 groups by way of a well-structured corporation known as "Maryland General Service, Inc.," which meets each year with five assemblies and four committee meetings. There are 19 separate committees. Each year we host two conventions. There are ten intergroups, which pursue long-standing activities that interface comfortably with Maryland General Service, which supports a mini-Conference designed to help prepare the delegate for the Conference. Area 29 is divided into six panels with each assigned two agenda topics. These panels meet independently with members to discuss their agenda topics. A few weeks prior to the Conference the mini-Conference convenes, and the panels come together with the delegate to report on decisions made on the assigned topics. During this reporting period other members of the area are provided an opportunity to participate and question the decisions of the reporting panel. This process provides the delegate with the group conscience of the area and can go to Conference well prepared. The delegate then provides a Report Back a few weeks after the Conference, which allows the area members to be an integral part of the General Service Conference. — *Ron Miscavich*

Massachusetts (Western): Area 31 has 5,500 members in 312 active groups. At our monthly area committee meeting, representatives serving six district committees, seven standing committees, and four invited committees gather to discuss the business of Alcoholics Anonymous — local, regional, and global. Our website committee, Area31aa.org, is intended to complement rather than compete with the Western Massachusetts Intergroup website. Our Archives committee hosts frequent “Open House” events and continues to add to a growing library of talks by longtime members. The successes of our P.I. committee’s long-running “Adopt-A-Library” initiative and the more recent C.P.C.’s “Sponsor Your Doctor” campaign, as well as the ongoing cooperative work of these two committees to host a weekly radio program, all reflect the dedicated service of individual members. Our Accessibility committee recently purchased headsets for hearing assistance and language translation, and distributes a list of about 40 meetings per week where ASL translation is available. At various service events G.S.R.s participate to enlarge and deepen their service experience. We are fortunate to have a dozen past delegates actively participating in events. I am humbled and inspired by the work of individual members who take to heart our pledge to be responsible, whenever, wherever. — *Anne Frey*

Michigan (Western): Area 34 encompasses the western half of the Lower Peninsula, as well as the eastern counties of the Upper Peninsula. We have 582 registered groups in 15 geographical districts, as well as one Spanish district. We hold monthly assemblies hosted by districts rotating throughout the area. This hosting arrangement allows members the opportunity to attend assemblies near their homes several times each year without significant travel expense. We hold workshops and sharing sessions during the assemblies five times per year, a pre-Conference assembly in March, and an area inventory or elections in October of alternating years. Time is also set aside at assemblies for the area’s 11 standing committees to meet. We also meet quarterly with our neighboring areas in the Lower Peninsula, Area 32 (Central) and Area 33 (Southeast) as members of the Michigan Statewide Service Committee. The three areas rotate the Annual State Convention, as well as hosting an annual Mock Conference, where participants act as a “Delegate for a Day,” providing group input and recommendations on Conference agenda items. Area 34 has the strong support of its groups, which was recently demonstrated when the area treasury was unfortunately depleted of all its funds, and trusted servants promptly informed the groups, who generously responded, replenishing the treasury within three months. I am grateful for the opportunity to serve the whole of A.A. as a delegate. — *Russ Larsen*

Minnesota (Northern): Area 35 has over 500 groups. Our area committee consists of five area officers, 11 committee chairs and 17 D.C.M.s. We have a service workshop at the beginning of the year, and two area assemblies, in April and October. We have four committee meetings and our area officers do two zonal forums a year, which are set in alternating zones for more people to know our area officers and we learn a little more about their needs. We use the theme from the Conference each year for our workshop and the banner is posted throughout the year at our assemblies. Our area committee is encouraged to get out to the groups and share our resources with them. As a delegate I will get widespread opportunity to share my experience at the various districts and attend as many functions as I can. Our districts work together filling needs in treatment and correctional facilities and the P.I. and C.P.C. committees are active throughout the state. Our webmaster has advanced our website, Area35.org, and also aameetinglocator.org, which serves all of Minnesota. We have been collaborating with Area 36 in southern

Minnesota on a yearly workshop, the meeting locator and with our correctional facilities. We have a wonderful archives collection. Finding ways to encourage fellowship in our service work can be an uphill battle. — *Michael (Jake) Jacobson*

Mississippi: A.A. began in Area 37 in 1944, when two members discovered that there were no meetings in our state. So they formed the Central Group of A.A., which is still meeting to this day. In 1949 we held our second State Convention; there were 21 groups in our state. We are now entering our 70th year and we will be holding our 66th Annual State Convention. We now have 209 registered groups and 17 correction groups in 22 districts, that reach over 104 cities, towns, and counties. Our area committee is comprised of D.C.M.s, G.S.R.s, nine elected officers and ten appointed standing committee chairs. Our assemblies are held quarterly with Pre- and Post-Conference Assemblies. Service workshops are held at various locations during the year to inform, encourage, and promote interest and participation in service work at all levels. We are experiencing slow growth among our Spanish-speaking and Native American groups, but our young people are taking an important and vital position. An area inventory last fall showed we are faced with a lot of challenges, and also focused on the future and how to generate more growth and participation from groups that do not attend area assemblies. There are a lot of challenges facing us locally and nationally. I am looking forward to Trudging the Road of Happy Destiny with you all. — *Tony Jordan*

Nebraska: Area 41 consists of 31 districts, one of which is a Spanish-linguistic district, spread over 77,421 square miles. There are 634 registered groups, which hold 1,034 meetings per week. Area 41 holds four area meetings per year, plus a Conference themed area reunion once a year. Up to four area service workshops are held yearly in rotating locations throughout the state. Our area supports a P.I. booth over the 11 days of the Nebraska State Fair and a presence at the Nebraska Academy of Family Physicians Conference through the C.P.C. Committee, with both events being staffed with A.A. volunteers. A.A. meetings are held in all state correctional facilities and are available at all county correctional facilities. Our Area 41 Service Handbook was recently accepted in November. This task was undertaken due to changes in our area structure and procedures brought about by a desire to emulate the General Service Conference. Efforts are underway to add Spanish-language pages to the Area 41 website. Planning continues for Area 41 to host the WCRAASC in 2015, accompanied by prayers to avoid the blizzard conditions which have affected our last two opportunities to host. — *Bill O'Malley*

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: Area 81 consists of 12 districts, one being assisted by an L.C.M., and 171 registered groups. Meetings are primarily conducted in French or English, though some are bilingual. There are several groups within our First Nations communities which are either of Mi'kmaq, or Maliseet origin. We usually meet as an area for a three-day assembly in both spring and fall, and during the winter and summer for a one-day Workshop/Sharing Session. After the fall election we host a Transition Meeting in early December, which provides an environment for incoming and outgoing trusted servants to gather and exchange key information. In our nonelection fall assembly we conduct an area inventory. We have five active committees and form Ad-Hoc committees as needed. Area 81 has four registered prison groups, and Dorchester Intramural Group, the first registered active prison group in Canada, will celebrate 65 years in June. Dorchester also has one registered Inuit group. Recently we formed meetings “behind the walls” at two Federal Correctional Facility Mental Health Units as per the inmates’ request. Area 81 has the distinct pleas-

ure of having incarcerated A.A. members participate in regular outside meetings and roundups, as well as area and district business functions by means of A.A. volunteer citizen escorts. We have even conducted a few district business meetings behind the wall. It is my privilege and honor to serve Area 81 here today. Thank you and God bless. — *Dave Allen*

New Hampshire: Area 43 has approximately 11,000 members attending 747 meetings weekly in 15 districts across our state, whose motto we can restate as “Live Alcohol Free or Die.” We hold eight area committee meetings per year at our centrally located Area Service Office and four area assemblies are hosted by districts on a rotating basis. We have eleven standing committees. There are no Intergroups in Area 43; we handle literature sales and communication through our Area Service Office. The literature sales together with contributions from the Fellowship, allow us to maintain a budget that supports our service work. Our April Area Convention’s location is rotated every two years between our Northern and Southern tiers. The theme of this year’s convention was “Sobriety Rocks!” In our most recent panel, we were proud to have made significant upgrades to our area website. In addition to improving the design, we successfully launched our online store in October 2013, offering literature, meeting lists, bumper stickers and medallions at the click of a mouse. We also now offer online registration to our convention. Our area newsletter, *The Pipeline*, has discontinued printed production and is offered as a digital subscription at no charge. While we still struggle to attract new trusted servants, we were pleased to have had an increase in participation at our last election and have an enthusiastic and talented group of trusted servants now participating in area service. I am honored to have been chosen as a Panel 64 delegate and look forward to meeting all of you as I trudge The Road of Happy Destiny. — *Ken Lawson*

New Jersey (Southern): Area 45 has over 8,900 A.A. members attending meetings in 532 groups, divided into 29 districts. A recently formed ad hoc committee comprised of past delegates is working with D.C.M.s to relight several districts. Our quarterly assembly/committee meetings are hosted by our districts. We host an annual convention and 2014 will be the 50th anniversary of that event. The convention is followed by our yearly mini-Conference which provides our delegate with an overview of the area’s group conscience. We join with our three Intergroups in hosting an annual Day of Sharing and our alternate delegate acts as liaison to the Intergroups. We cooperate with Al-Anon by having an A.A. presence at their annual Convention. We are invited to host meetings and to make literature available there, as well as having an A.A. speaker at their Saturday night meeting. Our Corrections Committee carries the message as well as literature into county and state prison facilities. In an effort to attract more volunteers to this vital work, we hold an annual Intra-Area Corrections Conference. We have an active Bridging the Gap Committee. Our C.P.C. Committee reaches out to doctors, local police departments, educators, lawyers and judges to provide them with information on what A.A. can do to help their clients. Our Grapevine hosts a bi-annual Grape-Fest. We have a website at snjaa.org and our *Fourth Dimension* newsletter is available online. Alcoholics Anonymous is thriving in Area 45, where our current theme is “We are partners in a common effort.” — *Joe McAndrews*

New Mexico: Area 46 has 349 registered groups and 19 districts; 17 are geographic and two are linguistic. Our linguistic districts are Spanish-speaking and include approximately 30 groups. We have a relatively small population spread over a fairly large geographic area, which means a lot of travelling to workshops, events and district meetings. To maximize participation, our

assemblies and conventions move from district to district. There are three assemblies each year, and a annual convention in June. We keep in touch between assemblies through our area website and our monthly newsletter, *El Farolito*, which includes reports from our area trusted servants and districts. New Mexico has the highest percentage of Hispanics and second highest percentage of Native Americans in the U.S., and A.A. in Area 46 continuously strives for inclusion at all levels of fellowship and service. Our Bilingual Committee works to ensure that the hand of A.A. is outstretched to all who seek recovery. Our dedicated translators travel to assemblies, conventions and other events, translating from English to Spanish and Spanish to English. While there is little language barrier to our Native American population, most of whom speak English, we are determined to bridge any cultural barriers that could keep potential members away. We have 13 standing committees, including our newest, the Young People in Service Committee. Our main goals are no doubt shared by every area represented at this Conference: communication, participation and unity. — *Jen Noonan*

New York (Hudson, Mohawk, Berkshire): HMB stands for Hudson, Mohawk, Berkshire, which no longer accurately describes our area. No more Berkshire! We’ve lost some groups from our western border and have gained an entire district to our north, extending our area to the Canadian border, and added a few groups to our south. Area 48 has over 700 groups and approximately 90% of the groups have a G.S.R. or contact person, and there are over 38 Correctional Facility groups listed with G.S.O. We have 18 districts, which are all active, and have regular district meetings. Over the past few years our area has hosted NERD (Northeast Regional Delegates) weekend, NER-AASA, and in 2015 HMB will be the site of NERF. Our area has a large and enthusiastic Young People’s presence. A Young People’s Conference was held in Saratoga in March 2012, hosted by TogaYPAA, and many of the young people hold district positions. Our Archives has undergone a major and dramatic restoration after suffering considerable damage two years ago in a flood after a hurricane. We have a website, with meeting lists available for the whole state, area newsletters, and district newsletters are available on the website, forms, reports, the Area Service Manual, and much more. Our Bridging the Gap chair has been to every district, and most of the districts now have BTG chairs as a result. — *Pat Latimer*

New York (Western): Area 50 has 364 registered groups, over 500 meetings, and approximately 6,000 members in 22 districts. At one time, we were a dark area without any D.C.M.s; today half our districts are represented by D.C.M.s. Our assembly meets seven times a year with two of the meetings being pre- and post-Conference events. The pre-Conference will allow members to voice their input to the delegate, and at the post-Conference the delegate reports back on the Conference. In odd years, a September meeting is held dedicated to elections for the upcoming term. Our assembly meetings are held in Hamburg Town Hall on Sundays at noon. However, in August we meet at an alternate location, due to the Erie (PA) County Fair. Our P.I. Committee hosts a booth at the fair, informing the public of Alcoholics Anonymous. Our assembly has ten chaired committees; our most recent being Finance, formed at the end of 2013. Our assembly in January approved taking our inventory for 2014. Within our area, we have one central office and three intergroups. There are three annual events: the Buffalo Fall Convention; the Cataract City Convention in March, hosted by our Niagara Intergroup in Niagara Falls; and our Area 50 Archive Breakfast in May. In addition, there are districts that hold days of sharing, providing information to members. It is a privilege and honor to represent Western New York at the General Service Conference. — *Frank Malota*

Ohio (Northwest): Area 55 encompasses 15 counties and is mostly rural. There are approximately 4,500 A.A. members in 17 districts, 350 registered groups, and more than 500 meetings per week. Toledo, the largest city, is where our assembly meets on the third Sunday of every month except March. In March 2014, we hosted a mini-Conference so that our delegate can be better informed of our Area 55 conscience on key agenda items. We are also hosting the 58th Ohio State Convention in conjunction with the East Central Regional Conference in July 2014. There are two Intergroup associations, the largest being in Toledo, where our Area 55 Archives is housed and displays some of our rich history since 1940. Our Archives Committee has portable displays that are taken to Area 55 group anniversaries and other events, when invited. They are also actively seeking out and requesting recorded interviews with our Area 55 old-timers. Our Grapevine Committee will also bring their display to any event they are invited to. Our C.P.C./P.I. Committee plans to continue public service announcements as well as contacting area colleges and universities to speak to students. We plan to have a G.S.R. school in May 2014, and we will be examining our districts to determine if there needs to be changes. We also wish to foster the spirit of Unity with our Intergroup Associations and be welcoming and responsive to our membership. I thank my area for this opportunity to be of service. — *Nancy Murphy*

Ohio (Southwest): In Area 56 we begin each year with a Unity Day in January, which is meant to foster fellowship and cooperation between our groups, districts, area committees and two intergroups, which are in Dayton and Cincinnati. In March we have a mini-Conference to help the delegate gain an informed group conscience, while offering attendees a chance to experience what the Conference experience can be. Including Unity Day, Area 56 meets monthly, with the exception of July. The format rotates between voting assemblies to take care of business matters and nonvoting committee meetings to discuss committee matters and maintain continuity between our area committees, groups, districts and intergroups. Representatives from each of our slightly more than 500 groups are encouraged to attend these meetings. Each group is entitled to a vote at the assembly as are the D.C.M.s of our active districts. I would like to report all 30 districts spread across 16 counties as being active. However, after well intentioned efforts to relight several of them individually failed, greater success is being discovered using a multi-district approach. The enthusiasm and dedication of our standing committee chairs and committee members is certain to insure Area 56 will continue to carry the AA message to the still-suffering alcoholic. To learn more and see what is happening in Area 56, visit our website: www.aaarea56.org. I am honored and grateful for the opportunity to both carry the conscience of and represent Southwest Ohio at this 64th General Service Conference. — *Garwood Faunce*

Ontario (Northeast): Area 84 is one of four areas serving the province of Ontario and covers about 162,500 square miles. We are comprised of seven districts with 170 groups and approximately 1,850 members. Meetings are largely conducted in English, French, Ojibwa and Cree. Travel between cities and towns is hampered by long distances, high gas prices and two-lane highways often closed due to harsh winter weather, while remote communities can only be accessed by air and train or ice roads during winter months. After years of discussion about 3:1 Panel distribution at the Ontario Delegates Committee, Area 84 offered to switch from the odd year panel, hence our Panel 63 delegate served only a one-year term. At the fall assembly in 2013, we held elections to vote in our first even-year panel delegate. We mark our area's 47th Annual Convention rotating to Sudbury on the Canadian Thanksgiving weekend. We also celebrate the Heritage Weekend, the Rainbow Roundup and a vari-

ety of gratitude suppers, camp-outs, group anniversaries and workshops. It is an honor and a privilege to serve A.A. and I pray for the guiding hand of my Higher Power and the wisdom of those who came before me. — *Terry Mills*

Ontario (Western): Area 86 has 813 registered groups (548 of them are active), over 23 districts and a membership of approximately 11,000. Our area holds two assemblies per year: one pre-Conference in the spring and a regular in the fall. We also hold seven area committee meetings per panel and they are rotated throughout our districts. Area 86 also participates in the Ontario Delegates Committee (ODC) with the other three areas in Ontario, which meets the first weekend in March. There we discuss upcoming General Service Conference items and it gives our delegates and alternates a feel for the General Service Conference. In Panel 62 our groups directed Area 86 to become more involved in the Bridging the Gap program, and we held workshops at our assemblies. Our subcommittee chairs for Treatment and Corrections worked hand-in-hand, travelling to do presentations and workshops. At the time that we started our area only had thirteen contacts to cover any bridges, now we have over 300 on the list. We have completed over 200 bridges in Panel 62 and we have become the 40th area to elect a Bridging the Gap subcommittee chairperson. An A.A. was heard saying, "Area 86 Rocks," and I am proud to say that we do. — *Jim Wilson*

Oregon: Area 58 has 37 districts, including three Spanish-linguistic districts, and serves over 1,100 groups and 22,000 members. There are four assemblies per year, plus an annual orientation, which is basically a service mentorship day for the incoming area officers, service committee servants and new D.C.M.s. Districts bid to hold these assemblies, thus allowing for area assemblies to move around the state on a regular basis. We have 12 service committees which are served by 22 appointed service committee servants. G.S.R.s are present at every assembly and vote on every matter of business that comes before the body. We find that this level of G.S.R. participation has greatly enhanced our area's unity. We conduct a pre-Conference assembly in February and randomly assign districts to each of the Conference Committees for agenda review, encouraging them to send their written opinions and observations to the area delegate prior to the Conference. We also conduct a biannual area inventory. I am blessed to be part of an area with trusted servants consistently dedicated to helping the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Gus Palmitessa*

Puerto Rico: Area 77 is composed of 106 groups and eight districts. There are about eight English-speaking groups and 98 Spanish-speaking groups. Groups tend to have open and closed meetings and study the principles of our program in addition to their administrative gatherings. The area committee and districts meet monthly. We have a service office with two employees and the area of Puerto Rico holds various events during the year. During our convention, for over 60 years now, we gather the professional community to let them know about our program. Our area seminar provides those members who want an opportunity to deepen their knowledge about the principles based on A.A.'s Three Legacies. Another activity is a family picnic to raise funds for our service office. A monthly publication, *El Despertar*, keeps members informed about what is happening in the program area and provides space for members to express opinions on certain topics of interest. We are carrying the message of A.A. into correctional institutions. We are also taking advantage of the Internet with a website with informative ads on radio and television, and the production of several different radio stations in Puerto Rico. The most important thing is to fulfill our

primary objective and give this chance of recovery to those yet to come. — *José (Chapo) Rivera-Vazquez*

Quebec (Northwest): Area 90, created in August 1976, has 365 groups and about 6,000 members. We have 19 groups in correctional centers and 15 in treatment centers. We have seven area officers, 24 active districts, six standing committees, including our area news bulletin, *The Heritage*, and *La Vigne* (bi-monthly magazine similar to the *Grapevine*). We also have three work groups: Archives, Website and Sharing Sessions on A.A. Services. We have a large area; to attend a district meeting it can be a seven hour road trip, which is about 400 miles. We also have an isolated district in the Land of Permafrost, located north of the 60th Parallel in the Eastern Arctic, which consists of Inuit members. The Inuit language is Inuktitut, but they also speak English. Communication with Inuit peoples is done either by phone or e-mails. After several years of work by the Remote Communities group members, this district has now reached their autonomy. They have their own service structure with a D.C.M. and G.S.R.s. Area officers also share their experiences on the role of a G.S.R., Traditions, Concepts, treasurer and the A.A. group in districts upon request. Because of these Sharing Sessions, members are aware of the importance of Tradition Seven and this is reflected in our contributions to G.S.O. We have six area committee meetings a year and one welcoming assembly for the new trusted servants from groups and districts. We also have two regional assemblies where members can express their thoughts about groups' and members' needs. — *Luc Tremblay*

Quebec (Southwest): Area 87 has 12,700 members and 550 registered groups distributed among 27 districts (19 are French, 7 are English and 1 is Hispanic). We have one meeting in Québec signed language and one in Persian. Sixteen committees work to carry the A.A. message, both in French, English and Spanish. Our C.P.C. Committee presents A.A. to professionals and to university students in medical and nursing programs, and to college students in nursing, social work and police technology programs. P.I. regularly visits colleges, high schools and elementary schools, homeless shelters, retirement homes, and businesses; they are also very active at our annual Area Convention. Our Corrections Committee takes meetings into provincial and federal prisons; they are also present in court houses. Our Treatment Committee supervises A.A. meetings in hospitals, treatment centers and homeless shelters. Our Group Services Committee organizes seminars on A.A. service structure and on Traditions and Concepts where past delegates are asked to contribute. We hold four assemblies and seven area committee meetings every year. The four delegates from Québec are board members of *La Vigne*, our French meeting-in-print, published six times a year and produced entirely by volunteers. It is a privilege to be here with you. — *Raymond Denis*

Rhode Island: Area 61, Rhode Island, also known as the "The Ocean State," has about 5,882 members, 286 registered groups, and 661 meetings. Area 61 is fortunate to have the support of our membership, which permits us to have office space for holding all of the area and committee meetings. We have eight districts, the eighth being a Spanish-linguistic district, which is currently dark. All of our committees meet monthly; the area officers, D.C.M.s and committee chairs meet monthly as well. The area has four assemblies each year, and each district holds one Joy of Service meeting in between the assemblies to discuss the service opportunities within the area's subcommittees. Yearly we have the Rhode Island A.A. Convention and the Ocean State Young Peoples Conference in scenic Newport. Rhode Island hosted the New England Conference of Young People in A.A. (NECYPAA) the weekend after Christmas 2013. In 2014 the

state is also hosting the North East Regional A.A. Service Assembly (NERAASA) for the first time ever, and in 2015 we will host the North East Regional Delegates meeting (NERD). Always remembering A.A. comes first, my life in sobriety and service has allowed me to live life. — *John Hogan*

South Carolina: Area 62 has about 383 groups, 53% of which contribute to support the three area assemblies yearly, along with one area committee meeting in the beginning of the year. In even years G.S.R.s are given an orientation. Their importance in A.A.'s service structure is shared from the experience of past and present delegates and area officers. Our area website, area62.org, is a vital tool. D.C.M.s, area service committees, and area officers are able, through the website, to stay in constant communication and to link to aa.org. Area 62 hosted the 2013 South East Regional Conference, "The Grand Dad of Them All," at which the Area Corrections Workshops were attended by South Carolina State Correction officials and past inmates. These workshops made carrying the message behind the walls more efficient. The Area P.I. Committee held three workshops on two major topics. One, the Eleventh Tradition proposed change to include Internet; and two, Anonymity in Social Media. Area 62 is looking forward to supporting Area 16, Georgia, who will be hosting the 2015 International Convention. Area 62 will continue to practice Recovery, Unity and Service. — *Marshall Carter*

South Dakota: Registered A.A. groups are located in 90 towns across Area 63, in towns as small as 42 people and in our largest city of nearly 154,000. Logging at least 500-750 miles per week to attend meetings is common. One group on the Interstate holds an "extra" meeting, usually attended by one person who opens the doors, just in case tourists or court card holders need a meeting. Twelve towns with A.A. groups are on Indian Reservations; at least half of these groups have a long history of continuous operation despite their rural nature. The area stays connected to groups and districts through four area-wide events. This year for the first time, our fall conference was cancelled, because of a powerful winter storm. The area functions through a committee system with eleven committees and one subcommittee. In 2013, two new committees were created and a new formal system to encourage groups and districts to forward agenda items for area consideration was tested. Group histories are being gathered by the Archive Committee. A.A. literature and public information distribution are activities facilitated by the area and through districts and groups. An area website, two district websites, three district hotlines and one Intergroup help carry the message. We are challenged by issues like participation, singleness of purpose, fears that A.A. is being diluted, and financial support for all levels of A.A. We are strengthened by individuals and groups willing to go to any lengths to maintain unity, promote historic and recent forgiveness, maintain A.A. for the future, and live by the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts. One of our groups is located in the exact geographical center of the nation; two host meetings are held every three hours during the Sturgis Bike Rally and another adds extra meetings during our State Fair. All of our groups will welcome you. — *Anne Fines*

Tennessee: Area 64 has 552 registered groups making up 41 districts. There are four assemblies that meet in different locations throughout the year. There are eight standing committees that have a sharing session and a business meeting prior to reporting to the assembly body during the area business meeting. The delegate meets with D.C.M.s to discuss any problems they may be having and to pass along information from G.S.O., while the alternate delegate holds a sharing session with G.S.R.s. We invite you to stop by the Archives to learn about Tennessee A.A. history and share a cup of coffee with Herb or

Ernie. Come on down and join the Tennessee volunteers in action. Y'all come, ya hear! — *Mary Ann Ehrhardt*

Texas (Northwest): Area 66 has 210 groups carrying the message of recovery through the Big Book. These groups are served by 11 districts; three are Spanish-speaking districts. Our area assemblies and miniforums are generally rotated through the larger cities and hosted by the districts. We usually have around 50-60 members attending our area assemblies. Some of our standing committees stay active while others are currently vacant waiting for a willing member to fill it. Given the wide span of geographical coverage, Area 66 is blessed to be making efficient use of the website technology to tie us together. Each district has access to operate its own website under the nwta66.org umbrella. The A.A. meeting section of this website is kept current with all meetings in the area, and includes a map to meeting locations. Our website also has protected file storage areas for the committees, districts, and officers, including the delegate, to use for the convenient and efficient distribution of information as needed. Area 66, our districts, and our groups are a great place to serve Alcoholics Anonymous by carrying the message to A.A. members and those who still suffer. We are guided by the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions, the Twelve Concepts, and the rich heritage of those dedicated and loving servants who have gone before us. — *Vernon Heiskell*

Texas (Southwest): Area 68, one of four areas in the state of Texas, serves 33 districts, 650 groups and 16,000 members. Oral presentations and written materials are always translated for the members of our seven Spanish-speaking districts. We hold four assemblies a year and in the spring we conduct a mock Conference prior to the General Service Conference. The seven standing committees conduct service workshops at the summer and winter assemblies. The fall conference combines service-speakers and area business. Area 68 sponsors two service conferences: Freedom from Bondage C.F.C. in February and Anonymous Not Invisible P.I./C.P.C. Deaf alcoholics can now fully participate in A.A. meetings in Austin and San Antonio thanks to the work of Special Needs Committees. The 56th Annual ICYPAA is coming to San Antonio in August 2014. Area 68 will host the Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly in October 2014 in Corpus Christi, Texas, so please, y'all come! — *James Hurst*

Vermont: Area 70 has 300 registered groups and 5,081 A.A. members. Our assembly meets quarterly, while our area committee meets seven times a year. We have ten standing committees which are active year round and most are represented at area events. There are no intergroups or central offices in Vermont, thus all of the districts have answering services, publish local meeting lists, obtain literature and perform outreach to the various facets of their communities, through their local Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities, Corrections, P.I. and C.P.C. committees. We conduct a pre-Conference Sharing Session, which is loosely modeled after the General Service Conference, to provide the delegate with the area conscience on the agenda items, and also gives our members a glimpse on how their voice is part of the greater whole of A.A. Our assembly holds an annual convention, now in its 51st year. Certainly the notoriety of Vermont, at least in A.A. circles, is that it's the birthplace of both our cofounders, Bill W. and Dr. Bob. I am grateful to Area 70 for entrusting me to be their delegate and for the opportunity to serve A.A. as a whole. — *Heidi Dahlberg*

Washington State (East): Area 92 has 24 districts, which include four nongeographic Hispanic districts. Our groups are approximately 440 strong with over 4,000 members. We're a combination of diverse cultures and ethnic groups including Caucasian, Hispanic, Jamaican, Native American and East Indian populations. Spanish translation of all our area publications and communications has been especially successful. We have remote communities, primarily on the two million square-mile Colville Indian Reservation and just south of the Canadian Border. We have two assemblies and two quarterlies each year and conduct them in English with simultaneous translation into Spanish. Additionally, we hold four Standing Committee Workshops. Our service committees are active in all our districts, providing information and assistance to institutions and communities. Our G.S.R. schools throughout the area are coordinated by the alternate delegate, who also acts as the area registrar. We have created an increased awareness of self-support and this has resulted in increased group contributions both to Area 92 and G.S.O. We support PRAASA (Pacific Region A.A. Service Assembly) through attendance and participation. Annually, we host, with Oregon Area 58, the PNC (Pacific Northwest Conference), one of the longest running conferences in A.A., beginning in 1948. Additionally, we participate with Area 72 Western Washington in the annual Washington State Hispanic Convention. I am grateful and humbled for the opportunity to serve both A.A. as a whole and Washington State East Area 92. — *Dolores Edelman*

Wisconsin (Northern/Upper Peninsula of Michigan): Area 74 has 790 groups, 24 districts, and a pre-Conference Delegates Workshop, four assemblies, five to six area committee meetings, and two conferences. We are guided by the A.A. Responsibility Statement. Throughout our area we have answering services and relationships with the professionals who are in charge of our jails, prisons, courts, treatment centers, and hospitals, which enables us to bring meetings into all of those institutions. Our members are active in P.I. efforts and Bridging the Gap. Our districts get excited about being able to host our conferences, and make sure that everyone who wants to attend can do so. Financial hardship is a real concern for our members, groups and districts, which keeps us vigilant on following any decisions that might create a financial strain on our groups. We continue to strive to be better and to conduct ourselves in accordance with our Steps, Traditions and Concepts. We hold each other to the spirit of servant and elder statesmen. We have our share of inactive districts but we are more abundantly blessed with active, committed A.A. members who fully participate in our Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. — *Mary Jo Rone*

Wyoming: Area 76 has 12 districts and 128 registered groups, and covers over 97,000 square miles. We host two business assemblies and two conventions a year, which rotate to different communities around the area based on a bidding system, with the larger communities hosting conventions and smaller communities the assemblies. The winter assembly discusses and votes on area business as well as Conference agenda items. Summer assemblies are used for area business. We have an active Corrections Committee that is dedicated to carrying the message into our five correctional facilities. Literature and Grapevine people are doing a great job spreading the message. Our archives now have a permanent home. Other committees include P.I./C.P.C., Finance, Guidelines-Report and Charter, and Treatment. We mirror the Conference's committee system in our assemblies. We are happy to be hosting the West Central Regional Forum in August of 2015 in Casper, Wyoming, and have much of the preliminary work done. I am grateful for this opportunity to serve Area 76 and A.A. as a whole. — *Sally Williams*

Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form and made no changes. The committee discussed providing the General Service Conference Evaluation Form in a digital format and agreed that was not appropriate at this time.
- The committee reviewed and discussed their Composition, Scope and Procedure and agreed that point #3 of the current Scope, which is to consider "The Conference Agenda and where appropriate to make suggestions for improvement to the trustees' Committee on the Conference," is ambiguous. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the Conference explore the potential role that the Conference Committee on Agenda might play in the selection process of Agenda items in the future and provide a report to the 2015 Conference Agenda Committee.
- The committee requested that the 2015 Conference Agenda Committee be provided with a report regarding the current and historical process of Agenda item selection.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the Archives Workbook and suggested adding sharing of experience with regard to preservation procedures, as well as on legal considerations for Archives collections.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and Workbook and suggested:
 - Adding an index of past issues of *About A.A.* to the publications tab.
 - Including a copy of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne in each Kit, subject to cost considerations.
 - Include a copy of the April 2010 A.A. Grapevine article entitled, "Spirituality and 'God Talk,'" by former Class A chair of the General Service Board, Ward Ewing, and a copy of the Fall 2003 *About A.A.* newsletter entitled, "The A.A. Program — Spiritual But Never 'Religious.'"
- The committee suggested that changes be made to the service piece *Information on Alcoholics Anonymous* (F-2) under the section "Proof of Attendance at A.A. Meetings" to reflect changes proposed for the pamphlet "If You Are A Professional...."

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Corrections Kit and Workbook and suggested that the DVD, "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" (DV-06) be included in the Corrections Kit (MV-45).
- The committee noted from the trustees' report that the number of requests from male inmates (U.S.) for Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) continues to increase at a rate significantly higher than the number of "outside" male volunteers available. The committee discussed ways to increase participation in C.C.S. including:

- Offer presentations on C.C.S. at A.A. events;
- Communicate the importance of C.C.S. to area delegates;
- Increase awareness of C.C.S. at A.A. meetings;
- Make C.C.S. information and forms more accessible at the home group;
- Use G.S.O. and Grapevine publications to encourage C.C.S. participation;
- Consider the topic of C.C.S. for presentations at Regional Forums.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the suggested area contribution for delegate expense for the Conference and after a lengthy discussion felt an increase was not necessary at this time.
- The committee reviewed the Self-Support packet and suggests that the following changes, as the Self-Support Card (F-42) is being updated by the A.A.W.S. Finance Committee:
 - Add the phrase "Your contributions help ensure the future of our Fellowship worldwide" in the "Some facts" section of the card.
 - Delete the phrase "Give until it feels good" under "Personal thoughts."
 - In addition to reporting the average costs per member, add the year of the costs that are quoted so the reader will know how current the information is.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the 2014 Grapevine Office Report on Audio Strategy and requested that an updated status and financial report on the project, including practices, financials, metrics and plans for the future, be provided to the 2015 Conference Committee on the Grapevine.
- The committee reviewed the A.A. Grapevine Board's suggestion that a new business plan is required for La Viña and requested that a new business plan be developed for La Viña and be brought back to the 2015 Conference Committee on A.A. Grapevine for review.
- The committee reviewed the report from the A.A. Grapevine Board on the feasibility of producing one book in ASL format. The committee agreed with the conclusion of the report that it is not feasible at this time to produce one book in ASL format due to cost considerations and a lack of expressed need.
- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Board the suggestion that Grapevine produce in the year 2015 or later:
 - The Twelve Traditions—Our Experience (working title)
Members share their experience with each of our Twelve A.A. Traditions, previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
 - Cartoon Book II (working title)
A collection of cartoons by A.A. members, previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
 - Special Needs (working title)
Stories by members who are wheelchair-bound, blind, deaf, ill or with other special needs. How A.A. reaches out to everyone. Previously published stories in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
 - Diversity in A.A. (working title)
A.A. members of color share their own stories of getting sober—from previously published stories in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.

- The committee discussed the request to reconsider publish-

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

ing the “Alcoholism at Large” section of the Grapevine and took no action.

- The committee reviewed suggested changes from A.A. Grapevine Board to the pamphlet “A.A. Grapevine and La Viña: Our Meetings in Print” (P-52) and made the following suggestions:
 - Re-edit the pamphlet for consistency and grammar.
 - Use the subtitle “Our Meetings in Print and Other Media” on the cover of the pamphlet and on page 5.

The committee requested that a revised draft be presented to the 2015 Conference Committee for review.

- The committee reviewed the Grapevine Workbook.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional Forums and attract first-time attendees, and some of the suggestions were:
 - Having the Forum Flyer professionally designed so that it would be attractive, perhaps could be used as a table topper;
 - Sharing ideas among areas in a region or region-to-region;
 - Encouraging those who have attended Regional Forums to share their enthusiasm about their experience — word-of-mouth sharing is really powerful;
 - Bring information about the Regional Forum to every district and area event.

LITERATURE

- The committee discussed a suggested change to the first paragraph in the section on Concept XII in the pamphlet “Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated” and took no action. The committee noted that the Report and Charter Committee was discussing a similar proposal.
- The committee discussed multiple suggestions for changes to the pamphlet “Questions & Answers on Sponsorship” and took no action, noting the current language in the pamphlet is adequate.
- The committee discussed a suggestion to reconsider the use of the circle and triangle as an unofficial A.A. service mark on Conference-approved Literature and, agreeing with past Conference Advisory Actions, took no action.
- The committee discussed a suggestion to create a pamphlet for alcoholics with mental illness and took no action. The committee agreed that this subject is adequately addressed in current A.A. literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the 2008 Conference Advisory Action regarding responsibility for site selection of the General Service Conference and took no action. The committee considered that the current hotel site-selection process by the General Service Office management is appropriate. The committee suggested that, in the spirit of clear communication, reports describing the hotel site-selection process of all future General Service Conferences be provided to the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for their information.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the 2014 Comprehensive Media Plan. Because this document will be reviewed and updated on an annual basis, the committee asked the staff secretary to forward some

suggestions to the trustees’ P.I. Committee, including the following:

- Clarification of some terminology since the plan is distributed widely to A.A. members who may be unfamiliar with media jargon.
- Adding annual review of the plan by the Conference P.I. Committee to the cover memo under “process.”
- Emphasis on items not only being “actionable” but also, whenever possible, “measurable.”

- The committee expressed strong support for the forward-looking vision of the Comprehensive Media Plan regarding seeking member-submitted content for future Public Service Announcements, similar to the model used for the Young People’s Video Project.

- The committee reviewed the 2013 Annual Report from the trustees’ Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.’s A.A. website. The committee requested that when ongoing website projects have made further progress than what was reflected in the distributed background, that relevant updates be communicated to the committee prior to the Conference.

- The committee expressed concern about possible inconsistencies between retiring certain P.S.A.s because of conflict with the current full-face policy, and posting video content on AA.org that may also be perceived to conflict with this policy. The committee asked that the A.A.W.S. Board consider offering the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* via a digital platform accessible by local committees, rather than displaying this content on publicly accessible pages of the AA.org website.

- The committee agreed with the assessment provided in the report from the trustees’ Public Information Committee on A.A. Video P.S.A.s regarding the P.S.A.s “I Thought,” “A Force of Nature” and “Testimonials,” including the suggestion that as new P.S.A.s are developed that these three items be retired as quickly as practical.

- The committee considered two proposed items from the report on the 2014 A.A. Membership Survey from the trustees’ Committee on Public Information regarding A.A. member awareness of services offered by G.S.O., and A.A. member awareness of the A.A. Grapevine, and took no action. The committee recognized the potential usefulness of gathering such information, but did not believe these questions fit the historical purpose of the A.A. Membership Survey.

- The committee strongly supported the idea of utilizing digital survey methods for future surveys, and looks forward to hearing from the trustees’ P.I. Committee regarding how such a transition might best be accomplished.

- The committee reviewed presurvey communications for area delegates and groups randomly selected to participate in the 2014 A.A. Membership Survey, and offered some suggestions to the staff secretary for how such communication might be most effective and helpful. The committee acknowledged that successful administration of the survey depends upon delegate participation in the process.

- In light of ongoing anonymity concerns, the committee suggested that delegates and other trusted servants utilize a variety of means, such as workshops, newsletters, panels, delegate reports, local A.A. websites, skits, presentations, etc., to stimulate A.A. members’ discussion on how to maintain anonymity at the public level. Because the ranks of our ever-changing membership exist in an ever-changing world, the committee acknowledged that such efforts truly have no end-point, and might best be incorporated as a regular part of local A.A. discussions and events. The committee asked the staff secretary to explore both direct and indirect ways of sharing these concerns, and a list of A.A. resources on anonymity, with the A.A. Fellowship. The committee also asked

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

the staff secretary to share the following suggestions with the 2015 International Convention coordinator for emphasis on anonymity at the International Convention via the following means:

- Pre-Convention registration and communication materials, including AA.org.
 - Hospitality suite communication and materials.
 - Consideration of an anonymity booth or similar display.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on development of a brief video on anonymity for inclusion with the Annual Letter to the Media, and expressed support for the content and purpose of such a video. The committee requested that if such a video is created that it be brought back to the 2015 Conference Committee on Public Information prior to posting or distribution. The committee recognized that this may mean delayed mailing of the Annual Letter to the Media until after the next Conference. The committee also expressed support for the idea of using both Class A and Class B trustees in the video, with the Class B trustees' anonymity carefully protected, to serve as an example of how A.A. members can share information about A.A. in the media within the spirit of our anonymity tradition.
 - The committee reviewed the contents of the P.I. Kit and Workbook, and suggested adding the following items:
 - Anonymity Online (SM F-197)
 - Anonymity Card (F-20)
 - The committee reviewed the information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the "Tengo Esperanza" public service announcement.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* 2014-2015 Edition, and the 2014 General Service Conference Final Report. The committee noted that the "Report of the 2014 General Service Conference Inventory" in the Final Report may take longer to prepare than the other front matter and asked to review the page proofs of the inventory report as soon as possible prior to publication.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the updates from the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board and suggested some revisions. The committee requested the General Service Board reconsider one item that they had forwarded.
- The committee reviewed the list of editorial updates from the Publishing Department for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- The committee considered a request to modify Article 3 of the Current Conference Charter and took no action. The committee agreed that the proposed modification was unnecessary, noting that the existing phrasing of Article 3 adequately addresses the process for making a change to Article 12 of the Charter, the Twelve Traditions of A.A., or the Twelve Steps of A.A.
- The committee reconsidered a 2013 Conference Advisory Action regarding editing Area Service Highlights in the General Service Conference Final Report and took no action. The committee agreed that the entire Final Report should continue to be professionally edited and published, and noted that they had discussed the Area Service Highlights in 2013. The committee requested that the memo to first-year delegates regarding Area Service Highlights emphasize that the Highlights may be edited for the Final Report.

- The committee considered the A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S., and Western U.S.) and requested that the General Service Office explore alternative methods of accessing and distributing the contact information contained in the A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S., and Western U.S.). The committee requested that a report be brought back to the 2015 Report and Charter Conference Committee.

TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee thoroughly considered a proposal to revise the pamphlet "Bridging the Gap" to expand its scope to include information on related corrections service activity and took no action. The committee acknowledged the desire in some areas for a generic Conference-approved pamphlet about bridging the gap. While some areas have combined corrections and treatment bridging the gap activities, they remain separate in many others. The sense of the committee was that revising the current pamphlet to include both treatment and corrections might not adequately address the variety of bridging the gap programs that areas throughout the U.S. and Canada have developed to address their specific needs. Some of these areas have developed service material tailored specifically to explain their local programs.
- The committee requested that the General Service Board consider whether there is a need to develop a Conference-approved pamphlet addressing bridging the gap activities for corrections.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Committee Kit and Workbook and agreed that the current contents adequately serve the needs of local committees.
- The committee reviewed the Special Needs/Accessibilities Kit and Workbook and expressed appreciation for the service material that is available to assist American Sign Language interpreters. They noted that the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions are available in this format, and requested that a service piece be developed of the Twelve Concepts for World Service for signing purposes.
- The committee noted that the first line in Gloria's Story in the pamphlet "A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs" that says "I was 84 years old and 11 years sober (Although I've been in A.A. since 1962...)" might be confusing to newcomers. They requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities consider whether this language might be clarified and bring back any suggestion for revision to the 2015 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.
- The committee asked that the staff member on the Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities assignment explore ways to provide electronic versions of the Workbooks and other materials in the Kits to committee chairs as an alternative to automatically mailing hard copies.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all Class B trustee candidates for the Eastern Canada and Pacific regional trustees.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

A.A. GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed a request "to reaffirm the Right of Decision of the A.A. Grapevine Board to make formatting decisions

for the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña magazines.” The committee acknowledged that Grapevine and La Viña are valuable Twelfth-Step tools. The committee recommended that the A.A. Grapevine Board have the ability to exercise their right of decision for all formatting decisions in producing Grapevine and La Viña noting that this recommendation removes all formatting restrictions on Grapevine and La Viña.

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended removing the following text from page five in the *Living Sober* booklet:

“Many of us have come to believe that our alcoholism is an addiction to the drug alcohol; like addicts of any sort who want to maintain recovery, we have to keep away from the first dose of the drug we have become addicted to.”

NOTE: The committee agreed that the current text added to confusion regarding A.A.’s Singleness of Purpose.

- The committee recommended that “Nonalcoholics are welcome to attend open meetings as observers” be added to the end of the open meeting side of the Primary Purpose (Blue) Card (F-17) in all three languages when the inventory of the English version is depleted.

The statement will read as follows (addition in **bold**):

“This Is An Open Meeting Of Alcoholics Anonymous

This is an open meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous. We are glad you are all here — especially newcomers. In keeping with our singleness of purpose and our Third Tradition which states that “The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking,” we ask that all who participate confine their discussion to their problems with alcohol. **Nonalcoholics are welcome to attend open meetings as observers.”**

(The 1987 General Service Conference made this statement available as an A.A. service piece for those groups who wish to use it.)

NOTE: The committee agreed that this item is available as a service piece for groups and is not intended to limit attendance at anniversaries or other A.A. events.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee recommended that the Anonymity Card (F-20), which currently reads:

A.A. ANONYMITY (ANNOUNCEMENT FOR READING AT MEETINGS OPEN TO THE PUBLIC)

There may be some here who are not familiar with our Tradition of personal anonymity at the public level:

“Our public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion; we need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio and films.”

Thus, we respectfully ask that A.A. speakers and A.A. members not be photographed, videotaped, or identified by full name on audiotapes and in published or broadcast reports of our meetings, including those reports on new media technologies such as the Internet.

The assurance of anonymity is essential in our efforts to help other problem drinkers who may wish to share our recovery program with us. And our Tradition of anonymity reminds us that “A.A. principles come before personalities.”

Be changed to read:

A.A. ANONYMITY (ANNOUNCEMENT FOR READING AT A.A. MEETINGS)

There may be some here who are not familiar with our Tradition of personal anonymity at the public level:

“Our public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion; we need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio and films.” **Anonymity breaks on the Internet, social media and all other forms of public communications are contrary to our Tradition of personal anonymity at the public level. When we break our anonymity at the public level, we may inadvertently break the anonymity of others, and adversely affect A.A. as a whole.**

In keeping with this spiritual principle, A.A. speakers and A.A. members ought not be photographed, video recorded, or identified by full name on audio recordings, and in published or broadcast reports of our meetings, including online resources accessible by the public.

The assurance of anonymity is essential in our efforts to help other problem drinkers who may wish to share our recovery program with us. And our Tradition of anonymity reminds us that “A.A. principles come before personalities.”

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- To add a single line item to the General Fund budget for La Viña. **(Not approved)**

- The 64th General Service Conference reaffirm the right of decision of the Grapevine Board to making formatting decisions for the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña magazines noting:

- a. That right is already exercised by publication of La Viña in color and
- b. The 2010 Advisory Action recommended a beginning point in bringing La Viña on spiritual parity with the A.A. Grapevine. **(Not approved)**

- The Conference consider the use of the circle and triangle on Conference-approved literature as a historical reminder of A.A.’s Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

- A.A. Grapevine discontinue publishing the “Alcoholism at Large” section of The Grapevine Magazine. **(Not approved)**

- The General Service Conference recommended that literature which focuses on “Alcoholics in Recovery with Mental Health Issues” be developed. **(Not approved)**

- Proposed Anonymity Card

The A.A. principle of anonymity at the public level is one of A.A.’s oldest protections and has helped attract countless newcomers from out of the shadows and into the rooms of Alcoholics Anonymous. Therefore, anonymity breaks on the Internet, social media, and all other forms of public communications are not only contrary to our Tradition of personal anonymity at the public level, they can scare away a problem drinker reaching out for help.

In the spirit of anonymity A.A. speakers and A.A. members ought not be photographed, video recorded, or identified by full name on audio recordings, and in published or broadcast reports of our meetings including online resources accessible to the public. The assurance of anonymity is essential in our efforts to help other problem drinkers who may wish to share our recovery program with us. And our Tradition of Anonymity reminds us that A.A. principles come before personalities. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION
December 31, 2013 (with comparative totals for 2012)

	General Service Board of A.A.								
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund	Pension Benefits	A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2013	Consolidated 2012
ASSETS									
Cash	\$ 854,209	\$ 1,877,370		\$ 162,037		\$ 870,349	\$ 652,182	\$ 4,416,147	\$ 2,876,088
Accounts and interest receivable		9,245				143,793	45,845	198,883	340,865
Intercompany balances	(1,122,145)	(1,932,500)				1,092,663	1,961,982	-	-
Inventories									
Books, pamphlets, etc.						1,345,513	262,483	1,607,996	1,765,124
Paper, prepublication costs, etc.						277,483	41,842	269,325	219,733
Investments - at fair value (Note 2)		15,347,538		2,544,099				17,891,637	18,058,364
Property, Equipment and Software (net of accumulated depreciation and amortization of 2013 - \$4,741,986; 2012 - \$4,699,143) (Note 2)			\$ 477,647			524,528	16,675	1,018,850	1,140,806
Deferred charges and deposits	34,431					89,545	82,059	206,035	214,301
Prepaid conventions	292,118							292,118	195,469
Total Assets	<u>58,613</u>	<u>15,301,653</u>	<u>477,647</u>	<u>2,706,136</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>4,293,874</u>	<u>3,063,068</u>	<u>25,900,991</u>	<u>24,810,750</u>
LIABILITIES									
Accounts and accruals payable	\$ -					\$ 353,677	\$ 125,733	\$ 479,410	\$ 418,370
Deferred income - orders and subscriptions, etc.	1,600					343,911	1,994,602	2,340,113	2,068,775
Accrued postretirement health benefits				\$ 5,664,481				5,664,481	5,937,994
Accrued pension benefits					\$ 3,569,738			3,569,738	10,368,723
Total Liabilities	<u>1,600</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>5,664,481</u>	<u>3,569,738</u>	<u>697,588</u>	<u>2,120,335</u>	<u>12,053,742</u>	<u>18,793,862</u>
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	<u>57,013</u>	<u>15,301,653</u>	<u>477,647</u>	<u>(2,958,345)</u>	<u>(3,569,738)</u>	<u>3,596,286</u>	<u>942,733</u>	<u>13,847,249</u>	<u>6,016,888</u>
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	<u>58,613</u>	<u>15,301,653</u>	<u>477,647</u>	<u>2,706,136</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>4,293,874</u>	<u>3,063,068</u>	<u>25,900,991</u>	<u>24,810,750</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2013 (with comparative totals for 2012)

	General Service Board of A.A.				Pension Benefits	A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		Consolidated 2013	Consolidated 2012
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund			Grapevine	La Viña		
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE										
Gross Sales						\$12,841,973	\$ 3,019,339	\$127,270	\$15,988,582	\$15,791,774
Less: Discounts						237,254	-	-	237,254	255,317
Net Sales						12,604,719	3,019,339	127,270	15,751,328	15,536,457
Cost of Literature Distributed										
Printing						(2,962,241)	(402,183)	(33,544)	(3,397,968)	(3,401,992)
Royalties on books						(27,840)	-	-	(27,840)	(27,161)
Direct shipping and warehousing						(1,505,296)	(623,640)	(30,192)	(2,159,128)	(2,215,000)
Gross Profit from Literature						8,109,342	1,993,516	63,534	10,166,392	9,892,304
CONTRIBUTIONS	\$6,906,371								6,906,371	6,557,608
INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)	114	\$ 40,274		\$ 385,336		390	10,500	-	436,614	268,382
Total Income	6,906,485	40,274		385,336		8,109,732	2,004,016	63,534	17,509,377	16,718,294
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)										
Program	5,751,387			-		3,200,822	1,097,907	206,078	10,256,194	9,796,825
Supporting services	3,756,195		\$122,962	201,737	\$ (772,710)	2,276,259	590,904	-	6,175,347	6,436,156
Total Expenses	9,507,582	-	122,962	201,737	(772,710)	5,477,081	1,688,811	206,078	16,431,541	16,232,981
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(2,601,097)	40,274	(122,962)	183,599	772,710	2,632,651	315,205	(142,544)	1,077,836	485,313
Change in pension liability - nonoperating	-	-	-	726,250	6,026,275	-	-	-	6,752,525	(293,769)
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS										
GSB La Viña support	(142,544)	-	-	-	-	-	-	142,544	-	-
Other transfers	2,743,641	(92,374)	-	-		(2,651,267)	-	-	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	(52,100)	(122,962)	909,849	6,798,985	(18,616)	315,205	-	7,830,361	191,544
NET ASSETS										
Beginning of year	57,013	15,353,753	600,609	(3,868,194)	(10,368,723)	3,614,902	627,528	-	6,016,888	5,825,344
NET ASSETS										
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	15,301,653	477,647	(2,958,345)	(3,569,738)	3,596,286	942,733	-	13,847,249	6,016,888

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2013 (with comparative totals for 2012)

	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	La Viña	Supporting Services	2013 Total	2012 Total
OPERATING EXPENSES											
Salaries	\$ 806,411	\$ 992,296	\$ 173,946		\$190,522	\$1,359,797	\$ 447,222	\$135,462	\$2,586,142	\$6,691,798	\$6,367,387
Payroll taxes	59,893	76,897	12,740		14,733	105,856	36,442	10,307	195,943	512,811	478,565
Health and group insurance	119,917	152,850	25,662		29,425	210,859	62,504	10,911	651,624	1,263,752	1,177,788
Retirement expense - funding	302,109	385,669	64,520		74,340	531,107	100,046	32,400	939,230	2,429,421	2,112,019
Other program printing	205,189	69,536	62,066		12,495				450	349,736	371,426
Mailing labor	108,923	7,100	1,721		3,810				82	121,636	104,968
Postage and express	227,249	40,214	43,285		25,593	8,616	4,971		31,387	381,315	373,268
Writers fees	16,532	7,900	10,680		4,510	900			466	40,988	58,096
Foreign literature assistance		43,652								43,652	56,004
Selling expenses						340,437	157,809	4,862	65,613	568,721	557,235
Professional fees								140	173,585	173,725	220,074
Contracted services	100,480	180,505	44,847		16,897	149,467	133,152	7,979	610,703	1,244,030	1,350,176
Occupancy	107,238	138,855	10,770		3,102	198,427	28,753		369,733	856,878	840,266
Telephone	14,004	13,610	2,133		1,297	13,293	14,318		78,137	136,792	129,196
Equipment maintenance	1,394	6,505				15,490			58,279	81,668	90,749
Depreciation and amortization	33,793	15,957	2,125		2,181	237,746			58,754	350,556	202,745
Stationery and office	82,701	8,904	11,281		6,548	1,231	56,345		68,737	235,747	218,087
Office service and expense	6,004	13,733	25,252		7,584	14,388	56,345	1,647	254,011	378,964	369,466
Travel, meals and accommodations	1,611	41,472	704,079		66,176	13,208		2,370	474,154	1,303,070	1,402,480
Bad debts									6,328	6,328	17,820
Delegate fees			(292,036)							(292,036)	(336,491)
Total Operating Expenses	<u>2,193,448</u>	<u>2,195,655</u>	<u>903,071</u>	<u>459,213</u>	<u>459,213</u>	<u>3,200,822</u>	<u>1,097,907</u>	<u>206,078</u>	<u>6,623,358</u>	<u>16,879,552</u>	<u>16,161,324</u>
Severance benefits									-	-	10,226
Postretirement health benefits									201,737	201,737	162,871
Retirement expense adjustment									(772,710)	(772,710)	(218,803)
Capital projects depreciation									122,962	122,962	117,363
Total Expenses	<u>2,193,448</u>	<u>2,195,655</u>	<u>903,071</u>	<u>459,213</u>	<u>459,213</u>	<u>3,200,822</u>	<u>1,097,907</u>	<u>206,078</u>	<u>6,175,347</u>	<u>16,431,541</u>	<u>16,232,981</u>
Allocation of supporting services to activities	<u>1,261,666</u>	<u>1,262,935</u>	<u>519,444</u>	<u>264,139</u>	<u>264,139</u>	<u>2,276,259</u>	<u>590,904</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>(6,175,347)</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>
Total Allocated Expenses	<u>3,455,114</u>	<u>3,458,590</u>	<u>1,422,515</u>	<u>723,352</u>	<u>723,352</u>	<u>5,477,081</u>	<u>1,688,811</u>	<u>206,078</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>16,431,541</u>	<u>16,232,981</u>
Services	\$3,455,114	\$3,458,590	\$1,422,515	-	\$723,352					9,059,571	9,315,563
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	5,477,081				5,477,081	5,029,421
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,688,811	206,078		1,894,889	1,887,997
										<u>16,431,541</u>	<u>16,232,981</u>
COMPARATIVE TOTALS 2012	<u>\$3,484,776</u>	<u>\$3,420,891</u>	<u>\$1,284,954</u>	<u>\$352,375</u>	<u>\$772,567</u>	<u>\$5,029,421</u>	<u>\$1,706,712</u>	<u>\$181,285</u>		<u>\$16,232,981</u>	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
 Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
 Year Ended December 31, 2013
 (with comparative totals for 2012)**

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>2013</u>	<u>2012</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ 7,830,361	\$ 191,544
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	(314,997)	(94,489)
Amortization of bond premiums	4,423	5,570
Depreciation and amortization	496,601	343,188
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	141,982	(37,582)
Inventories	107,536	(36,166)
Deferred charges and other assets	(88,383)	(75,068)
Accounts and accruals payable	61,040	(118,728)
Deferred income	271,338	9,080
Postretirement health benefits obligation	(273,513)	413,871
Accrued pension benefits	(6,798,985)	74,966
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided</u>		
<u>by Operating Activities</u>	<u>1,437,403</u>	<u>676,186</u>
FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Purchases of property and equipment	(374,645)	(306,916)
Proceeds from sales of investments	6,768,354	5,525,267
Purchases of investments	(6,291,053)	(6,321,606)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u>		
<u>by Investing Activities</u>	<u>102,656</u>	<u>(1,103,255)</u>
Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash	<u>1,540,059</u>	<u>(427,069)</u>
Cash, beginning of year	<u>2,876,088</u>	<u>3,303,157</u>
Cash, end of year	<u><u>4,416,147</u></u>	<u><u>2,876,088</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

■ Report of the Independent Auditor

INDEPENDENT AUDITORS' REPORT

March 25, 2014

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10115

Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2013 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

Management's Responsibility for the Financial Statements

Management is responsible for the preparation and fair presentation of these financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America; this includes the design, implementation, and maintenance of internal control relevant to the preparation and fair presentation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

Auditor's Responsibility

Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit. We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement.

An audit involves performing procedures to obtain audit evidence about the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. The procedures selected depend on the auditor's judgement, including the assessment of the risks of material misstatement of the financial statements, whether due to fraud or error. In making those risk assessments, the auditor considers internal control relevant to the entity's preparation and fair presentation of the financial statements in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the entity's internal control. Accordingly, we express no such opinion. An audit also includes evaluating the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of significant accounting estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall presentation of the financial statements.

We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our audit opinion.

The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2012 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated April 1, 2013, we expressed an unmodified opinion on those financial statements.

Opinion

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2013 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Other Matter

Our audit was conducted for the purpose of forming an opinion on the financial statements as a whole. The consolidating information presented in the consolidated statement of financial position is presented for purposes of additional analyses and is not a required part of the financial statements. Such information is the responsibility of management and was derived from and relates directly to the underlying accounting and other records used to prepare the financial statements. The information has been subjected to the auditing procedures applied in the audit of the financial statements and certain additional procedures, including comparing and reconciling such information directly to the underlying accounting and other records used to prepare the financial statements or to the financial statements themselves, and other additional procedures in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. In our opinion, the information is fairly stated in all material respects in relation to the financial statements as a whole.

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants
New York, N.Y.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 2013

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., ("G.S.B.") and its affiliates A.A. World Services, Inc. ("A.A.W.S.") and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. ("A.A.G.V.") are not-for-profit organizations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose. The trustees of G.S.B. are members ex officio of A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V., and as such, elect their boards of directors. As members, they also have the sole right to amend the A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. by-laws, and approve their budgets.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in five separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND — This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was redefined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND — This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND — A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of international A.A. Conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the

regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all Conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$1,561,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund.

The POSTRETIREMENT MEDICAL FUND — A fund established in 2006 with the goal of accumulating assets equal to 50 % of the liability for postretirement health benefits by the end of ten years.

The Postretirement health benefits plan is described in more detail in Note 5.

The GENERAL FUND — This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Organization was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Organizations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Organizations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

The Organizations receive revenue from sales of literature and magazine subscriptions and donations from A.A. groups and members.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the International Literature Fund are also treated as unrestricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers are eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been charged based on the actual lease cost; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organizations only maintain accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Accounts Receivable: Receivables from sales of literature are recognized when items are shipped. Allowances for doubtful accounts are recorded based on the age of the receivables.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are capitalized and depreciated over estimated useful lives of three to eight years.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2013 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	<u>Life</u>	<u>Cost</u>	<u>Current Year</u>	<u>Accumulated Depreciation</u>
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$3,122,741	\$122,962	\$2,645,094
Furniture	8 Years	754,354	6,994	741,777
Computers	3 to 5 Years	441,072	63,464	285,446
Software	5 Years	1,442,669	303,181	1,069,669
		5,760,836	496,601	4,741,986

During 2013, \$125,000 of capitalized software for ebook applications was charged to expense after A.A.W.S. decided to discontinue their own application in favor of commercially available ebook applications.

Investments: Investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

The Organizations follow Accounting Standards Codification ("ASC") 820, Fair Value Measurements. It establishes a framework for measuring fair value, and expands disclosures about fair value measurements. Investments are now classified into one of three categories.

Level 1 — Quoted prices are available in active markets for identical investments as of the reporting date.

Level 2 — Pricing inputs are other than quoted prices in active markets, which are either directly or indirectly observable as of the reporting date, and the fair value is determined through the use of models or other valuation methodologies.

Level 3 — Pricing inputs are unobservable for the investment and include situations where there is little, if any, market activity for the investment.

All of the securities held by the Organizations at December 31, 2013 and 2012 have been valued at either Level 1 or Level 2.

Level 2 investments have been valued using the net asset values as reported by the mutual funds.

As described above, all funds of the operating entities not required for working capital are consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Reserve Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity and certificates of deposit.

The Postretirement Medical Fund holds investments designed to assist in reaching the stated goal of accumulating assets equal to 50 % of the accrued postretirement health benefits by December 31, 2015. This fund invests in bond and equity mutual funds.

At December 31, 2013, investments were comprised as follows:

	<u>Cost</u>	<u>Fair Value</u>	<u>Level 1</u>	<u>Level 2</u>
Reserve Fund				
Certificate of deposits	\$8,577,660	\$8,577,660	\$8,577,660	\$ -
U.S. Treasury	6,739,064	6,769,878	6,769,878	-
Totals	15,316,724	15,347,538		
Postretirement Medical Fund				
Bond funds	846,307	835,785	-	835,785
Equity funds				
Small Cap Index	101,725	147,264	-	147,264
Mid Cap Index	98,880	138,718	-	138,718
S&P 500 Index	749,787	1,117,625	-	1,117,625
International Index	264,419	304,707	-	304,707

	2,059,118	2,544,099		
Totals	<u>17,375,842</u>	<u>17,891,637</u>	<u>15,347,538</u>	<u>2,544,099</u>

Investment income for 2013 and 2012 is comprised of the following:

	2013	2012
Interest and dividends	\$ 148,078	\$ 199,576
Realized gains	15,937	9,399
Change in unrealized appreciation	299,060	85,090
Investment expenses	<u>(26,461)</u>	<u>(25,683)</u>
	<u>436,614</u>	<u>268,382</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including staff services, the *Box 459* newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French and Spanish speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Organizations use estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that changes in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Subsequent Events: In connection with the preparation of these consolidated financial statements, Management evaluated subsequent events after the balance sheet date of December 31, 2013 through March 25, 2014, which was the date the financial statements were able to be issued.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multi-

plied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense has been recorded in accordance with ASC 715 under which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors that are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, ASC 715 requires an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under ASC 715 is recorded as an adjustment to retirement expense as a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2013:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 24,088,753
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>27,658,491</u>
Funded status	<u>(3,569,738)</u>
Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	<u>\$ 3,569,738</u>
Accumulated benefit obligation	\$ 24,538,738
Benefit cost	1,332,290
Employers' contributions	2,105,000
Benefits paid	1,086,724
Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 2,105,000
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	<u>(772,710)</u>
	<u>1,332,290</u>
Weighted — Average Assumptions used to determine benefits obligations at December 31, 2013:	
Discount rate	4.76 %
Salary increases	3.5 %
Expected long-term return on assets	8.0 %
Weighted — Average Assumptions used to determine net periodic pension cost for year ended December 31, 2013:	
Discount rate	3.88 %
Salary increases	3.5 %
Expected long-term return on assets	8.0 %

The expected rate of return on plan assets is determined by those assets' historical long-term investment performance, current asset allocation, and estimates of future long-term returns by asset class.



The fair value of plan assets at December 31, 2013 were composed as follows:

	Total	Level 1	Level 2
Cash and equivalents	\$ 1,327,809	\$1,327,809	\$ -
Domestic equity mutual funds	13,294,221	-	13,294,221
International equity mutual fund	2,739,205	-	2,739,205
Bond mutual funds	6,727,518	-	6,727,518
Totals	<u>\$24,088,753</u>	<u>\$1,327,809</u>	<u>\$22,760,944</u>

The mutual funds in the plan are primarily index funds designed to achieve diversification between fixed income and equity investments among asset classes including S&P 500, small capitalization companies and international stocks.

The expected benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2014	\$ 1,375,967
2015	1,501,149
2016	1,544,586
2017	1,564,095
2018	1,580,950
2019 - 2023	8,516,009

The employers' contributions for 2014 are expected to be \$3,190,000, which includes an additional \$1,500,000 contribution authorized and paid from the Reserve Fund in February 2014.

Effective January 1, 2013, the Corporations implemented a "soft freeze" of the defined benefit pension plan. Employees in the plan as of December 31, 2012, continue to accrue benefits; however, employees hired after that date participate instead in a new defined contribution plan. The contribution rate is 5% plus a 50% match on employee contributions up to 5%. Therefore, the maximum combined rate is 7.5%. The 2013 pension cost was \$25,218.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2013, A.A.W.S. as fiscal agent for the G.S.B. and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) for office space at 475 Riverside Drive in New York City:

\$775,450 annual leases effective January 1, 2009 through December 31, 2018 for space on the 10th and 11th floors;

\$46,264 annual lease effective January 1, 2012 through November 30, 2014 for space on the 12th floor.

Future minimum rental payments due under the leases are as follows:



2014	\$ 817,859
2015	775,450
2016	775,450
2017	775,450
2018	775,450
	<u>\$3,919,659</u>

The space on the 10th floor is subleased at \$121,255 per year from February 15, 2012 through December 31, 2015 to an unaffiliated not-for-profit organization. The above lease expense will be offset by payments due under the sublease as follows:

2014	\$121,255
2015	121,255
	<u>\$242,510</u>

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Organizations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

For employees hired after January 1, 2004, there is a three-tier structure in the level of group medical insurance premiums paid for on behalf of employees who retire directly from GSO. For employees with 5-9 years of service, the Organizations pay 25%, 10-15 years 50% and more than 15 years 75%.

The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 6.0%. A discount rate of 4.76% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B at December 31, 2013. The discount rate was 3.88% at December 31, 2012.

Prior to 2006, the Plan was unfunded. However, as described in Note 1, a Postretirement Medical Fund was created by the Board with the purpose of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the postretirement health benefits liability after ten years. As of December 31, 2013, the Fund's assets were equal to 47.8% of the benefit obligation.

The following table sets forth information regarding the Plan for 2013:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	\$5,664,481
Benefits paid	\$ 212,166
Benefit cost	<u>\$ 664,903</u>
Benefit cost reported by:	
Operating entities	\$ 463,166
Postretirement Medical Fund	<u>\$ 201,737</u>
	<u>\$664,903</u>

The expected postretirement benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2014	\$ 224,896
2015	238,390
2016	252,693
2017	267,855
2018	283,926
2019 - 2023	1,696,552

Note 6 Tax Status: The Organizations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

The Organizations have not entered into any uncertain tax positions that would require financial statement recognition. They are also no longer subject to audits by the applicable taxing jurisdictions for the periods prior to 2010.

The General Service Office 2014 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	2013 Budget	2013 Actual	2014 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$12,800,000	\$12,841,973	\$15,300,000
Discounts Allowed	260,000	237,254	594,000
<u>Net Sales</u>	12,540,000	12,604,719	14,706,000
Cost of Literature Distributed			
Manufacturing	3,100,000	2,962,241	3,503,500
Royalties	28,000	27,840	38,870
<u>Gross Margin</u>	9,412,000	9,614,638	11,163,630
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	1,629,200	1,505,296	1,940,070
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	7,782,800	8,109,342	9,223,560
Contributions Received	6,697,000	6,906,371	7,000,000
Interest Income	750	504	400
<u>Total Revenue</u>	14,480,550	15,016,217	16,223,960
 OPERATING EXPENSES			
Salaries	5,915,000	5,870,730	6,390,500
Payroll taxes	435,000	443,611	444,250
Insurance	1,148,200	1,104,493	1,244,791
Retirement expense	2,234,000	2,232,066	1,916,750
Other program printing	389,900	349,735	406,150
Mailing, labor, etc.	124,500	121,636	134,700
Postage & express	439,000	376,345	436,000
Writers' fees	42,500	40,988	105,000
Other literature assistance	90,000	43,652	50,000
Selling expenses	298,900	406,051	499,250
Professional fees	209,500	137,259	209,500
Contracted services	991,300	1,102,896	1,201,400
Occupancy	800,500	809,471	836,000
Telephone	107,825	112,360	122,200
Equipment maintenance	70,215	64,266	75,300
Furniture & equipment	217,900	342,581	273,500
Stationery & office expense	162,500	179,402	180,750
Office service & expense	314,950	290,906	326,275
Travel, meals, & accommodations	1,090,100	953,594	1,073,700
Bad debts	10,000	2,621	2,500
<u>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</u>	15,091,790	14,984,663	15,928,516
INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	<u>(\$611,240)</u>	<u>\$31,554</u>	<u>\$295,444</u>

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2014 BUDGET

	GRAPEVINE			LA VIÑA		
	2013 Budget	2013 Actual	2014 Budget	2013 Budget	2013 Actual	2014 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION—						
AVERAGE # OF Print COPIES	78,760	77,126	73,401	9,200	10,145	10,607
On-Line Circulation	4,653	5,175	4,561			
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE						
Subscription income	\$2,041,459	\$2,059,479	\$1,969,167	\$96,648	\$106,921	\$111,790
Single copies and back issues	32,049	31,681	30,255	10,185	9,590	9,590
Digital Magazine Subscriptions						
GV Online	126,748	151,203	133,429			
<u>Total magazine income</u>	2,200,256	2,242,363	2,132,851	106,833	116,549	121,380
<u>Total direct costs</u>	815,296	764,674	750,733	53,204	61,791	64,113
Gross Profit on Magazine	1,384,960	1,477,689	1,382,118	53,629	54,758	57,267
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	704,320	776,976	787,557	16,210	10,721	9,649
<u>Total direct costs</u>	269,421	261,149	266,556	5,086	1,945	1,751
Gross Profit on Special Items	434,899	515,827	521,001	11,124	8,776	7,898
Total Gross Profit	1,819,859	1,993,516	1,903,119	64,753	63,534	65,165
COSTS AND EXPENSES						
EDITORIAL COSTS						
Salaries, including temporary help	393,008	382,534	398,421	79,120	94,616	95,479
Payroll taxes and benefits	155,781	152,115	153,114	36,324	34,283	33,639
Occupancy costs	46,821	35,285	36,344			
Office supplies and expenses	25,379	23,532	24,238	116	1,647	1,696
Magazine Redesign						
Product development & Web	75,000	40,332	75,000			
<u>Total Editorial</u>	695,989	633,798	687,117	115,560	130,546	130,814
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS						
Salaries, including temporary help	360,189	337,511	380,640	41,012	40,846	41,012
Payroll taxes and benefits	216,073	220,081	208,843	20,362	19,335	19,103
Fulfillment	99,016	120,277	95,603	8,640	7,979	8,218
Occupancy costs	43,912	36,555	37,652			
Office supplies and expenses	92,002	89,158	91,833			
Selling expense-regular	95,000	84,662	95,000	4,386	4,862	5,008
- GvR program	7,000	11,251	11,589			
Postage	7,565	4,971	5,120			
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	920,757	904,466	926,280	74,400	73,022	73,341
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE						
Computer Consulting	30,000	17,402	30,000			
Insurance	6,682	7,556	7,783			
Professional fees	60,000	36,326	60,000			
Meetings and conferences	64,970	55,070	62,000	1,707	2,370	2,441
Furniture and equipment	15,000	7,975	15,000			
Canadian exchange and other	4,000	6,290	5,800	140	140	144
Bank service charges	14,807	16,221	16,707			
Bad debts	12,000	3,707	10,000			
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	207,459	150,547	207,290	1,847	2,510	2,585
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	1,824,205	1,688,811	1,820,687	191,807	206,078	206,740
Add: Interest earned	16,300	10,500	11,800			
Support from GSB General Fund				127,054	142,544	141,575
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	\$11,954	\$315,205	\$94,232	\$0	\$0	\$0

2013 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings — by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTION PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS ⁽¹⁾	SPECIAL MEETINGS ⁽²⁾	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	440	206	46.8%	42,349	9,050	\$4.67	754	1,000	390		\$44,493.15	\$4.92
2.	Alaska	186	93	50.0	23,674	3,241	7.29	1,060	0	307		25,041.20	7.73
3.	Arizona	941	467	49.6	114,748	21,271	5.38	5,731	4,550	2,623	601	128,253.54	6.03
4.	Arkansas	255	142	55.7	26,981	4,549	5.92	462	0	2,141		29,584.44	6.50
California													
5.	Southern	1,325	386	29.1	107,969	48,293	2.23	7,634	5,400	1,587	1,104	123,694.73	2.56
6.	N. Coastal	1,981	1,121	56.6	275,414	59,615	4.61	33,835	150	7,628	124	317,150.24	5.32
7.	N. Interior	1,008	451	44.7	86,819	29,058	2.98	8,021	25	3,045	75	97,985.38	3.37
8.	San Diego/Imp.	1,019	392	38.5	74,658	28,153	2.64	3,311	3,500	1,107		82,576.83	2.93
9.	Mid-South.	2,012	824	41.0	177,753	61,286	2.89	10,759	1,000	3,197	413	193,122.68	3.15
10.	Colorado	813	440	54.1	108,464	18,842	5.75	9,661	2,020	7,329	135	127,609.78	6.77
11.	Connecticut	1,529	623	40.7	128,271	34,912	3.66	16,306	2,840	31,624	396	179,436.87	5.14
12.	Delaware	256	121	47.3	33,817	3,799	8.89	817	1,250	1,800	100	37,783.16	9.95
13.	D.C.	498	214	43.0	55,640	15,075	3.68	1,354	50	1,882		58,925.88	3.91
Florida													
14.	North	954	446	46.8	108,363	19,486	5.55	10,591	140	12,056	107	131,256.67	6.74
15.	South/	2,044	925	45.3	193,141	42,145	4.57	16,641	176	61,164	65	271,187.22	6.43
16.	Georgia	768	467	60.8	105,570	18,815	5.60	9,438		2,055	105	117,167.42	6.23
17.	Hawaii	320	162	50.6	39,828	5,471	7.27	3,635	0	678	75	44,215.21	8.08
18.	Idaho	251	102	40.6	19,489	4,609	4.22	491	0	1,821		21,801.08	4.73
Illinois													
19.	Chicago	1,346	356	26.4	80,263	29,258	2.73	3,652	20	980		84,914.57	2.90
20.	North	1,216	460	37.8	61,296	23,027	2.65	6,948	28	37,419		105,690.84	4.59
21.	South	443	170	38.4	25,473	7,605	3.34	567	100	1,527		27,667.43	3.64
Indiana													
22.	North	679	278	40.9	43,916	10,120	4.33	2,071	25	6,435	93	52,540.63	5.19
23.	South	677	313	46.2	42,991	12,238	3.50	729	5,075	2,631	61	51,486.46	4.21
24.	Iowa	704	311	44.2	56,879	14,084	4.03	3,187	95	725	249	61,135.57	4.34
25.	Kansas	360	180	50.0	31,029	9,088	3.40	979	300	7025		39,332.47	4.33
26.	Kentucky	719	324	45.1	71,907	11,629	6.17	8,153	0	10,419	40	90,518.23	7.78
27.	Louisiana	573	198	34.6	48,322	11,165	4.32	2,914	0	2,583		53,818.90	4.82
28.	Maine	541	173	32.0	21,935	8,634	2.53	3,370	0	3,937	610	29,851.17	3.46
29.	Maryland	1,058	447	42.2	90,712	16,584	5.46	5,670	500	964	70	97,915.90	5.90
Massachusetts													
30.	East	1,482	519	35.0	127,780	47,534	2.68	8,876	0	1,246		137,902.48	2.90
31.	West	318	166	52.2	23,611	5,346	4.41	597	0	0	2,000	26,208.35	4.90
Michigan													
32.	Central	695	261	37.6	37,987	15,430	2.45	4,654	0	441	30	43,112.66	2.79
33.	Southeast	949	280	29.5	49,463	21,182	2.33	3,241	5,040	885		58,629.00	2.77
34.	West	636	208	32.7	44,365	12,677	3.49	2,249	50	5,005		51,668.98	4.08
Minnesota													
35.	North	572	258	45.1	33,302	8,438	3.94	616	500	8,876		43,293.36	5.13
36.	South	1,135	426	37.5	89,121	27,105	3.28	1,168	0	1,000	81	91,368.76	3.37
37.	Mississippi	228	102	44.7	22,388	4,554	4.91	20	0	1,110		23,517.59	5.16
Missouri													
38.	East	583	238	40.8	53,861	9,390	5.73	1,856	120	1,010		56,846.23	6.05
39.	West	233	121	51.9	21,056	7,099	2.96	286	25	653		22,019.02	3.10
40.	Montana	282	136	48.2	31,607	5,713	5.52	821	4,028	300		36,756.23	6.43
41.	Nebraska	687	268	39.0	47,617	15,534	3.06	1,551	2,000	2,993		54,161.59	3.49
42.	Nevada	618	205	33.2	40,284	14,198	2.83	3,927	5,000	5,930	30	55,170.52	3.89
43.	New Hampshire	633	279	44.1	39,785	10,921	3.63	4,064	0	7,440		51,289.52	4.70
New Jersey													
44.	North	1,373	560	40.8	134,006	33,069	4.04	17,936	0	2,873		154,815.13	4.68
45.	South	565	256	45.3	63,953	9,479	6.74	1,643	0	266		65,861.95	6.95
46.	New Mexico	377	181	48.0	34,305	7,464	4.59	3,052	1,000	3,010	8	41,374.41	5.54
New York													
47.	Central	762	283	37.1	49,181	11,207	4.38	7,896	0	1,846	300	59,223.17	5.28
48.	H./M./B.	742	301	40.6	33,440	10,787	3.09	2,225	0	3,486		39,150.92	3.63
49.	Southeast	1,802	731	40.6	257,300	57,481	4.47	6,990	100	3,751	125	268,265.96	4.67
50.	West	376	93	24.7	17,925	6,245	2.86	402	0	50	80	18,456.53	2.96
51.	N. Carolina	1,147	574	50.0	156,269	19,697	7.92	18,777	0	9,575	17	184,637.94	9.37
52.	North Dakota	161	79	49.1	16,240	3,418	4.74	260	0	2,303	20	18,822.60	5.51
Ohio													
53.	Cent. & S.E.	843	233	27.6	28,196	10,766	2.61	3,720	0	449	50	32,414.46	3.01
54.	Northeast	1,543	333	21.6	37,709	19,631	1.91	709	0	3,493		41,911.24	2.13
55.	N.W. Ohio/ S.E. Mich.	303	97	32.0	13,010	4,291	3.02	310	25	0		13,344.97	3.11
56.	S.W. Ohio	535	265	49.5	47,377	9,614	4.92	609	50	2,918	90	51,044.59	5.31
57.	Oklahoma	421	181	43.0	37,691	9,356	4.02	4,502	109	642		42,943.68	4.59
58.	Oregon	1,166	423	36.3	76,938	22,283	3.44	2,139	208	4,852	346	84,482.56	3.79

Pennsylvania													
59.	East	1,602	800	49.9	174,218	32,656	5.32	10,187	100	7,840	58	192,402.96	5.89
60.	West	929	387	41.7	58,150	12,431	4.67	3,875	5,152	3,098		70,274.81	5.65
61.	Rhode Island	296	127	42.9	23,764	6,001	3.95	2,262	0	2,648		28,673.75	4.78
62.	South Carolina	395	192	48.6	53,174	9,529	5.57	2,311	50	5,628		61,162.94	6.42
63.	South Dakota	187	75	40.1	14,704	4,179	3.51	636	0	421	20	15,780.88	3.78
64.	Tennessee	575	243	42.3	54,235	12,385	4.37	5,778	0	320		60,332.72	4.87
Texas													
65.	Northeast	512	190	37.1	99,407	19,881	4.99	15,318	50	6,152		120,926.69	6.08
66.	Northwest	263	77	29.3	19,683	5,265	3.73	746	1,000	1,922		23,350.75	4.44
67.	Southeast	641	281	43.8	74,020	16,710	4.42	6,060	125	4,011		84,216.48	5.04
68.	Southwest	628	278	44.3	93,178	14,814	6.28	4,639	0	3,038	137	100,992.09	6.82
69.	Utah	376	162	43.1	34,054	7,076	4.80	871	0	1,545	215	36,685.75	5.18
70.	Vermont	293	137	46.8	28,780	5,055	5.68	3,405	0	7,275	60	39,520.12	7.82
71.	Virginia	1,469	732	49.8	173,118	26,150	6.61	15,625	0	5,850	204	194,796.67	7.45
72.	Western Washington	1,471	639	43.4	132,761	30,791	4.30	12,334	3,000	7,090	143	155,328.74	5.04
73.	West Virginia	280	126	45.0	13,744	2,911	4.71	1,105	200	695	40	15,783.81	5.42
Wisconsin													
74.	N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	748	268	35.8	27,234	10,907	2.49	1,010	0	188		28,431.89	2.61
75.	South	1,066	425	39.9	52,026	19,815	2.62	1,750	50	548		54,373.73	2.74
76.	Wyoming	127	60	47.2	14,477	2,271	6.36	645	0	1,037		16,159.16	7.12
77.	Puerto Rico	120	69	57.5	7,675	1,207	6.35	227	0	1,132	100	9,134.31	7.57
78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	539	242	44.9	76,957	9,001	8.54	1,481	951	5,367	100	84,856.92	9.43
79.	B.C./Yukon	838	412	49.2	115,823	15,221	7.60	7,755	5,047	8,011		136,635.85	8.98
80.	Manitoba	150	42	28.0	10,593	3,900	2.71	193	0	0		10,786.11	2.77
81.	N.B./P.E.I.	203	88	43.3	14,591	3,294	4.42	301		1,142		16,033.56	4.87
82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	253	114	45.1	25,218	3,289	7.66	232	0	6,216		31,666.06	9.63
Ontario													
83.	East	602	256	42.5	65,581	14,578	4.49	1,850	954	19,519	735	88,640.19	6.08
84.	Northeast	170	75	44.1	17,330	1,763	9.82	6	0	2,814		20,150.21	11.43
85.	Northwest	59	14	23.7	3,960	1,002	3.94	36	0	2,259	99	6,353.90	6.34
86.	West	600	259	43.2	84,982	10,605	8.00	606	0	17,987		103,575.67	9.77
Quebec ⁽³⁾													
87.	Southwest	555	411	74.1	23,813	12,536	1.89	1,652	0	16,176		41,640.93	3.32
88.	Southeast	202	182	90.1	1,893	2,950	0.63	569	0	18,719		21,180.81	7.18
89.	Northeast	326	258	79.1	1,263	6,062	0.20	2,636	0	24,776	47	28,722.03	4.74
90.	Northwest	358	269	75.1	2,251	6,373	0.34	882	0	140,232		143,365.58	22.50
91.	Saskatchewan	274	134	48.9	32,402	2,991	10.82	908	0	8,747		42,057.26	14.06
92.	Washington East	445	212	47.6	31,068	5,622	5.52	555	0	2,562	33	34,218.12	6.09
93.	Central Calif	1,059	396	37.4	98,740	29,370	3.35	6,598		1,096	3,224	109,657.81	3.73
Total U.S./ Canada		64,694	27,481	42.5%	\$5,718,305.63	1,389,602	4.12	\$398,880.01	\$63,178.11	\$629,542.04	\$12,814.63	\$6,822,721.31	\$4.91
Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings					\$474,874								
Specials					\$629,542								
Total for U.S. & Canada					\$6,822,721.31								
FOREIGN AND OTHER													
Online and Telephone Meetings					\$1,641								
Correctional and Hospital facility groupups					\$30								
Foreign, WSM, other					\$73,800								
Internationalists					\$3,077								
International Lawyers in A.A.					\$1,000								
Loners					\$4,102								
Grand Total					\$6,906,371.02								

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON – 2012-2013 – (in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	TOTAL PER CAPITA INCLUDING SPECIALS ETC			
U.S. & Canada 2013	64,694	27,841	42.5%	\$5,718,305.63	1,389,602	\$4.12	\$4.91			
U.S. & Canada 2012	64,414	27,332	42.4%	\$5,459,874.20	1,388,727	\$3.93	\$4.68	2013	2012	
Increase (Decrease)	280	159	0.1%	\$258,431.43	875	\$0.18	\$0.23	EST. COST OF SERVICES PER CAPITA	6.84	\$6.66

⁽¹⁾A Special contribution is one that comes from any number of AA entities that is not an AA Group. For example, a Conference, a Committee, an Area, a District, an Intergroup, etc.

⁽²⁾A Special Meeting is a meeting that does not want to be a group but does want to contribute to the General Service Board.

⁽³⁾Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per info from areas).

The Budget Highlights

2014 G.S.O. Budget

These budget highlights describe the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office — A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation), the General Fund (Service activities) and the Grapevine Operations. It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund, Post Retirement Fund or the Capital Projects Fund.

Income: The 2014 budget projects gross sales of \$15,300,000. Ongoing unit sales are expected to be approximately even with 2013, however, the 2014 budget anticipates sales of the 75th Anniversary Edition of the first edition of the Big Book; also, a general price adjustment is scheduled for late in the year (October 2014). While reviewing and recommending the 2014 budget the A.A.W.S. Board continues to consider that revenue and expense assumptions ultimately affect the long-term fiscal health of the General Service Board and its Reserve Fund.

Manufacturing, royalties, and shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted higher than both the 2013 budget and the 2013 actual results, primarily due to the costs for the 75th Anniversary Edition.

After subtracting manufacturing costs, royalties and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$9,223,560, or 62.7%. Gross profit has been budgeted about \$1,114,000 more than 2013, again primarily due to the Anniversary Edition. The 62.7% gross profit percentage anticipated for 2014 compares with 64.3% realized for 2013.

It should be recognized that as we continue to strive to have literature available throughout our Service Structure in Spanish and French, as well as English, lower print runs in non-English languages usually result in higher production costs. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost; therefore lower gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages.

The table below reflects the Gross Profit Percentages from 2009 through the 2014 budget.

2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014 Budget
61.1 %	64.5 %	63.7 %	63.7 %	64.3 %	62.7 %

Prudence dictates that ongoing reviews are necessary to control costs and reinforce the revenue stream to provide sufficient funds to continue providing services. Trusted servants continue to evaluate costs of operations as well as assess the services provided.

Contributions: Contribution revenue had shown positive movement for several years. The years 2008 and 2009 however reflected decreases followed by a rebound in 2010. Results for 2011 showed a slight decline with 2012 rebounding with a \$293,800 increase from 2011 and 2013 reported a further increase of approximately \$348,000.

During 2013, contributions from groups and individuals (as distinguished from those received for the World Service Meeting literature efforts) of \$6,870,242 were \$208,242 (3.1%) more than budget and \$347,299 (5.3%) greater than 2012. Contributions received from World Service Meeting countries toward the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund efforts amounted to \$36,130, approximately even with the \$34,665 received in 2012. This compares with \$75,000 received in 2011 and \$129,000 in 2010. Total contributions including WSM efforts were just over \$6,906,300.

The percentage of the A.A. groups that choose to list with the General Service Office that have participated in the Seventh Tradition by contributing to the General Service Office has remained in a relatively stable range (between 42% and 45%) for the past ten years.

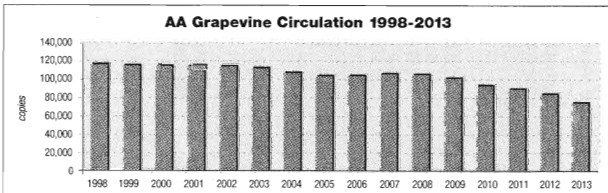
Total Operating Revenue for 2014 is anticipated at \$16,223,960, an increase of approximately \$1,207,000 (8%) due primarily to the Anniversary Edition.

Total Operating Expenses for 2014 have been budgeted at \$15,928,516, approximately \$943,800 or 6.3% greater than 2013 expenses and approximately five percent greater than the 2013 budget. The 2014 budget anticipates additional staffing needs, specifically International Convention assignment staff member and assistant, and a publications Licensing Manager.

The 2014 G.S.O. budget anticipates an excess of revenue over expense of \$295,444. After considerable discussion, the A.A.W.S. Board recommended and the General Service Board approved the 2014 budget, which included price adjustments effective October 2014. It should be remembered that generally the Reserve Fund is funded by literature profits. This anticipated profit for 2014 compares with a profit of \$31,554 for 2013, \$152,448 for 2012, \$819,132 for 2011, \$1,255,289 for 2010, \$1,273,500 for 2009, and a loss of \$275,000 for 2008.

2014 Grapevine Budget

The 2014 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation for the print magazine of 73,401. This anticipates 5,359 fewer copies than the 2013 budget and approximately 3,725 copies fewer than the 2013 average paid print circulation of 77,126. The 2014 budget calls for approximately 4,561 GV online subscriptions, which compares with the 2013 budget of 4,653 and the 5,175 actually achieved. Print magazine circulation for the last 16 years is depicted in the chart below.



Income: Magazine income of \$2,132,851 is expected to be approximately \$109,000 less than 2013. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$787,557, approximately \$11,000 greater than 2013.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, a gross profit of \$1,903,119 is budgeted for 2014. This compares with \$1,993,516 achieved for 2013 and the 2013 budget of \$1,819,859.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 2014 are budgeted at \$1,820,687, \$131,876 greater than the 2013 expenses of \$1,688,811, but \$3,500 lower than the 2013 budget.

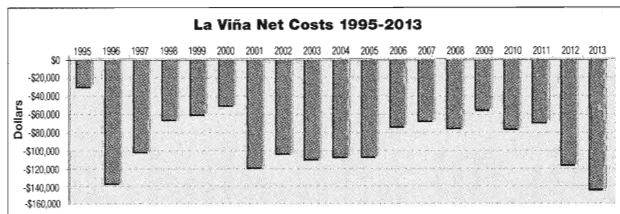
Net Income (loss): For 2014 the Grapevine anticipates a net profit of \$94,232. This compares with a 2013 budgeted profit of \$11,954 and an actual profit from operations of \$315,205.

2014 La Viña Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards were to review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture. In 2001 The General Service Board recommended, and the 2001 Conference approved, that the La Viña magazine continue to be published by the Grapevine but funded by the General Service Board's General Fund, instead of continuing to draw funds from the Reserve Fund.

For 2014 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$57,267, compared with \$54,758 achieved in 2013. Circulation for 2014 is estimated at 10,607 some 4.5% greater than the 2013 average and 15% greater than the 2013 budget as well. Other Publishing Income is estimated at \$9,649, which after deducting cost of product of \$1,751 expects to contribute \$7,898 to revenue. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$206,740 for 2014, approximately \$700 greater than 2013 and \$15,000 more than the 2013 budget. The 2014 budget projects a net cost of \$141,575, to be funded by the General Service Board's General Fund. The anticipated 2014 net cost is \$1,000 less than the 2013 net cost loss of \$142,544. As noted above these net costs are funded by the General Service Board's General Fund.

The Chart above reflects the La Viña magazine net costs since inception (1995). To date net costs of approximately \$1,668,645 have been incurred.



■ 2014 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Michelle Dobek-Koinberg
Anne Fines
Steve Foster
Jennie Herd
¹Padee McCrery
Ron Miscavich
Bill Reidy
Jose Rivera-Vazquez
²Sharon Stevenson

Secretary: Mary Cumings

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Daniel Blanchard
¹Dave Cornwell
Heidi Dahlberg
Sharon Gibbs
Terry Lindgren
²Homer Moeller
Jen Noonan
Gus Palmitessa

Secretary: Racy Joseph

Corrections

Walter Curry
Don Greene
Tony Jordan
Linda McGhee
Terry Mills
²Dennis Morrow
Bill O'Malley
¹Holly Peterson

Secretary: Clement Cann

Finance

Dean Brady
²Kim Carswell
Harold Casey
Raymond Denis
Sheryl Figley
Joe McAndrews
Nancy Murphy
¹Yvette Nelson
Rebecca Thomason

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

Marilyn Balliet
Roger Bedard
Marshall Carter
Cathi Clark
John Hogan
Jake Jacobson
¹Mo Neal
²Astri Torjussen

Secretary: Eugene O'Brien

Literature

¹Carmella Crockett
²Diane Davis
Bruce Dinneford
George Johnson
Pat Latimer
Ola Pearson
Luc Tremblay
Cheryl Vassau

Secretary: Mary Dargan

Policy/Admissions

Mary Ann Ehrhardt
Vernon Heiskell
Sophie Kenn
Frank Malota
¹Mark Mankowski
Marilyn Rodgers
Mary Jo Rone
²Rose Sherburne
Garren Taylor

Secretary: Julio Espallat

Public Information

¹Cathy Beckham
Joyce Saunders
²Patrick Claymore
Garwood Faunce
Cesar Flores
Linda Kornacki-Kuhns
Ken Lawson
Clint MacKenzie

Secretary: Jim Malone

Report and Charter

Dave Allen
Kathi Fowler
²Scott Gilkerson
Pauline Newas
Larry Noonan
Mary Lou Quinn
Mike Rogalla
¹Ken Taylor

Secretary: Tracey Ober

Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities

Dolores Edelman
Anne Frey
Dave Hall
Russ Larsen
Juan Montiel
¹Steve Otto
Randy Rogness
Jim Stone
Sally Williams

Secretary: Rick Walker⁵

Trustees

Becky Burden
Veronica Ernst
²Don Fucik
James Hurst
Ken Koga
Kelley Moran
Patty Schaller
¹Carolyn Walsh
Jim Wilson

Secretary: Clay Rittenhouse

³Archives

Dean Brady
Mary Ann Ehrhardt
James Hurst
Marilyn Rodgers
²Mike Rogalla
¹Rose Sherburne
Carolyn Walsh
Jim Wilson

Secretary: Michelle Mirza

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Dave Allen
Marshall Carter
Michelle Dobek-Koinberg
Garwood Faunce
Vernon Heiskell
Sophie Kenn
²Linda Kornacki-Kuhns
¹Sharon Stevenson

*Secretaries: Eva Sanchez
Mary Clare Lynch*

2015 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Michelle Dobek-Koinberg, Alberta/NWT	Anne Fines, South Dakota
³ Archives	Mary Ann Ehrhardt, Tennessee	Jim Wilson, Western Ontario
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Heidi Dahlberg, Vermont	Gus Palmitessa, Oregon
Corrections	Bill O'Malley, Nebraska	Donald Greene, Kansas
Finance	Dean Brady, California, San Diego/Imperial	Rebecca Thomason, Georgia
Grapevine	John Hogan, Rhode Island	Cathi Clark, So. Indiana
³ International Conv./Regional Forums	Vernon Heiskell, NW Texas	Marshall Carter, South Carolina
Literature	George Johnson, Kentucky	Bruce Dinneford, Alaska
Policy/Admissions	Garren Taylor, Idaho	Mary Ann Ehrhardt, Tennessee
Public Information	Clint MacKenzie, Manitoba	Ken Lawson, New Hampshire
Report and Charter	Kathi Fowler, Arizona	Mary Lou Quinn, Maine
Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities	Russ Larsen, W. Michigan	Dolores Edelman, Washington East
Trustees	Kelley Moran, California, Northern Interior	James Hurst, SW Texas

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

⁴The 2014 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 64th General Service Conference.

⁵Filled in for Steve Smith, who was unable to attend.

■ 2014 Trustees' Committees**

Archives

Michele Grinberg, *chairperson*
Lynda Bergeron
Rod Betonney
Frances Brisbane
Joe Downey
Bill Farnsworth
David Morris
Michelle Mirza, *secretary*

Audit

David Morris, *chairperson*
Nancy Haynes
J. Gary Lutz
Don Meurer, *secretary*

Compensation

Michele Grinberg, *chairperson*
Roberta Lindeman
J. Gary Lutz
Andrew Ware
Don Meurer, *consultant*
Eugene O'Brien, *consultant*
Gary Glynn, *consultant*
Olga Mesonjnik, *secretary*

Conference

Clayton Vandivort, *chairperson*
Lynda Bergeron
Roberta Lindeman
David Noll
Bill Noonan
Bob Wilcox
Albin Zezula
Mary Cumings, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment/Special Needs- Accessibilities

John Fromson, *chairperson*
Rod Betonney
Michele Grinberg
Ivan Lemelle
Ed Martin
Chet Parker
Bob Wilcox
Racy Joseph,
secretary — C.P.C.
Steve Smith, *secretary*
— Treatment/Special
Needs-Accessibilities

Corrections

Frances Brisbane, *chairperson*
Carole Boerner
*Robert Fernando Cordero
Donald Cusson
*Terry Flynn
John Fromson
Barb Kelly
Ivan Lemelle
Andrew Ware
Clement Cann, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

David Morris, *chairperson*
Corliss Burke
Joe Downey
Bill Farnsworth
Nancy Haynes
J. Gary Lutz
Bill Noonan
Clayton Vandivort
Andrew Ware
Kevin Sunkel,
consultant/independent auditor
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Barb Kelly, *chairperson*
Corliss Burke
Ed Martin
David Noll
Chet Parker
Clayton Vandivort
Bob Wilcox
Rick Walker, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Corliss Burke, *chairperson*
Lynda Bergeron
Donald Cusson
Michele Grinberg
Roberta Lindeman
David Morris
Bill Noonan
Eva Sanchez, *secretary*
— International Conventions
Mary Clare Lynch, *secretary*
— Regional Forums

Literature

Donald Cusson, *chairperson*
Rod Betonney
Carole Boerner
Joe Downey
Bill Farnsworth
*Teresa Frohock
*Christine Hofer
Ed Martin
Albin Zezula
Greg Tobin, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Mary Dargan, *secretary*

Nominating

Roberta Lindeman, *chairperson*
Frances Brisbane
Corliss Burke
Nancy Haynes
Barb Kelly
J. Gary Lutz
Clayton Vandivort
Clay Rittenhouse, *secretary*

Public Information

Andrew Ware, *chairperson*
*Tom Becherer
Carole Boerner
*Josh Eggleston
John Fromson
Ivan Lemelle
David Noll
Chet Parker
Albin Zezula
Jim Malone, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Albin Zezula, *chairperson*
Julio Espallat, *secretary*

Officers of the General Service Board

Chair
Terry Bedient
First vice-chairperson
Michele Grinberg
Second vice-chairperson
Roberta Lindeman
Secretary
Clayton Vandivort
Treasurer
David Morris
Assistant secretary
Julio Espallat
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer
The new slate of officers
is given on page 9



* Denotes appointed committee members.

** Terry Bedient is an ex officio member on all committees; Phyllis Halliday is an ex officio on all committees except the Audit Committee, Compensation Committee and the Nominating Committee.

■ 2014 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE (99 Washington Ave., Suite 410, Albany, NY 12210) was elected chairman of the board in 2013, and has served as a Class A trustee and treasurer since 2008. Currently vice president of the Medical Society of New York, his career has included various executive positions, including hospital chief executive officer. He has served on a dozen nonprofit boards, currently as trustee of the New York Lawyer Assistance Trust, which oversees substance abuse programs for attorneys and judges, and as treasurer of the Federation of State Physical Health Programs. Terry is a Fellow of the American College of Healthcare Executives.

Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D. (53 Rustic Ave., Medford, NY 11763) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. A graduate of Columbia University School of Social Work, she received a doctorate in Organization Development from Union Graduate School and University, Cincinnati, Ohio. Frances is the author of five books and over 60 articles and has over 100 major presentations, nationally and internationally, on topics relating to alcoholism and substance abuse prevention and treatment for people of African ancestry. She is currently dean and professor, School of Social Welfare, S.U.N.Y. at Stony Brook, New York. Frances chairs the Corrections Committee and serves on the Archives and Nominating Committees.

Corliss R. Burke, B.Ed. (11 Hayes Place, Whitehorse, Yukon Y1A 0E1) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. During her 26 years in the addiction field, Corliss has worked as a counselor, trainer, director and Deputy Minister. Throughout this time, she has always been involved with Alcoholics Anonymous, attending open A.A. meetings in many countries and working to implement the Bridging the Gap program in Alberta and in the Yukon. Currently, her consulting business focuses on addictions program design and development, as well as on counselor training. Corliss chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Nominating, International and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

John A. Fromson, M.D. (221 Winslow Rd., Waban, MA 02468) was elected Class A trustee in April 2010. He is a board certified addiction specialist. John is a vice chairman of the Dept. of Psychiatry at Brigham and Women's Hospital and Chief of Psychiatry at Brigham and Women's Faulkner Hospital, and teaches at Harvard Medical School. He is the author of many articles and lectures widely. John chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees, and serves on the Corrections and Public Information Committees.

Michele Grinberg, J.D. (P.O. Box 4879, Charleston, WV 25364) was elected Class A trustee in April 2010. She is a 1985 graduate of West Virginia University College of Law, where she now teaches a legal writing course as an adjunct instructor. Michele is a practicing attorney with a concentration in health policy and medical staff relations. She is co-editor of *Women and the Law*. Michele chairs the Archives and Compensation Committees and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs Accessibilities Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

The Hon. Ivan L.R. Lemelle (U.S. District Court, Eastern District of Louisiana, 500 Poydras St., Chambers C-525, New Orleans, LA 70130) was elected Class A trustee in April 2013. A graduate of Loyola University School of Law, New Orleans, Judge Lemelle has an extensive background in both state and federal law. He currently serves as a U.S. District Judge, Visiting Judge in various other federal courts, President of the District Judges Association for the U.S. Fifth Circuit, and lectures often at national and international forums. Ivan serves on the Corrections, Public Information and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees.

David M. Morris, CPA (1060 Park Ave., Apt. #4G, New York, NY 10128) was elected Class A trustee in April 2013. Currently, David is the owner of Morris Consulting, a practice that focuses on providing financial and accounting guidance. He is retired from the position of senior vice president, JPMorgan Chase Bank. David chairs the Finance & Budgetary and Audit Committees and serves on the Archives and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

***Rod Betonney** (6553 Elmcrest Dr., #13F, Salt Lake City, UT 84107) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2010. A former Panel 47 delegate, Rod graduated from the Univ. of Utah with an MSW degree and currently works as a licensed clinical social worker in a substance abuse treatment program. He serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities, Archives and Literature Committees.

***Donald Cusson** (2-1260 Francois Paquin, Terrebonne, Quebec J6W 3Z8) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 2010. A former Panel 54 delegate Don is active in his district and area and is a retired business man. He chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Corrections and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

William (Bill) Farnsworth (716 Fifth St. Marietta, OH 45750) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2013. A former Panel 47 delegate, Bill is active in his district with the Corrections committee. His professional background is in law enforcement and he is involved with community projects. Bill serves on the Archives, Finance & Budgetary and Literature Committees.

Nancy Haynes (P.O. Box 151, St. Helena, CA 94574) was elected general service trustee in May 2011. A former Panel 49 delegate, Nancy served as a nontrustee director on the A.A. Grapevine Board. She is president and CEO of a coffee roasting company. Nancy chairs the Grapevine Board and serves on the Nominating, Audit and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Barbara (Barb) Kelly (752 Skyline Rd., RR #1, Oakwood, ON K0M 2M0) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in May 2011. Barb was a Panel 55 delegate from Eastern Canada and remains active in her area, as well as in community affairs. Now retired, her most recent position was as mayor of Kawartha Lakes. Barb chairs the International Committee and serves on the Corrections and Nominating Committees.

*Rotating at the close of the 2014 Conference meeting.

***Roberta S. Lindeman** (3487 Long Drive, Minden, NV 89423), a Panel 47 delegate from Nevada, was elected general service trustee in April 2010, after having served the four previous years as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Roberta brings a background of teaching, counseling, and school district administration to the board. She continues active participation in a home group and in local A.A. events. Roberta chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Conference, Compensation and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

J. Gary Lutz (2210 13th St., Bethlehem, PA 18020) was elected Northeast regional trustee in May 2011.

A Panel 55 delegate from Eastern Pennsylvania, J. Gary is a university professor of education, specializing in educational research methodology and currently serving as Vice Provost for Institutional Research. He chairs the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Audit, Compensation, Nominating and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

William (Bill) Noonan (1310 Ocean Rd., Spring Lake Heights, NJ 07762) was elected general service trustee in April 2013, after serving as an A.A.W.S. non-trustee director for four years. Bill, a Panel 49 delegate, is an executive in the Financial Risk Management field. Bill's love of general service developed as a result of his involvement with The International Conference of Young People in A.A. Bill serves on the Conference, International Conventions/Regional Forums and Finance & Budgetary Committees. He is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Chet Parker (1006 Eastern Way, Orlando, FL 32804) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2013. A Panel 59 delegate, he is involved in his area's Traditions Workshops. Chet is an attorney who has taught various courses at local institutions. Chet serves on the Public Information, International and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees.

Clayton Vandivort (Box 158, 316 S. Kingshighway St., Sikeston, MO 63801) was elected Southwest regional trustee in May 2011. A former Panel 49 delegate from Eastern Missouri, Clayton is active in his area and region. He is an attorney in private practice. He chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the Nominating, Finance & Budgetary, International Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Andrew Ware (3214 Cummins Way, Missoula, MT 59802) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 2012. A former Panel 57 delegate, Andrew is active in his area and in corrections service. He is a university professor and chair of the Department of Physics and Astronomy. He chairs the Public Information Committee and serves on the Corrections, Compensation and Finance & Budgetary Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Marty Watters (9478 Greenglade Rd., Sidney, BC V8L 3T7) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 2012. A former Panel 59 delegate, where he chaired the Conference Nominating Committee, Marty was active in workshops, inventories and other events around his area. He was the owner of a Landscape/Hardscape Design and Installation business. He served on the Conference, International Conventions/Regional Forums, and Nominating Committees, and was a member of the A.A.W.S. Board. Marty's last service commitment was to chair the Western Canada Regional Forum in February, though ill at the time. He died March 4, 2014.

Robert (Bob) Wilcox (30 Whispering Wind Rd., Westfield, MA 01085) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2013. Bob was a Panel 52 delegate, where he chaired the Public Information Committee. He owns an independent insurance agency. He serves on the Conference, International and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees.

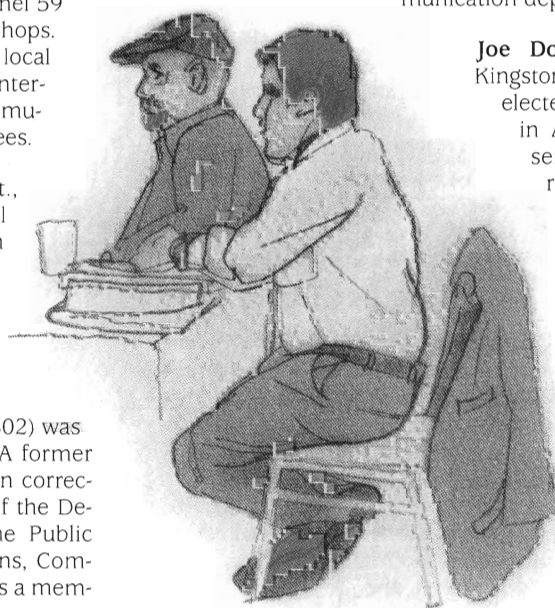
Albin Zezula (100 Connecticut Ave., Long Beach, NY 11561) was elected general service trustee in April 2013, after having served four years as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board. Albin is an associate publisher with a newspaper publishing company. He chairs the Sharing Session and serves on the Conference, Public Information and Literature Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2014 Conference

Richard Boisvert (409 DuRhône, Terrebonne, Quebec J6W 5M3) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 2014. A Panel 60 delegate from NW Quebec, Richard remains active in his area and region. He is retired from the Aerospace industry.

Joel Castellaw (4239 Collwood Lane, San Diego, CA 92115) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2014. A former Panel 60 delegate from the San Diego/Imperial Area, Joel is active in his area. A college professor, he chairs the Communication department.

Joe Downey (43 Lennox St., Kingston, Ontario K7M 4S3) was elected general service trustee in April 2014, after having served as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Joe was a Panel 51 delegate where he was chair of the Conference Literature Committee. He is a clinical researcher at a major university.



A.A. World Services Directors

J. Gary Lutz, *chairperson, regional trustee*
 Carole Boerner, *director*
 Joe Downey, *director*
 Julio Espallat, *G.S.O. staff member*

Phyllis Halliday, *G.S.O. general manager*
 Roberta Lindeman, *general service trustee*
 David Noll, *director*
 Bill Noonan, *general service trustee*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Nancy Haynes, *chairperson, general service trustee*
 Lynda Bergeron, *director*
 Ami Brophy, *executive editor/publisher*
 Michele Grinberg, *class A trustee*

Ed Martin, *director*
 Clayton Vandivort, *regional trustee*
 Andrew Ware, *regional trustee*
 Albin Zezula, *general service trustee*

General Service Office Staff

Phyllis Halliday, *general manager*
 Doug Richardson, *director of staff services*
 Mary Cumings
 Mary Dargan
 Julio Espallat
 Racy Joseph
 Mary Clare Lynch

Jim Malone
 Tracey Ober
 Clay Rittenhouse
 Eva Sanchez
 *Steve Smith
 Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Ami Brophy, *executive editor/publisher*
 Irene Donoso, *La Viña editor*

Jon Witherspoon, *senior editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Julie Anderson, *staff assistant*
 Nadine Baker, *staff assistant*
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr./executive asst.*
 Clement Cann, *G.S.O. staff*
 Louis Casgrain, *French language interpreter*
 Amalia Castillo, *Spanish language interpreter*
 Sheila Coppin-Thom, *staff assistant*
 Cathalina Davis, *copy room coordinator*
 Joseph Dennon, *staff assistant*
 Stefan Jetchick, *French language interpreter*
 John Kirwin, Jr., *hotel coordinator/on-site manager*
 Andree Lanoix, *French language interpreter*
 Elsa Lathan, *staff assistant*
 Sheila Coppin-Thom, *staff assistant*
 Oliver Lepage, *French language interpreter*
 Donald Meurer, *C.F.O., A.A.W.S.*
 Michelle Mirza, *archivist*
 Eugene O'Brien, *GV controller*
 Lionel Perez, *Spanish language interpreter*
 Joselin Pichardo, *GV asst. production editor*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Jason Seder, *artist, Final Conference Report*
 Frank Segui, *finance assistant*
 Charlie Shell, *consultant, project management*
 Robert Slotterback, *controller*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Ames Sweet, *writer*
 Greg Talley, *consultant, International Convention*
 Greg Tobin, *publishing director*
 Yee Tully, *staff assistant*
 Andre Washington, *office manager*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Summer Edition Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nay Williams-Wise, *Conference staff assistant*
 Sandra Wilson, *exec. asst. to general manager*

Trustees emeriti

Leonard Blumenthal
 Ward B. Ewing, D.D.
 Gary Glynn

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 64th Conference includes Panel 63 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 64 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	63	Jim Stone 203 Thach Ln. Meridianville, AL 35759
Alaska	2	64	Bruce Dinneford 6745 Marquerite Juneau, AK 99801
Arizona	3	64	Kathi Fowler 403 E. Croydon Park Rd. Tucson, AZ 85704
Arkansas	4	63	Steve Foster 220 Sibley Trail Searcy, AR 72143
California Southern	5	63	Juan Montiel 868 W. Emory Ct. Upland, CA 91786
Central	93	63	Sharon Gibbs 2330 E. Avenue J-8, #264 Lancaster, CA 93535
Northern Coastal	6	63	Padee McCrery Box 8602 Santa Rosa, CA 95407
Northern Interior	7	64	Kelley Moran 903 Tanner Court Folsom, CA 95630
San Diego/Imperial	8	64	Dean Brady 1533 La Flesta Dr. San Marcos, CA 92078
Mid-Southern	9	64	Cesar Flores 2025 Pomona Ave., Apt. B Costa Mesa, CA 92627
Colorado	10	63	Diane Davis P.O. Box 773306 Steamboat, CO 80477
Connecticut	11	63	Rose Sherburne 30 Gladden St., #9 New Britain, CT 06051
Delaware	12	64	Veronica Ernst 148 S. Lexington Dr. Felton, DE 19943
District of Columbia	13	63	Carmella Crockett 7546 8th St., NW Washington, DC 20012
Florida North	14	63	Marilyn Balliet 6035 E. Tudor St. Inverness, FL 34452
S. Florida/Bahamas/ V.I./Antigua/St.Maarten/ Cayman Islands	15	63	Don Fucik 950 S. Pine Island Rd. Suite A-150 Plantation, FL 33324
Georgia	16	64	Rebecca Thomason 5818 Lakeshore Dr. Buford, GA 30518
Hawaii	17	63	Ken Koga 1815 Young St., Apt. #1 Honolulu, HI 96826
Idaho	18	64	Garren Taylor 1720 E. 2800 South Wendell, ID 83355-3025

* Steve Smith was unable to attend.

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Illinois				Montana	40	63	Sharon Stevenson P.O. Box 542 Bozeman, MT 59771-0542
<i>Chicago</i>	19	63	Mark Mankowski 10830 Sacramento Chicago, IL 60655	Nebraska	41	64	Bill O'Malley 2765 A. Street Lincoln, NE 68502
<i>Northern</i>	20	64	Cheryl Vassau 40710 N. Lake Bluff Dr. Antioch, IL 60002	Nevada	42	63	Sophie Kenn 286 N. Tumbleweed Rd. Bishop, CA 93514
<i>Southern</i>	21	63	Becky Burden 4 Paul Ct. Bloomington, IL 61701	New Hampshire	43	64	Kenneth (Ken) Lawson 39 Sandy Beach Rd. Springfield, NH 03284
Indiana				New Jersey			
<i>Northern</i>	22	63	Bill Reidy 4503 Kingsdale Dr. Valparaiso, IN 46383	<i>Northern</i>	44	63	Linda Kornacki-Kuhns 512 Newark Ave. Piscataway, NJ 08854
<i>Southern</i>	23	64	Cathi Clark 802 Acorn Woods Dr. Indianapolis, IN 46224	<i>Southern</i>	45	64	Joseph (Joe) McAndrews 318 E. Third Ave. Runnemede, NJ 08078
Iowa	24	63	Sheryl Figley 12258 255th St. Donahue, IA 52746	New Mexico	46	64	Jennifer (Jen) Noonan 2200 Corley Dr., #8G Las Cruces, NM 88001
Kansas	25	64	Donald (Don) Greene 124 W. Minneapolis St. Salina, KS 67401	New York			
Kentucky	26	64	George Johnson, III 137 Blue Lake Dr. Berea, KY 40403	<i>Central</i>	47	63	Patty Schaller 221 Avis St. Rochester, NY 14615
Louisiana	27	63	Holly Peterson 4124 Pleasant Dr. Lake Charles, LA 70605	<i>Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire</i>	48	64	Pat Latimer 20 Twiller St. Albany, NY 12209
Maine	28	64	Mary Lou Quinn 1 Pleasant St. Lubec, ME 04652	<i>Southeast</i>	49	63	Linda McGhee 50 East 21st St., #3-F Brooklyn, NY 11226
Maryland	29	64	Ronald (Ron) Miscavich 29868 Nicholas Way Easton, MD 21601	<i>Western</i>	50	64	Frank Malota 109 Southridge Dr. West Seneca, NY 14224
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	63	Horner Moeller 5147 Brandiles Ln. Winston-Salem, NC 27104
<i>Eastern</i>	30	63	Ken Taylor 121 Chestnut St. Pepperell, MA 01463	North Dakota	52	63	Mike Rogalla 4310 10th Ave. South, #109 Fargo, ND 58103
<i>Western</i>	31	64	Anne Frey 182 N. Washington St. Belchertown, MA 01007	Ohio			
Michigan				<i>Central/Southeast</i>	53	63	Dave Cornwell 777 Liverpool Pl. Westerville, OH 43081
<i>Central</i>	32	63	Pauline Newas 2200 Cleveland Ave., #2316 Midland, MI 48640	<i>Northeast</i>	54	63	Ola Pearson 4480 Granada Blvd., #22 Cleveland, OH 44128
<i>Southeast</i>	33	63	Dennis Morrow 65 Woodland Shores Dr. Grosse Pointe Shores, MI 48236	<i>Northwest</i>	55	64	Nancy Murphy 1507 Park Ridge Lane Toledo, OH 43614
<i>Western</i>	34	64	Russell (Russ) Larsen 4748 Zuder St. North Shores, MI 49441	<i>Southwest</i>	56	64	Garwood Faunce 217 E. Main St. Piqua, OH 45356
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	63	Harold Casey P.O. Box 515 Nicoma Park, OK 73066
<i>Northern</i>	35	64	Michael (Jake) Jacobson 1921 E. 27th St. Hibbing, MN 55746	Oregon	58	64	August (Gus) Palmitessa P.O. Box 51328 Eugene, OR 97405
<i>Southern</i>	36	63	Terry Lindgren 3020 Casco Point Rd. Wayzata, MN 55391	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	64	Tony Jordan 605 20th Ave. North Columbus, MS 39701	<i>Eastern</i>	59	63	Steve Otto 118 N. 32nd Ave. Longport, NJ 08403
Missouri				<i>Western</i>	60	63	Yvette Nelson 10 Yale Ave. Pittsburgh, PA 15229
<i>Eastern</i>	38	63	Larry Noonan 2610 Elm Dr. Arnold, MO 63010				
<i>Western</i>	39	63	Dave Hall 2138 Xenia St. Joplin, MO 64801				

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	64	John Hogan 52 Watch Hill Rd. Westerly, RI 02891
South Carolina	62	64	Marshall Carter 30 Kendal Green Dr. Greenville, SC 29607
South Dakota	63	64	Anne Fines 22571 Smokey Ridge Rd. Rapid City, SD 57702
Tennessee	64	64	Mary Ann Ehrhardt 1110 Glenview Dr. Nashville, TN 37206
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	63	Maureen (Mo) Neal 326 Faircrest Dr. Arlington, TX 76018
<i>Northwest</i>	66	64	Vernon Heiskell 6410 Persimmon Lane Amarillo, TX 79124
<i>Southeast</i>	67	63	Patrick Claymore 7997 Kendalia Dr. Houston, TX 77036
<i>Southwest</i>	68	64	James Hurst 818 Alden Corpus Christi, TX 78412
Utah	69	63	Walter Curry 746 Country Club Dr. Stansbury Park, UT 84074
Vermont	70	64	Heidi Dahlberg 22 Athens Dr. Essex Junction, VT 05452
Virginia	71	63	Scott Gilkerson 7251 Beauregard Ct. Warrenton, VA 20187
Washington <i>State East</i>	92	64	Dolores Edelman P.O. Box 246 Malott, WA 98829
<i>Western</i>	72	63	Astri Torjussen 2309 No. 193rd St. Shoreline, WA 98133-4137
West Virginia	73	63	Cathy Beckham 24 Spring St. Morgantown, WV 26501
Wisconsin <i>No. WI/ Up. Pen. MI</i>	74	64	Mary Jo Rone 2437 Sherman Creek Rd. Eau Claire, WI 54703
<i>Southern</i>	75	63	Randy Rogness 1825 N. 166th St. Brookfield, WI 53005
Wyoming	76	64	Sally Williams 415 N. Second East Riverton, WY 82501
Puerto Rico	77	64	Jose (Chepo) Rivera-Vazquez P.O. Box 672 Barranquitas, PR 00794-0672

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	64	Michelle Dobek-Koinberg P.O. Box 402 Blairmore, AB T0K 0E0
B.C./Yukon	79	63	Carolyn Barnes Walsh 16617 79B Ave. Surrey, BC V4N 0J2
Manitoba	80	64	Clinton (Clint) McKenzie 411 Booth Dr. Winnipeg, MB R3J 3M9
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	64	David (Dave) Allen 4 Kilburn Ave. Moncton, NB E1A 3N6
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labr.	82	63	Marilyn Rodgers 5-8 Munroe Court Truro, NS B2N 6P4
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	63	**Joyce Saunders 133 Wynford Dr., Unit 803 Toronto, ON M6K 1K8
<i>Northeast</i>	84	64	Terry Mills 252 Ash St. Sudbury, ON P3C 1Z8
<i>Northwest</i>	85	63	*Jennie Herd 450 Laurensen Ln., Apt. 611 Kenora, ON P9N 4C9
<i>Western</i>	86	64	James (Jim) Wilson 118 West 27th St. Hamilton, ON L9C 5A1
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	64	Raymond Denis 11773 Avenue Matte Montreal-Nord, QC H1G 3P8
<i>Southeast</i>	88	63	Daniel Blanchard 214 Salaberry Sherbrooke, QC J1E 2P6
<i>Northeast</i>	89	63	Roger Bédard 572 106 e Avenue St-Georges-de Champlain, QC G9T 3K3
<i>Northwest</i>	90	64	Luc Tremblay 440 Theberge, #304 Terrebonne, QC J6W 2R4
Saskatchewan	91	63	Kim Carswell 5717 2nd Ave. North Regina, SK S4R 5M4

